



PARISH

of Aghagallon & Ballinderry

Music Ministry. Welcome back to Michaela and the choir at 11am Mass. Music is an essential part of our parish liturgies, and our choirs help us to praise and worship God. Both choirs welcome new members. From October, our Saturday Night Choir will practice every other Tuesday evening after Mass and sing at every other Saturday evening Mass. Our Sunday Community Choir will initially return once or twice a month at the 11am Mass on a Sunday, with a practice just before Mass. We urgently require another person, musician or group to lead our music during alternate Saturday evening or Sunday morning Masses. This is a paid role and may suit someone who is studying music and has an interest in religious music. For more information speak to Fr Declan or contact Catherine in the Parish Office.

Growing In Faith Together Programme. Monday 14th Sep 2026 in Aghagallon Community Centre from 7.30pm-9pm for Year 8's.

Children's Liturgy. Welcome back to all of the children and the leaders of Children's Liturgy.

Sacramental Preparation for Children in Non-Catholic Schools. Faith development is primarily the responsibility of parents. However, in Aghagallon and Ballinderry parish we try to emphasise the partnership between home, school and Church. If you choose to send your child to a non-Catholic school and would like to present them for First Penance (P3), First Holy Communion (P4) or Confirmation (P7) in the parish this year they must be prepared appropriately. Please contact their teacher to ensure that they are part of a catechetical programme and enrol them in children's liturgy in the parish. If schools do not provide sacramental preparation, the parish can assist with providing classes. Please contact Catherine in the parish office to collect an application form.

WEEKLY BULLETIN

Sunday 13th September 2026

Weekly Collection

£1,115.00

Online

£644.47

Total: £1,759.47

Monthly Stipend

£1,335.00

Thank you for your continued support

The Sanctuary Lamp
will burn this week for a
Special Intention

Weekly Mass Schedule

14th Sep – 13th Sep 2026

Mass

Monday: 10.00am

Tuesday: 7.00pm

Wednesday: 10.00am

Thursday: 10.00am

Saturday: 7.00pm

(Vigil)

Sunday: 9am & 11am

Adoration

Wednesday 10am-10pm

Liturgy of the Word

Friday: 10am

MINISTRY OF WELCOME

Booking Masses, Baptisms and Weddings As parish office opening hours have been reduced slightly, we are returning to our previous practice of booking Masses, baptisms and weddings in person, in the sacristy after Masses.

Masses can be booked well in advance to ensure your preferred dates are available.

Baptisms can only be booked by the child's parent or legal guardian. At least one month's notice is required. To book a baptism parents must present the child's long birth certificate, complete the baptism request form, meet with one of our Baptism team and attend weekly Mass during the month prior to the date of the Baptism

Weddings can be booked by the couple themselves. Couples are required to give at least six months' notice of marriage to ensure the preferred date is available and that there is adequate time to complete all Civil and Church paperwork.

RECENTLY DECEASED

Seamus Lavery

Brian McGarry

Tom Dowdall

Mary Orr

Iris Craig

Michelle Latimer (nee Rush) Month's Mind Mass Sunday 13th September at 9am

ANNIVERSARIES AT THIS TIME

Colin Toomey

Pat Lavery

Barry Geraghty

Kathleen McStravick

Pat McKillop

Kathleen Mulholland

Charlie McVeigh (34)

Desmond McVeigh (15)

Lily Mallon

Anniv Mass Sat 12th Sep at 7pm

Anniv Mass Sun 13th Sep at 11am

Anniv Mass Tue 15th Sep at 7pm

Anniv Mass Sat 19th Sep at 7pm

Anniv Mass Sun 20th Sep at 9am

Anniv Mass Sun 20th Sep at 11am

The Order of the Knights of St Columbanus cordially invite you veneration of the Holy Relic of St Padre Pio, Sat 26th Sept directly after 7pm mass. Tea & Coffee will be served during the veneration from the Kiosk. Everyone welcome. **Adoration** will run from after 10am Mass-6pm and 8pm-10pm from Wednesday 16th September 2026.

Recent expenditure - Folens - New School Books for Confirmation preparation - £173.25.

Parish Office Tel: 02892 651214

Email: parishofaandb@yahoo.co.uk

Parish Priest: Fr Declan Mulligan

02892651214

Parish Office Mobile:

Catherine 07485605252

EMERGENCIES AND SICK CALLS

07831 934 756

(in the event you are unable to reach Fr Declan on the emergency number)

02894 422278

St Vincent De Paul

Contact Number:

07598 076585

www.svp.ie

Lifeline Freephone 0808 808 8000

The Knights of St Columbanus

028 92 528 916

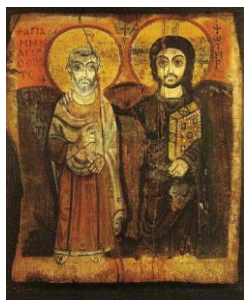
Diocesan Safeguarding Office

028 9049 2798

Parish Office Open Tue, Wed & Fri 11am-3pm

All insertions for the bulletin – please leave in the Parochial house red post box, email or phone the parish office before 4pm on Tuesday.

13th SEPTEMBER 2026 — 24th SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME



PARISH OF ANTRIM
St Comgall, St Joseph, St MacNissius

Rev Patrick Mulholland PP, St Comgall's Presbytery: 94428016
 Rev David Aksenczuk, St Joseph's Presbytery: 07935340359
 Parish Support Officer: Mrs Bernie Mann: 94428016
 Antrim Parish website www.antrimparish.com
 Facebook: [Parish of Antrim](https://www.facebook.com/Parish of Antrim)

**SUNDAY MASSES**

St. Comgall's 9.00am 11.00am
 St. Joseph's 5.30pm (Sat vigil) 12.00noon
 St. MacNissius 10.00am

Weekday Mass

St. Comgall's: Monday, Wed, Friday & Sat 10.00am
 St. Joseph's: Tues & Thurs 10am Fri 7pm

Mass is available to view on the Parish
 facebook page and youtube: Parish of
 Antrim

Confessions

St. Comgall's – Sat 12 - 12.30pm
 St. Joseph's – Sat 4.45 – 5.15pm

Adoration: Fri 10.30 – 12 noon St. Comgall's
 Every 1st Fri. @ 6pm St. Joseph's

Prayer Group – Every Wed 7pm in Sr.
 Catherine's Room
 St. Comgall's

Readings: Sunday Cycle A 24th
 Sunday of the Year Weekday Cycle 2

PRAYER OF THE DAY

*Holy Spirit by your light you guide
 this world toward the Father's love
 and accompany creation as it
 groans in travail. You also dwell in
 our hearts and you inspire us to do
 what is good.
 Praise be to you.*

PRAYER PEOPLE

Intention for Parish Community Year 13
Week 43

*We pray for parishioners who are
 living the single vocation in life that
 they will be encouraged and
 appreciated for the gifts that they
 bring to the community*

Thought for the Week

*“The Lord set his love upon you and
 chose you. (Deut. 7:7)
 God is bound to us, he chose us, not so
 much because we are faithful, but
 because the Lord is faithful and endures
 our faithlessness, our indolence's,
 our lapses....
 We can experience and savour the
 tenderness of this love at every stage of
 life: in times of joy and sadness, in times
 of good health and of frailty and of
 sickness.”*

Pope Francis

Offertory Collection: £3,167.00
Thank you to all who contributed.

Recently Deceased: Keith Hagan

Month's Mind: John Hughes, Bernadette McManus

Anniv : Danny McKay, Theresa Gallagher, Brigid Duffin, Denis Dickson, Joby Thomas
 Paddy McKiney, Jean McTernan, James Maguire, Catherine & Michael Donaghy,
 Enda McAuley(Jnr), Jim Delargy, Eileen Marks, Frank O'Hanlon, Ellen Rice,
 Patrick O'Keeffe, Roisin Gibson, Elizabeth Murphy, Niall McAleese, Aileen McGinn

CEMETERY SUNDAYS IN PARISH

Sunday 13th September in St Comgall's Cemetery.

People are asked to assemble in the Church for prayers before going to the graves for the blessing.

(a collection will be taken up to defray expenses for the services)

Healing Night will be on Sunday 20th September at 6pm. There will be Eucharistic Adoration, confession and an opportunity for quiet individual prayer and music.

TEA AND COFFEE MORNING The social and hospitality would love you all to come and join us for a cuppa and some refreshments on Sunday 20th September in St Comgall's Youth Centre after 11am Mass. Bring your family and friends – everyone is welcome.

Naming Our Family of Parishes We have been grouped in the Family of Parishes with Duneane and Randalstown. We are inviting our parishioners old and young to find a name for our Group which reflects our faith, heritage and location. More details on how to do this are available on the parish website and facebook page

Padre Pio Mass – Blessing with the glove of Padre Pio

Our Lady of Lourdes Church Moneyglass, on Wednesday 23rd September at 7pm. The Mass will be held in the Grotto. A Petition box will be available for all petitions.

QUEEN'S CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY – WE'RE BACK!

The Catholic Chaplaincy at Queen's reopens for the new academic year on **Monday 14 September**, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming.

Our first Sunday Mass is **20 September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Please note the new time!**

New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org and on our socials. Staff and alumni are always welcome too. Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions or candlelighting — and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!

HSC NI Foster Care This September HSC NI Foster Care are hosting two child specific virtual information events which will feature 6 children from across Northern Ireland who urgently need safe and nurturing foster homes. **EVENT 1** Tuesday 22 September 7.30pm - 9.00pm **EVENT 2** Thursday 24 September 7.30pm - 9.00pm

To register for either event, please provide your contact details (including postcode) and which child/children you are interested in hearing about to: 0800 0720 137.

hello@adoptionandfostercare.hscni.net

Prayer after Communion

Soul of Christ, sanctify me;

Body of Christ, save me;

Blood of Christ, fill me;

Water from the side of Christ, wash me;

Passion of Christ, strengthen me, O Good Jesus hear me

Within your wounds hide me; allow me not to be separated from you;

From the malicious enemy defend me;

At the hour of my death call me;

And bid me come to you, that with your saints I will praise you forever and ever. Amen

13th SEPTEMBER 2026
24th SUNDAY OF THE YEAR

Priest: In our first reading, Sirach teaches us that when we pray for others, our own sins will be forgiven. We offer our prayers, ever mindful of God's mercy for us and for all people.

With Pope Leo, we pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

Let us pray to the Lord

For world leaders and all in authority, that they may choose paths of peace, dialogue, and mutual forgiveness over power, division and conflict.

Let us pray to the Lord.

For all those who struggle with 'resentment and anger'; may God give them the grace to forgive, the patience to understand one another, and the courage to let go of bitterness.

Let us pray to the Lord

That the gift of creation may be used with care and responsibility. May human beings be true stewards and act for the welfare of all creatures who share our world

Let us pray to the Lord

For the sick who carry a daily cross of pain or helplessness may be granted healing and fresh hope through the hands of those who care for them.

Let us pray to the Lord

For those who have died:

Recently Deceased: Keith Hagan

Month's Mind: John Hughes, Bernadette McManus

All those named in the bulletin.

that the Lord who '*is rich in mercy*' may welcome them into the eternal joy of heaven.

Let us pray to the Lord

Priest: Merciful Father, hear our prayers. Help us to forgive as we have been forgiven, and guide us always in the way of love, reconciliation, and peace. We ask this through Christ our Lord **Amen.**

PARISH SCHEDULE

DATE	ST MARY STAR OF THE SEA	ST JOSEPH
Mon 7	10am: MASS 10am-7pm: Private Prayer	10am-7pm: Private Prayer
Tue 8	10am-7pm: Private Prayer 7pm: NOVENA MASS: Mother of Perpetual Help	10am-7pm: Private Prayer
Wed 9	10am-7pm: Private Prayer	10am: MASS 10.30am-7pm: ADORATION (Evening Prayer at 6:45pm)
Thu 10	10am-7pm: Private Prayer	10am-7pm: Private Prayer
Fri 11	10am-7pm: Private Prayer	10am-7pm: Private Prayer
Sat 12	4.15pm: Confessions 5pm: VIGIL MASS	10am: MASS & Confessions 10am-7pm: Private Prayer
Sun 13	10am-7pm: Private Prayer	10am MASS 11am-7pm: Private Prayer

MASS INTENTIONS

Mon 7:	Samuel Doherty
Tue 8:	Sean Masterson & Peekie Kearney
Wed 9:	Helen Caldwell
Sat 12 (10am):	For the Parish
Sat 12 (5pm):	Brendan Braniff (MM)
Sun 13:	Joe Bailie (MM), Fr Eamon Fitzgerald, Phyllis & Harry Reid



Mass Intention Envelopes are available in the Churches and can be left in Offertory baskets during Mass, the Parish Office or directly with Fr Robert.

REST IN PEACE



RECENTLY DECEASED: Fr Michael McConville (Ballycastle)
MONTHS MIND: Martin Quinn
ANNIVERSARIES: Bobby & Vera Adair, Chris McGrattan, John & Mary McMullan, Vi Dorrian

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord!



This week's Sanctuary Candle will burn for:

St Joseph's: For all our families
St Mary Star of the Sea: For the sick and housebound

Sanctuary candle intentions are requested through the Office.
A suggested offering of £5.

150th Anniversary of St Joseph's Church

St Joseph's Church, Ardkeen, opened on Sunday 8th October 1876. This year will mark 150 years of worship, community and faith at this beloved Church on Mount St Joseph. To celebrate this milestone, a series of events is proposed around the theme "The Goodness of God" - a time to give thanks for a century and a half of grace, prayer and parish life. Further details to follow. The week of celebrations will include:

Thursday 1st October - Feast of St Thérèse of Lisieux: Floral Exhibition concluding with Evening Prayer.

Friday 2nd October - Feast of the Guardian Angels: Pupils from St Mary's Primary School will visit the floral exhibition. First Friday Evening Mass.

Saturday 3rd October - Celebratory Lunch at Kirkistown Castle GC.

Sunday 4th October - 800th Anniversary of St Francis of Assisi: Harvest Mass & Farm Animals display for the kids and the young at heart.

Wednesday 7th October - Family Rosary followed by 24 hours of Adoration for the Lord.

Thursday 8th October - Evening Prayer & Solemn Benediction.

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Tue 8: NAVTIVITY OF MARY
Wed 9: St Ciaran, Abbot
Thu 10: St Peter Claver, Priest
Sat 12: The Holy Name of Mary

"She is the flower of the field from whom bloomed the precious Lily of the Valley."

-St Augustine



The Birth of the Virgin
by Giotto (1266-1337)

PARISH NEWS AND EVENTS

WEEKLY OFFERING: The Weekly Offering on last Sunday amounted to £1,575. Thank you for your continued generosity and support.

ST VINCENT DE PAUL: Thank you for your continuing support of the work of SVP. Last week's collection amounted to £260. If you require assistance then please call our confidential helpline number: 07895835215.

SILVER CIRCLE PARISH DRAW: Congratulations to our August winners: Declan Kelly (£250), Brian & Margaret Caughey (£200), Margaret & Patrick Lennon (£150), Eugene Byers (£50). Thanks to all who support our Parish Draw.

BINGO IN AID OF AIR AMBULANCES. St Patrick's Community Centre, Portaferry, **Sunday 13th September at 3pm.** All welcome.

ST MARY'S LITTLE STARS Parent/Grandparent, Baby and Toddler Group, a new parish initiative, will hold an information morning on **Thursday 17th September from 10.30am-12.30pm** at the Nunsquarter Room, St Mary Star of the Sea Church. It aims to create a warm and welcoming space to meet, chat, play and make new friends. All parents, grandparents with their babies and toddlers welcome. See posters or webpage for more info.

CATHOLIC MENS RETREAT - Standing in the Breach, will take place at Portglenone Monastery on **Saturday, 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.** The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

FAITH, HERITAGE & COMMUNITY DAY OUT for Ballygalget, Portaferry & Ardkeen Parishes: A fully guided tour of the shepherd's life at Glenshane Country Farm, the Gorta Experience at Friels, with a 3-course Dinner at Friels Bar & Restaurant, Swatragh. **Thursday 24 September, 9am-6pm,** £60 pp all included. Contact Seamus Dorrian 07813968171. All welcome. See webpage for more information.

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND. Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from **Friday 2nd to Sunday 4th October 2026** at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. For more details: www.marriageencounter.ie

BALLYCRAN GAA LOTTO RESULTS 30th August. No jackpot winner. Next week's jackpot is £3050. Draw winners: Rory Gordon, Philip McCarthy, Michael McKenna.



ALTAR SERVERS: There will be a meeting of Altar Servers on **Monday 28th September at 7.00 pm** in the Nunsquarter Room at St Mary Star of the Sea. Anyone interested in becoming an altar server should contact the Parish Office or Grainne McNamara for an Application Form. It is open to children who have made their First Holy Communion. Training will be provided, and new teams will be established.



POPE'S INTENTION FOR SEPTEMBER 2026

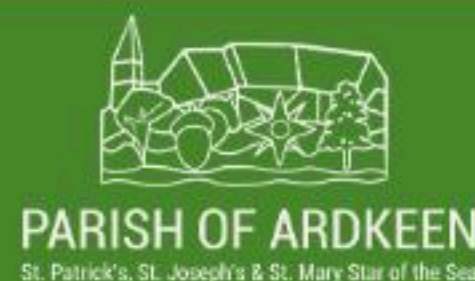
For the care of water - Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have access to it.

Upcoming Parish Committee Meetings

Celebrations Committee: 8th September at 7.30pm
Pastoral Council: 22nd September at 7.30pm
Finance Committee: 29th September at 7.30pm
Liturgy Committee: 6th October at 7.30pm



Parish Priest: Very Rev Robert Sloan PP VF
Parish Office Tel: 028 42738294 (Parish Support Officer: Mairead)
Parish Office Hours: Monday 9am-4pm, Tuesday 1.30-4pm, Wednesday 9am-3pm, Thursday 9am-4pm, Friday Closed.
Address: 46 Blackstaff Road, Ballycranbeg, Kircubbin, BT22 1AG



Our Vision:

A vibrant and welcoming Catholic Parish witnessing Christian prayerfulness and joyful service in the broader Community.



For more information please see:

Website: www.parihofardkeen.co.uk

Facebook: Parish of Ardkeen



Parish Bulletin

for
Ramoan

(Ballycastle, Glenshesk & Rathlin)
and

Ballintoy & Ballinlea
(Mass Readings: Sunday Cycle A)

Parish Emergency Mobile: 07809553349.
www.ballycastleparish.com

Parish Office, Mon-Fri 9am-2pm: 20762223
ballycastle@downandconnor.org

Mass and Confessions Schedule in Ballycastle

Vigil Mass on Saturday at 6.30pm, and Masses on Sunday at 10am and 12noon.
Daily Mass: 10am, with Sacrament of Reconciliation after Saturday 10am Mass

Upcoming Mass Schedule

Ballintoy: Sat 5th Sept at 5.30pm Glenshesk: Sun 13th Sept at 9am. Ballinlea: Sun 20th Sept at 9am.

Youth Choir

🎵 Every other Saturday starting Saturday 5th Sept with 5.15pm rehearsal for 6.30pm Mass.
New members welcome. Age: P4 upwards
Contact Noilin 07852263060

Lough Derg

One Day Retreats

of guided prayer and reflection are available on September 9th, 12th, 15th, 19th & 20th
Further information at www.loughderg.org or info@loughderg.org



The Causeway Coast Peace Group

meet on Tuesday, 8th September, 10am-12noon (Tea / Coffee 10-10.30am)
in Ballintoy Parish Church Hall with speaker Shona McCarthy
on the theme "Peace Through a Creative Lens".
New members / attendees always welcome

We extend a warm welcome

The Rev Emma Gibson

**who was formally instituted as rector of the Church of Ireland
Parishes of Ramoan and Culfeightrin on Friday 4th September.**

The Legion of Mary Annual Pilgrimage

to Knock Shrine will take place on Sun 27 Sept.
A coach will leave Dunloy Parish Centre at 7am, returning by 9.30pm.
Information / booking: 07510547636 (Legion of Mary)

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach

Portglenone Monastery, Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.
The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20).
and will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.
All men are very welcome.
For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

Temporary Building Supervisor required at St Olcan's Primary School, Armoy for 18.5 hrs per week with immediate start, initially for 1 month but may be extended; experience preferred.

Please send your CV to mkennedy502@c2kni.net if you would be interested in this post.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament

every Monday, immediately after 10am Mass until 1.30pm. All welcome

We pray for our deceased parishioners, relatives and friends, especially those who died recently

Seamus Walsh (Leyland Farm),
Dermot Hurley (Castle Street; originally Maghera),
Michael McConville (Belfast & formerly Ballycastle) and
Patrick McGothigan (Germany; originally Magherahoney)

and those whose anniversaries occur at this time

Robbie Elliot (1st), Kieran Grant (1st), Joseph McAuley, Maureen & James Forrester, Francie Black,
John McLaughlin, Annie McCaughan, Mary Ann Bakewell, Jimmy Gibson, Mary Girvan,
Patrick & Maureen Hetherington, Andrew McLernon and Francie McGinty

Requiescant in Pace

We welcome
*to the worshipping community of the parishes of
Ramoan, Ballycastle and of Ballintoy*

Aran Taylor
Ben Taylor
Eiblinn McCaughan
Jack Tolan
Leo McLean
Arlo Whelan-Neill
Naoise Whelan-Neill
Grace Connolly
Orlaith Connolly
Rian Soave
Blanaid McCaughan
Oisin McAlonan
Kaleb Farrelly
Brianna McAfee

who were baptised over the last two months.



Baptism is the gateway to life in the Spirit and the door which gives access to the other sacraments. Through Baptism we are freed from sin and reborn as children of God; and become members of Christ.

Apostolic Work collection totalled £1,008.20. Thank you to all who contributed and special thanks to SVdP, and to Bridie O'Neill and Riona for helping out on the day.



The Foodbank is very much in need of tinned veg (e.g. peas and carrots), tinned meats (e.g. tuna, corned beef and ham), packets of biscuits (e.g. digestives and kitkats), tinned rice and custard.



Al Anon

If you are concerned about a loved ones drinking, you are not alone.
Ballycastle Al Anon family group meet every Monday in 62 Ann St, from 6 to 7pm.

Please note change of venue, day and time.

Newcomers are very welcome

Confidential helplines: 08000086811 and 028-90682368.

Email: helpline@al-anonuk.org.uk

Day trip to Knock

Saturday 3rd October. Bus leaving St Patrick's Church Loughguile at 6am.

Contact Patricia Campbell on 028-27641120 or 07871626940. Price approx £30 depending on numbers.

Useful numbers

Saint Vincent de Paul 07754722022.

Bethany Bereavement Support 07519471481.

Foodbank 07536986448.

BabyBank 07801630476 or 07929785256.

Legion of Mary 07510547636.



The Parish of Ballyclare & Ballygowan

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Notice Board

The Parish of Ballyclare & Ballygowan

6 September 2026

(028) 9334 2226 ballyclare@downandconnor.org

 @ballyclareballygowanparish

The Faithful Departed

Recently Deceased: Monica Harris

Anniversaries: Teddy McCudden, Eileen Foley, Elizabeth McGookin, John Flynn, John Joseph Ryan, Thomas McFall, Kathleen McToal, Seamus McAlinden, Pauline Rogan, James Joseph McAlinden, Margaret Quinn

Eternal Rest Grant unto them, O Lord, and let perpetual light shine upon them.

Masses this week: No weekday Mass this week

Offerings: Thank you for your recent offerings.

30 August – Weekly Offering £379.50

Holy Family Church will reopen on Sunday 4th October with a celebratory Mass at 3.00pm. All welcome, refreshments afterwards.

A Special Mass to mark the opening of the Season of Creation will be held this evening, Sunday 6 September at 6.00pm in St Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast. This year, under the theme "Living Water" we are again called to renew and deepen our commitment to care for our common home through prayer and action. Celebrant Fr Piaras Jackson SJ

Catholic Men's Retreat: Standing in the Breach: Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

Called & Gifted - Discover Your Spiritual Gifts Have you ever wondered how God might be working in your life, or what gifts He has given you to use for others? Called and Gifted is a guided process to help you discern the Spiritual gifts you received at your Baptism, and how God is calling you to use them. We invite you to journey with others to discover: Who God is calling you to be; How the Holy Spirit is at work in your life; The unique gifts you have been given to share with others. This engaging programme will run for two Saturdays and three Wednesday evenings in Belfast. For more information and details of how to register please contact the Pathways to the Future team pathwaystothefuture@downandconnor.org (028) 9069 0920

Belfast Jesuit Centre: Two new programmes starting this September: A Year of Ignatian Prayer and The Chosen Season 2 - weekly screenings. For more information please visit the centre website belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk or email bjc@jesuit.ie

Thinking about becoming Catholic, or want to deepen your understanding of the faith? The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults wishing to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect with their faith. The 2026-2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23rd September and runs weekly from 6.30 pm to 8.00pm in St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiances, and friends are also very welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after time away. To find out more, scan the QR code to visit our information page, or email rcia@downandconnor.org to register.



<i>This Week's Hymns</i>			
Entrance	395	Communion	260
Offertory	687	Recessional	442



Please click on the button if you wish to make an online donatation to the Parish of Ballyclare and Ballygowan. Thank you.



Vincent's Shop – open Monday – Friday - 9 00-5 00pm.
 Telephone 2564 4122 Helpline Tel No 078 4048 2141

Parish Centre Telephone Number – 028 2563 1236



Why not join us after 10 00am Mass for tea, coffee, and some light snacks in the Main Hall, Parish Centre. There will also be juice and nibbles for the younger people

The Old School Café is available for funeral receptions – various menus available. Contact 078 7977 4749. **Thursday Lunch - Contact Claire** to book.

Repository Shop – Tuesday – Friday - 10 30am-12 30pm.

Wednesday Get Together Club continues - 16 September – 2 00pm-4 00pm. Come and enjoy a cup of tea and a chat.

All Saints' Men's Group new project – Friday Club for Seniors (ladies and gents) continues – 11am-1pm. Activities include Badminton, Boccia & Board games. Refreshment provided – Free! Managed by NACN & financially supported by PHA.

Bingo continues – Sundays - 7 30pm.

All Saints' Men's Club (Seniors) – Wednesday - 11am (after Mass). New members welcome. No upper age limit.

Ladies Activity Class recommences – Monday 14 September – 11 00am-12noon. New members welcome.

Creative Crafters recommences – Monday 14 September – after 10 00am Mass

Pitter Patter Parents & Toddlers recommences – Monday 14 September – 10 00am-11.45am – All Saints' Youth Club.



24th Sunday in Ordinary Time - 13 September 2026

Our Parish vision:

Our Parish is a caring community, leading people into friendship with Christ and sending them out to serve, bring hope and enrich lives.

Church of All Saints - Saturday 6 00pm Vigil, Sunday 8 30am, Sunday 10 00am, Sunday **2 00pm Polish Mass**
St Patrick's Church - Saturday 5 00pm Vigil, Sunday 11 00am

Eucharistic Adoration each Friday 10 30am-12noon

Confessions – Saturday 12noon-1 00pm
First Fridays 7 00pm-7 30pm. Mass at 7 30pm

On the first Saturday of each month, beginning on 3rd October, confessions will be heard in the room under the gallery

Weekly collection £4006 Thank you for your generosity.

Parish Office Tel: 028 2564 1515 – weekdays 9am-12noon
Facebook Page: Ballymena Kirkinriola Parish
Youtube: All saints ballymena
. Website: ballymenaparish.org
Email: ballymena@downandconnor.org

If you are new to the parish, you are invited to register at the Parish Office and collect an Information Pack for new Ballymena parishioners

Weekend Masses at 5pm & 6pm (vigils) and 10am & 11am will be transmitted via YouTube and 6pm and 10am via Parish Radio
Daily Mass at 10am transmitted via Youtube and Parish Radio



We welcome those who were Baptised recently in the parish: Lyla-May Kerr

Recently deceased: Elizabeth Ann Hayes, Marie Reid
Month's Mind: John Donnelly, Frank Heffron (Randalstown)

Anniversaries: Shaun McCormick (Downpatrick) & Hilda Butler (née Kerr), Robert Atkinson, Jim Dougan, John Curry, Richard O'Rawe, Marie Joseph, Sheila O'Brien, Patrick McKenna, Seamus Marron, Mary McMullan, Rose, Joseph & Elizabeth Gallagher, Sheila & Joe McGrath, Jo Roden, Susan O'Hara, Bridget McAlonan, Matilda Downey, Alfred Mooney, James & Emily McIlwee, Jean & Patsy Neeson, Rose Murnin, Eric Sphara, Martin McCarte

Eucharistic Adoration – Down and Connor Diocese is renewing and developing its **Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee** in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting at **ONE** of these venues:

Thursday 1 October – The Parish Centre Ballymena – 8 00pm

Friday 2 October – St Patrick's Centre Downpatrick – 8 00pm

Registration from 7 30pm. See poster in the church for details.

Pioneer Gathering – Sunday 27 September

A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down & Connor will take place on: **Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast.**

This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who would like to support a fresh start, new energy, and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

Children's Liturgy -We will shortly be restarting Children's liturgy following the summer break for pupils in P1 -7. Children's liturgy is a wonderful way for children to engage with the gospel message and the good news of Jesus through storytelling, discussion, singing and prayer. **The liturgy will take place in the Parish Centre during the Sunday 10am Mass from 13 September.** Only children who have started Primary School and have been registered by a parent/guardian to attend can leave the church to attend. For new registrations, or if your details have changed, please contact Claire on clarhanna@gmail.com or 07415653854.

Fr Joe Davis – Presentation

There will be a special Mass of thanksgiving concelebrated with Fr Joe in **All Saints Church on Friday 25th September at 7pm.** This will be followed by a presentation of a gift and social event in the Parish Centre. Everyone is welcome to attend. If you wish to donate to the cost of the gift, use the special donation envelope which can be found in the porch of the church. Please return it on the collection plate on or before Sunday 20th September. Many thanks.

Irish Classes in All Saints' Parsh Centre - 10 weeks - beginning - Thursday 17th September. Minor Hall 07:00pm - 08:00pm – Irish Language Improver's Class Slemish Room 07:00pm - 08:00pm – Irish Language Beginner's Class. Please book early as numbers are restricted. Braid Room 07:00pm - 08:00pm – Irish Language Advanced class. **Please contact Rosie Lyness on 07740684152 for further details.**

OCIA/RCIA - Adults, who are interested in finding out more about our Catholic faith, thinking about joining our Catholic community or existing Catholics, who wish to learn more about the basics of our faith, please contact the Parish Office and complete a registration form by **Friday 18th September.**

Down & Connor Cantor Training – Music Ministry Formation for adults (18+) ready to serve more fully in parish music ministry. Training will take place in St Joseph's Parish Centre Dunloy – 3rd & 17th October & 7th November. To request an application form or for more information please contact the Pathways team at pathwaystothefuture@downandconnor.org

If you know of anyone who has recently become housebound and would like a visit from a priest, please contact the parish office.

The **CONNECT** friendship group will meet in the Secret Garden Cafe at the Ecos Hub on **Saturday 19th Sept 11.30am.** Everyone welcome. (Over 18)

RNID Near You/NHS Hearing Aid Support Service - We can provide new batteries, cleaning, and re-tubing of ear moulds for NHS hearing aids. We are in the Ballykeel Community Centre on Wednesday September 16 from 12noon - 2pm . All welcome.

All Saints' new Weekend/Holy Day Rota available from the Sacristy



Parish of Ballymoney
& Derrykeighan
CAUSEWAY FAMILY OF PARISHES

6th September 2026
Twenty Third Sunday of Ordinary Time



HOW TO DEAL WITH COMPLAINTS

This Sunday's readings tackle a subject we all find awkward: how to give and receive criticism. In the first reading, Ezekiel is called by God to speak out against sin, even though he cannot guarantee people will listen. In the Gospel, Jesus gives practical advice for confronting someone who has wronged us — first privately, then with a friend, always seeking reconciliation rather than revenge.

The lesson is one of patient love. We shouldn't gossip or hold grudges, but speak honestly and calmly, wanting the relationship restored rather than "winning." Sometimes the wisest course is to wait until we can speak without anger. And when we ourselves feel let down, even by God, we're free to bring him our complaints too — he can bear them.

THIS WEEK

Parish webcam can be viewed on our YouTube channel
(search for Ballymoney Parish)

SUNDAY 6th	9.30am Mass
MONDAY 7th	10am Mass
WEDNESDAY 9th	10am Mass 7pm Rosary
FRIDAY 11th	6pm Adoration & Confessions 7pm Mass
SATURDAY 12th	5.30-5.50pm Confessions 6pm Mass

Our Lady & St Patrick's church is open every day
for private prayer - usually from 10am to 7pm.

Other Sunday Masses in the Causeway Family of Parishes

Saturday 4.30pm	-	Portstewart
Sunday 10am	-	Portstewart
Sunday 11.30am	-	St Malachy's, Coleraine
Sunday 12noon	-	Portrush
Sunday 5pm	-	St Malachy's, Coleraine

WE PRAY FOR THE FAITHFUL DEPARTED

Month's Mind

Frankie McEldowney

Anniversaries

Danny Coyles, Michael Coyles, James Douglas,
John & Florence Kirgan, Florena Moore

REQUIESCAT IN PACE

PARISH FINANCES

Thank you to everyone who supports the parish through our collections. If you want to request a box of envelopes there is a purple form at the back of the church. Remember that you can also support the parish through a regular standing order or by making a one off payment through your bank or online. Our account details are:

Parish of Ballymoney & Derrykeighan
Sort code: 95-06-79
Account No: 10020192.

If you want to give by cheque please make payable to:
Parish of Ballymoney & Derrykeighan.

SEASON OF CREATION

The Church's Season of Creation runs throughout September and on until the feast of St Francis of Assisi on October 4th.

Bishop Alan McGuckian writes "I warmly encourage our parishes, schools, families and communities throughout the diocese to participate in the Season of Creation. May we be inspired to take practical steps, however small, to care for God's creation and to work for environmental justice.

"May this Season of Creation deepen our gratitude for the gift of creation, strengthen our commitment to environmental justice, and inspire us to become faithful stewards of the earth entrusted to our care."

BLESSING OF PETS

Once again we will be marking the Season of Creation with a blessing of animals inspired by the ministry of St Francis of Assisi. Our pets and animals remind us of the beauty and diversity God has given us in the natural world. This year the blessing service takes place here in Ballymoney in the grounds of the church on **Sunday 27th September** at **2pm**. All welcome to attend and bring along your animals to be blessed.

ST VINCENT DE PAUL

Our parish SVP conference is here to support our local community, and we do this in the strictest confidence. If you are in need and would like our help please do not hesitate to get in touch on **07860 455 549**.



SVP ANNUAL OUTING

The Society of St Vincent de Paul, Ballymoney, are hosting their annual outing for senior citizens and those living alone on **Sunday 20th September**.

This year's event will offer a shopping trip followed by an evening meal. Transport is being organised for those wishing to attend with number limited to 48. Anyone with mobility issues please speak to a member of SVP prior to the event. A donation of £5 per person would be greatly appreciated.

Anyone interested in attending should call the SVP number (**07860 455 549**) and leave their name and contact number, or speak to an SVP representative.

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION

A new committee to promote Eucharistic Adoration in our diocese is being set up. They are looking for people who would be interested in supporting their work through promotion, speaking in parishes, organisation or prayer. If you're interested in getting involved please speak to Fr Damian for more information.

CAUSEWAY COAST PEACE GROUP

The group invite you to the first in their 25th Anniversary series of meetings for 2026-27 on **Tuesday 8th September** at **10am** in **Ballintoy Parish Church Hall**. The speaker will be Shona McCarthy who is speaking on *Peace Through a Creative Lens*. A warm welcome will be extended to all who come along.

PARISH OF BALLYMONEY
& DERRYKEIGHAN

Diocese of Down & Connor
Causeway Family of Parishes

Contact Details

Very Rev. Damian McCaughan PP VF

81 Castle Street
BALLYMONEY
Co. Antrim
BT53 6JT

Tel: 028 2766 2003
Email: ballymoney@downandconnor.org

Website: www.ballymoneyparish.com
Facebook: [@ballymoneycatholic](https://www.facebook.com/ballymoneycatholic)

HYMNS FOR MASS

Soul of my Saviour sanctify my breast,
Body of Christ, be thou my saving guest,
Blood of my Saviour, bathe me in thy tide,
wash me with water flowing from thy side.

Strength and protection may thy passion be,
O blessed Jesus, hear and answer me;
deep in thy wounds, Lord, hide and shelter me,
so shall I never, never part from thee.

O Lord, my God,
when I, in awesome wonder
Consider all
the worlds Thy hands have made
I see the stars,
I hear the rolling thunder
Thy power throughout
the universe displayed

Then sings my soul,
my Saviour God to Thee,
How great Thou art, how great Thou art.
Then sings my soul,
my Saviour God to Thee,
How great Thou art, how great Thou art.

OLD & NEW@No.5

There's lots of new stock again this week from an old vintage sewing machine to a large pair of two handled vases, nice pairs of candlesticks, jug and basin sets, and much more.

Visit us at 5 Gate End, Ballymoney, open **Wednesday to Saturday, 10am - 4.30pm**. To keep in touch with our offers and to see pictures of our stock don't forget our Facebook page **@oldandnewatno5**

MEN'S RETREAT

A Catholic men's retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on **Saturday 19th September**, from **9am** to **1pm**. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on **07967 620435** or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk

CAUSEWAY PARISHES PILGRIMAGE TO KNOCK

There will be a pilgrimage to Knock Shrine for our Causeway Family of Parishes on **Saturday 3rd October** led by **Fr Kevin McGuckien**. The bus will make pickups from Portrush, Portstewart, Coleraine and Ballymoney leaving at approximately 7am and returning around 10.30pm. The cost is **£35 for adults** and **£10 for children**. You can book a place by phoning **07724 092063**.

OTHER TRIPS TO KNOCK

The Legion of Mary Annual Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine will take place on **Sunday 27th September**. A coach will leave Dunloy Parish Centre at 7am, returning by 9.30pm. Information/booking: **07471537051**

There will be another trip to Knock on **Saturday 3rd October**. A bus will be leaving St Patrick's Church Loughguile at 6am. Contact Patricia Campbell on **02827641120** or **07871626940**.

PARISH OF BANGOR, MEMBER OF ARDS FAMILY OF PARISHES

Parish Priest: Very Rev Joseph Gunn St Comgall's Presbytery, 27 Brunswick Road, Bangor, Co Down, BT20 3DS
T: (028) 9146-5522 **Permanent Deacon:** Rev James McAllister **T:** 07751 851444
Email: bangor@downandconnor.org **Website:** www.bangorparish.com **Office Hours:** Mon-Fri 10am to 1pm.

Twenty-Fourth Sunday in Ordinary Time, Year A – 13th September 2026

Your prayers are requested for:

Recently Deceased:

Gerry O'Loan

Tess Hughes

Anniversaries:

Jack Allen

Raymond & Alice Havlin

Mona Hinds

Mary Ellen McGeough

Bridget Agnes Rafferty

Kitty Campbell

June Boyd

Billy Grego

Ena Quinn

Joe McNally

Maureen Taylor

Maureen Cullen

Stephen McKearney

Patrick Coyle

MASS TIMES NEXT WEEK

DAILY MASS:

Monday 14th – Friday 18th September @ 9.30am

ST. COMGALL'S CHURCH DONAGHADEE

Sunday 20th September 2026 @ 9am

ST COMGALL'S CHURCH BRUNSWICK ROAD

Saturday 19th September @ 6.30pm

Sunday 20th September @ 10am & 12noon

BAPTISMS

Please register online SIDE BAR under Baptism registration
Baptisms are celebrated on Sundays @ 1.15pm



TRŌCAIRE COFFEE MORNING

In aid of disaster in Nepal

Sunday 20 September in Parish
Centre

Tea/coffee & traybakes
Big ballot
Tombola

Please support our appeal

Canon Ronnie Nesbitt

This weekend sees the retirement of Canon Ronnie Nesbitt as Rector of Bangor Abbey. He and his wife Carol have been firm and generous friends to both me since 2009 and to the parish of St Comgall during his term of office.

Whether it was in relation to St Columbanus celebrations in which he participated fully or in ecumenical co-operation he gave of himself with typical humour and warmth.

I know that he is hugely respected and loved in his parish and he has been a wonderful exponent of the friendship promised in the very name of St Comgall "the friend of the stranger".

May he go from strength to strength as he begins his retirement and may it be as long and fruitful as his ministry in the Abbey where he personified the words of St Comgall - *Sancti Venite – Draw nigh and take the body of the Lord.*

On behalf of the Catholic Parish of Bangor, Canon Whyte, Deacon James and Sr Maura I wish God's blessing on Canon Ronnie and Carol and every joy for the future.

Canon J. Gunn PP

PARISH CENTRE – PARISH GROUPS 2025

MONDAYS	TUESDAYS	WEDNESDAYS	THURSDAYS	FRIDAYS
BRIDGE CLUB at 7.15pm until 9.45pm [Minor Hall] LECTIO DIVINA GROUP 7.30pm – 8.30pm [St Dymphna's Room] BADMINTON NOW WEEKLY at 8 to 9pm [Main Hall]	FRIENDSHIP CLUB at 10.30am [Minor Hall] IRISH DANCING CLASSES at 6.00pm to 8.30pm [Main Hall] SVP at 7.30pm to 9.30pm [St Dymphna's Room]	MEDITATION GROUP at 12pm to 1.30pm [St Dymphna's Room] FOLK GROUP AT 6.30 -7.30pm [St Dymphna's Room] SENIOR CHOIR At 7.30pm [St Dymphna's Room] YOUTH CLUB AT 6.30 -8.30pm [Main Hall]	St Comgall's Guide Unit (Girls aged 6-18) at 6.15pm to 8pm [Main/Minor Hall] IRISH LANGUAGE CLASS At 7pm to 8pm [St Dymphna's Room] CEILI DANCING at 8.15pm to 9.30pm [Minor Hall]	Ju-Jitsu Club (Juniors 5-15yrs) 6-7pm [Main Hall] Discussion Group At 7.30pm – 9pm [St. Dymphna's Room]

Discussion Group

The next meeting of the Discussion Group will be on Friday 18 September 2026 in the Parish Centre from 7:30pm to 9:30pm.

The topic for this meeting is: 'The Justice of God'.

Everyone is welcome.

Pioneer Gathering – Sunday 27 September

A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down & Connor will take place on:

Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast.

This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who would like to support a fresh start, new energy, and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

CHOIR

New choir members welcome for 10am Mass and we would welcome tenors and basses.

No prior music reading experience required.

See timetable above for details.

Poetry & Presence begins on Thursday 1 October at 7pm in the **Belfast Jesuit Centre**, opening with the theme of **Water** in this **Season of Creation**. You're invited into a quiet, reflective evening of poetry, art, music, and Scripture: a space to pause, breathe, and let the imagery of water in God's story speak to the depths of your own heart.



Thursday 1 October 7.00pm



Belfast Jesuit Centre

Children's Liturgy

Children's Liturgy will be starting on the 27th September. New forms have to be filled in. Lisa will have them at back of church before and after mass this week.

Parishioners are kindly requested to submit notices for the newsletter and anniversary mass requests to the parish office by Wednesday of each week (Mon to Fri 10am – 1pm) or via bangor@downandconnor.org

ST VINCENT DE PAUL HELPLINES

Bangor Conference 07703679384

(covering Bangor West, Clandeboy/Newtownards Road area, Kilcooley, Helens Bay and Crawfordsburn)

Ballyholme/Donaghadee Conference 07703679389. (covering Bangor city centre, Bangor East/Ballyholme, Balloo/Bloomfield Road area, Groomsport, Donaghadee and Millisle)

Parish of Bright Bulletin

Twenty-Third Sunday Ordinary Time - 6th September 2026

Parish Priest: Fr Peter O'Kane,
16 Rossglass Road, Killough, BT30 7QN
Tel: 028 4484 1221
Email: parishofbright@downandconnor.org
Website: parishofbright.net

Mass Times: Week Beginning Monday 7th September

<u>St Patrick's, Legamaddy</u>	<u>St Joseph's, Killough</u>
7th September Monday 10am	8th September Tuesday 10am
11th September Friday 7.30pm	9th September Wednesday 7.30pm
13th September Sunday 10am.	12th September Saturday 10am
	12th September Saturday Vigil 6.30pm

Our Lady, Star of the Sea, Rossglass

10th September Thursday 10.00am

Faithful Departed

Recently Deceased: John Lundy (Saul & Ballee)

Month's Mind: Richard Smyth, Jeannine Schollhammer (Jersey)

Anniversaries: Tommy Connolly

Weekly Confessions

Sacrament of Reconciliation: after all weekday Masses; and in St Joseph's every Wednesday 8.00pm-8.45pm and at 6.00pm before the Saturday Vigil Mass.

Eucharistic Adoration

St Joseph's, Killough every Wed: 3.30pm -7.30pm & after Mass 8pm-9pm. St Patrick's, Legamaddy every Friday: 6.30pm-7.30pm.

Sunday Collections 30th August

Weekly £794-92. Thank you for your generous contributions.

Mass for the Sick and Infirm

The annual 'Mass for the Sick and the Infirm' will take place in Bright Community Hall, Ballynoe, BT30 8AJ at 12noon on Saturday 12th September. Neighbouring parishes are also very welcome to attend. Refreshments will be served afterwards. If you need transport please contact St Vincent de Paul: Nickey 07745 004510 or Sean 07548 647301.

Parish of Bright Cemetery Sunday 2027

Sunday 13th June: St Joseph's, Killough 1pm & Star of the Sea, Rossglass 3pm
Sunday 27th June: St Patrick's, Legamaddy 3pm.

Celebration of the Sacraments for our Primary Schools 2027

First Confession

St Patrick's PS: Monday 8th March in St Patrick's Church at 1.00pm

St Joseph's PS: Monday 15th March in St Joseph's Church at 1.00pm

Confirmation

St Patrick's & St Joseph's PSs: Thursday 22nd April, St Patrick's Church, Legamaddy at 11.00am with Bishop Alan McGuckian SJ

First Holy Communion

St Joseph's PS: Saturday 15th May in St Joseph's Church at 11.00am

St Patrick's PS: Saturday 22nd May in St Patrick's Church at 11.00am

Parish Pastoral Council 1st September 2026

During the meeting we discussed the following: The newly merged Parishes of Downpatrick and Bright Baptism Preparation Team is now providing courses for parents requesting Baptism in our parish, plans are progressing to provide Children's Liturgy at St Patrick's in Legamaddy (hopefully from October) and to involve the Primary 4 Come Follow Me group from St Joseph's in the Saturday Vigil Mass. Children's Liturgy will be provided by a number of catechists on the Come Follow Me Programme all of whom have undergone the appropriate level of safeguarding checks and training. We discussed how to most sensitively implement a new Diocesan process for parishioners who wish to avail of the Bereavement Ministry that recognises that not everyone will wish to do so.

The Pastoral Council plan to introduce 'Lectio Divina' as a way of enhancing the prayerfulness of our meetings, Father Peter will lead us in the reading, meditation, prayer and contemplation of the Gospel, based on resources accessed from the Dominican Lectio Divina Centre in Newry.

Proposed dates were suggested for the Mass for the Bereaved and the Inter-Church Carol Service (it is our turn to host this year) and are awaiting confirmation. Two dates that have been agreed include next year's Cemetery Sunday and Confirmation for children from both primary schools that will be held at St Patrick's - these dates will be published in the bulletin in due course. We all agreed that 'Ice Cream Sundays' had been a great success and these will be scheduled for next summer.

The next meeting of the Parish Pastoral Council will take place on Monday 5th October 2026.

The members of the Parish of Bright Pastoral Council are: Gertie Small (Chair), Suzanne Hogg (Secretary), Mary McGrath, Mary Wylie, Cyril Carr, Gerarde Dawe, Fr Peter.

Mass Timings for the weekdays and weekends (17th August onwards)

Mass Times

Monday - 7pm St Nicholas

Tuesday - 10am St Nicholas

Thursday - 7pm Our Lady of Lourdes

Friday - 10am Our Lady of Lourdes

Sunday - 9.30 Our Lady of Lourdes

- 11.30 St Nicholas

Confessions

Monday - 6.15 to 6.50 - St Nicholas

Thursday - 6.15 to 6.50 - Our Lady of Lourdes

Sunday - 9am to 9.20am - Our Lady of Lourdes

Sunday - 11am to 11.20am - St Nicholas



Mary, Mother of the Church Saintfield

Open Sun. Tues. Wed. Thurs. 10 am – 4 pm
Mon. Fri. Sat. 10 am – 8 pm

MASS

Saturday 6:30 pm
Sunday 11:00 am
Monday & Friday 7:30 pm

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament
Monday 7.00 pm

St Joseph's Church, Carrickmannon
Open Sat & Sun 10:00 am – 2:00 pm

MASS

Sunday 9:00 am
Tuesday 10:00 am

CONFESSIONS

Before Vigil Mass

ALTAR SOCIETY

Saintfield – Group 2
Carrickmannon – Team 4

READERS 19/20 September

Vigil: Mary Davies

9am: Michael Miskelly

11am: Sharon Murray

EUCCHARISTIC MINISTERS

19/20 September

Vigil: Gemma Magennis, Eileen Murray

9 am: Margaret Bennett

11 am: Audrey Mullan,
Marian Walsh, James Mullan

St Vincent de Paul

Contact: 07521463667

stmochai.saintfield@syvni.co.uk

Weekly Collection 6th Sept. £1270

August Weekly by S/Orders: £572
August Monthly Env: £1407.10
August Monthly by S/Orders: £192



*"Speak Lord, your servant is
listening. You have the message
of eternal life."*

Please remember in your prayers:

Anne Kelly, Cameron Beaton, Jane Stewart, Mathew VP Vanchiparayil, Fr Michael McConville, Joseph McGourty, Ita Bell and Kevin Fay recently deceased.

Anniversaries: Margaret Mullan, Ann Murray, Robert Gault, Minnie Gault, Orla Flynn, Raymond Creighton, Clare Walls, William McDowell, Mary Greeves, Joe Cunningham and all the Holy Souls in Purgatory.

Months Mind Mass for Kevin Fay will be offered at 6:30 pm on Friday 18th September in Saintfield Church.

Feast Days

Monday: Exaltation of the Holy Cross

Tuesday: Our Lady of Sorrows

Wednesday: St Cornelius, St Cyprian

Thursday: St Robert Bellarmine

Saturday: St Januarius, Our Lady of
Salette

A Presentation Evening for Fr Michael Sheehan will be held in St Joseph's Hall, Carryduff on **Saturday 26th September at 7pm.** Envelopes towards his leaving gift are available in both churches. If you wish to make a donation please take an envelope and return to the box provided next weekend 19/21 September. Thank you for your support and generosity.



Hello children. Today Jesus talks to us about forgiveness – about how God is always ready to forgive us if we say sorry and about how we should try to forgive others if they say sorry to us.

This week let's try our best to say sorry when we have done something wrong, and to forgive and help others.

God of love, help us to share your forgiveness with others. Guide us to do what is right and to make this world a fairer place for all who live in it. Amen.

Worksheets and the Kids Bulletin to support this week's Gospel are available in both churches. Pick up copies for your children/grandchildren.

Could You Help Share the True Spirit of Christmas? Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell Trócaire's Gifts of Change — meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. Last Christmas, 50 parishes took part and we'd love to grow that number even more this year! For more details please call **028 9080 8030** or email mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org

Catholic Men's Retreat- Portglenone Monastery, Saturday 19 September from 9am to 1pm. Theme: "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" Fr Eddie McGee is keynote speaker. Contact Thomas Carey on 07967620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk



Monday Social Club
Next meeting
21st September 2026
12:30 – 2:00 pm

Crois Dharach CLG Club

Lotto Numbers: **4 11 18 28**. No Jackpot winner. Consolation prize winners: Marie Lowry, Lorcan Fairfield, Daryl McLaughlin and Paul O'Callaghan. **New Jackpot £11,300.** Tickets are available on Klubfunder page Oaks Bar, Chestnut Bar, Vivo Shop, Dufferin Bar, International Bar and Central Bars Killyleagh

The Medical Missionaries of Mary will speak at all Masses in the parish on **26th and 27th September** of their work, mainly in Africa and South America, and their mission to bring Christ's healing love to those most in need. Our parish and our diocese have supported MMM generously in the past, both in finance and in prayer, and MMM wishes to express gratitude for that support and to emphasise that we here at home are the body of mission, and those who are sent to faraway places are the hands and the feet. When they speak to us and share their story they serve as a connection between us and those whom they serve.

A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down & Connor will take place on **Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast.** We would be delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

As we celebrate the feast of the [Exaltation of the Holy Cross](#), on Monday 14th September, let us *“glory in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, in whom is our salvation, life and resurrection, through whom we are saved and delivered.”*

May Christ be in our mind, in our lips, in our heart, in our actions, in our life. But if this noble and holy desire were to come true, let us not forget that to follow Christ and to live His life necessarily require carrying His Cross and all that it entails, not with mere resignation, but with joyful acceptance and for Love.

“O God, who willed that your Only Begotten Son should undergo the Cross to save the human race, grant, we pray, that we who have known his mystery on earth may merit the grace of his redemption in heaven. Through our Lord Jesus Christ Your Son, who lives and reigns with You, in the unity of the Holy Spirit, One God, forever and ever. Amen.”

Prayer to Our Lady of Sorrows

Our mother of sorrows, with strength from above you stood by the cross, sharing in the sufferings of Jesus, and with tender care you bore him in your arms, mourning and weeping. We praise you for your faith, which accepted the life God planned for you. We praise you for your hope, which trusted that God would do great things in you. We praise you for your love in bearing with Jesus the sorrows of his passion.

Holy Mary, may we follow your example, and stand by all your children who need comfort and love. Mother of God, stand by us in our trials and care for us in our many needs. Pray for us now and at the hour of our death.

Amen

Anam Cara - Monthly Parent Support Evening - 14th September at 7.30pm in the Crowne Plaza, Shaws Bridge, Belfast. This event is free and open to all bereaved parents. We also offer an online support group meeting. To find out more email info@anamcara.ie

MEN'S 55 + VOLUNTEER CHALLENGE – Tuesday 15th September at 10:30 am in Saintfield Community Association, Windmill Park, 29 Belfast Road, Saintfield. Volunteers will take part in a range of outdoor activities. See poster in Church porch.

Fossil Football – Five-a-side – for 55 years Plus – Down Leasure Centre
Tuesday evenings. Contact Trevor 07843089778 See poster in Church porch

As part of the **Season of Creation**, **Join the Dots Together** is launching a report on its **Earth Day Conference, An Economy of Enough**. The launch will take place on: **Thursday 24 September, 7.30pm in Windsor Hub, 22 Lower Windsor Avenue, Belfast**. Further information from Juanita Majury, info@jointhedotstogether.org

Bookings for Mass, Month Minds, Anniversaries, Baptisms and Weddings are to be made through the Parish Office **02897510237** or Parish email address at: saintfield@downandconnor.org. Office Hours: Monday & Wednesday 11.00am - 1.30pm. Thursday 12 – 1pm. Please use the Parish email outside of Office Hours.

Saintfield & Carrickmannon

Parish Bulletin

13th September 2026



*Jesus, son of the living God,
have mercy on me, a sinner.*

24th Sunday in Ordinary Time

Fr Martin Graham PP 028 9081 2238
Fr Anthony McHugh PE 028 9751 023
Email: saintfield@downandconnor.org

Parish Family Website
www.carryduffsaintfield.co.uk

6th September 2026

23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time

A Year of Ignatian Prayer 2026-2027 – Belfast Jesuit Centre our immersive programme in Ignatian Spirituality returns in September offering ten in-person Saturdays (10am–4pm) in the BJC and seven online Integrative Practice Pause Points to support prayer, discernment, and reflective living. Open to those new to Ignatian Spirituality and those seeking to deepen their practice. Suggested donation: £200–£280. Bursaries available. For dates and registration, please visit: <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/a-year-of-ignatian-prayer-2026-2027/>

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct.

Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at ~~Portglenone~~ **Monastery** on **Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm**. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk

Derriaghy Parish: Please take note of the following.

- Baptisms:** 1st Sunday of each month. One month's notice required.
- Marriages:** Three months' notice is required, six months is preferable.
- Confession:** Every Tuesday after 10:00am Mass



Dundrum Tyrella Parish

Weekly Bulletin

24th Sunday in Ordinary Time
13th September 2026



Parish Information

Priests: Canon Robert Fleck

Parochial House: 4375 1212

Mobile: 07841101853

E-mail: robertfleck@btinternet.com

Deacon James: 07921026295

Sacred Heart Primary, Dundrum

Mr Mark Fitzsimons: 4375 1293

St. Joseph's Primary, Ballykinlar

John McVeigh: 4485 1600

SVP Helpline - 07538683550

Office Hours: Tuesday, Wednesday 3.30pm to 7.30pm and

Thursday 3.15pm to 6.15pm

Email for bulletin notices: dundrum@downandconnor.org

Visit our Facebook page: Dundrum Tyrella Parish

Dundrum Mass is live streamed—visit www.mcnmedia.tv

PARISH SAFEGUARDING COMMITTEE:

Our Chairperson is Maurice Redmond, supported by Mary Graham, Geraldine Vaughan, Loretta Killen, and Canon Robert Fleck.

If you have a concern about a child or vulnerable adult's welfare, please contact any of the following:

Diocesan Designated Liaison Person,

Philip O'Hara: 07534 992 124

Social Services: 02890 507000;

PSNI: 101; NSPCC Helpline: 0808 800 5000.

What's On in Our Parish:

Parish Surgery—there will be **NO PARISH SURGERY** this Monday 14th September as Canon Robert away on retreat.

Prayer & Communion Services—on Monday 14th and Wednesday 16th September by Deacon James in Dundrum at 9.30am. **The service will be lay led on Tuesday 15th September.**

St Carlo Acutis—many thank to the Parishioners who purchased medals, prayer cards and candles. A young gent after Mass spoke to Canon Robert and Deacon James informing them he had met St Carolo Acutis' mother in Paris—how special!

Parish Fundraising Concert on Friday 18th September—countdown on for this event!

Parishioners and friends are requested to be seated by 6.45pm please. Parish Pastoral Council Members will be available to provide help in carpark and chapel.

"Helpers" would be most welcome to come along to tidy chapel on Monday 14th September at 7pm and setup community centre on Thursday 17th September at 7pm. **Not too late to purchase ticket!**

We hope everyone has an enjoyable evening.

Canon Robert—will be away on retreat after Mass on Sunday the 13th September until Wednesday 16th September inclusive. **Please contact Mary Polland for any emergencies 07713 701 750.**

Parish Pastoral Council Meeting—held last Tuesday the following was agreed. The 1st Anniversary of Deacon James Ordination will be held on Sunday 4th October 2026. Following tea and coffee and light refreshments for everyone. Parishioners are **ALSO** welcome to join Deacon James and his family for lunch in Maginn's Castlewellan (**payable!**)

Please inform Annette or Mary if you wish to attend and choose menu!

October is the Month of the Rosary and at weekend Masses the Rosary will be recited (outside, weather permitting) in Ballykinlar at 5.45pm and Dundrum at 10.30am.

Harvest Display—Parishioners/Friends who would like to help with the display please come along to chapel on Thursday 1st October at 7pm. Your views will be very welcomed!

November 2026—There will only be **ONE** Mass this year (in November) for all those who have died (or buried) since November 2025 in Ballykinlar.

Date to be confirmed.

Remembering the faithful departed

12th September to 18th September

"Grace and mercy await the chosen of the Lord" (Wis 4:15)

Frances Walker
Eileen Hynds
Gareth Hunter
Jackie McVeigh
Sadie Savage
Clement Digney
Kathleen Digney
Peter O'Hare
Margaret Howard
Margaret McCann

Patrick Mahon
Willie Joe Valentine
Danny McAvoy
Vera Cunningham
Tommy Smith
Mary C Killen
Hugh Kelly
J.J. Magorrian
Margi Grant
Barney Kelly

Recently deceased

Patsy (Patrick) Forsythe
Margaret Magee (nee Poland)

Mass Intentions for this weekend

Sun, 13th September 11am Dundrum

Anniversary Mass for Pearse Rice & Gareth Hunter

This week's mass times from 14th Sept to 20th Sept 2026:

Monday	9.30am	Prayer/Communion Service in Dundrum
Tuesday	9.30am	Dundrum –Lay-led Prayer Service
Wednesday	9.30am	Prayer/Communion Service in Dundrum
Thursday	9.30am	Dundrum
Friday	9.30am	No Mass - Ballykinlar
Saturday	6.00pm	Ballykinlar
Sunday	11:00 am	Dundrum

All masses in Dundrum and Ballykinlar can be viewed via church webcams on www.mcnlive.tv.

Lifeline. If you're in distress or despair call free on 0808 808 8000. Lines are open 24/7.



May their souls,
and the souls of the faithful departed,
through the mercy of God, rest in peace.
Amen

Entrance Hymn

*Be thou my vision,
O Lord of my heart,
Naught be all else to me
save that thou art;
Thou my best thought
in the day and the night
Waking or sleeping,
thy presence my light*

*Be though my wisdom,
be thou my true word,
I ever with thee
and thou with me, Lord;
Thou my great Father,
and I thy true heir;
Thou in me dwelling,
and I in thy care.*

*Be though my breastplate,
my sword for the fight,
Be though my armour
and be though my might,
Though my soul's shelter,
and thou my high tow'r
Raise though my heav'nward,
o Pow'r of my pow'r*

*Contributors: Eleanor Hull and Mary Byrne,
Russell Robinson
used with permission license number A-632154*

Preparation of the Gifts

*O, the love of my Lord
is the essence
Of all that I love here on earth.
All the beauty I see
he has given to me,
And his giving is gentle
as silence.*

*Ev'ry day, ev'ry hour,
ev'ry moment
Have been blessed by the
strength of his love
At the turn of each tide
he is there at my side,
And his touch is as gentle
as silence.*

*There've been times
when I've turned
From his presence,
And I've walked
other paths, other ways;
But I've called on his name
in the dark of my shame
And his mercy was gentle
as silence.*

*Contributors: Estelle White
used with permission license number A-632154*

Recessional Hymn

*Abide with me,
Fast falls the eventide;
The darkness deepens;
Lord, with me abide
When others fail,
And comforts flee
Help of the helpless
O abide with me.*

*Swift to its close
Ebbs out life's little day;
Earth's joys grow dim,
Its glories pass away;
Change and decay
In all around I see;
O though who changest not,
Abide with me.*

*I need thy presence ev'ry
passing hour;
what but thy grace can foil
the tempter's pow'r?
Who like thyself my guide and
stay can be?
Through cloud and sunshine,
Lord, abide with me.*

Public Domain

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of The Chosen: Season 2 will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at 10.45am, episode at 11.00am, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required. Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October. **Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk**

Beginning Experience – Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November and would be most grateful if you could include the following information in your Church Bulletin at your earliest convenience. The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November)

Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29th September at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. **Free admission.**

"**MYMY** is an accredited counselling service for adults based in Newcastle. If you or someone you know could benefit from counselling **please give us call on 028 4372 7549**, email hello@mymy.org.uk or self-refer via our website."

Pioneer Gathering – Sunday 27 September 2026

A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to

renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down & Connor will take place on: Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast. This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who would like to support a fresh start, new energy, and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell Trócaire's Gifts of Change — meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide everything you need including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. Last Christmas, 50 parishes took part — and we'd love to grow that number even more this year! If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call 028 9080 8030.

Eternal Father,

*anoint us with your Holy Spirit,
as we read your Word,
let us hear your voice speaking
to us from within.*

*Give us wisdom to understand
your message to us.*

*Let your word be the joy of our
heart and a lamp for our steps.*

*May we rejoice in the
blessedness of those
who hear your Word and keep it.
Speak Lord
your servants are listening.*

ST PATRICK'S AND ST BRIGID'S GLENARIFFE



TWENTY THIRD SUNDAY OF ORDINARY TIME



6th September 2026

“O that today you would listen to his voice, harden not your hearts”

WEEKDAY MASSES: Wednesday & Friday 7.30pm

WEEKEND MASSES: Saturday Vigil 7pm, Sunday 10am

THE MEDICAL MISSIONARIES OF MARY many thanks to all who have given your support to the above charity.

Please take a voting card; ASSIST US TO LIVE - NOT TO DIE. This vote takes place on 11th September, so complete and forward this week.

DECEASED: Jean McDonnell, Glenravel, (Bernie Haughey's mother)

MONTH'S MIND: Pat McNaughton, Tully

ANNIVERSARIES: Michael Graham, Patrick McAllister, Mary Murray, Seamus Waide, Martin McGinty, Sister Marie Grignon Hayes. Archie McIntosh, Cassie & Cahal McNaughton, Martin O'Boyle, John Collins, Jim Haughey, Greta McAllister

Thought for today:

Creation is God's work. Before humanity was, the rest of creation came into being. The earth and her creatures – indeed the whole cosmos – have beauty, dignity, and meaning before human presence. So, to be amazed at the wonder of creation is part of our calling. Look up to the skies, walk in the fields, stand at the sea's edge. Everything belongs; every thing has beauty! The garden is such a model for our care of creation.

Our call is to be good gardeners, thoughtful, alert and diligent, working with the soil and with the rhyme of the seasons, caring for the creatures who find a home and a shelter in the garden.

Fr Donal Neary, S.J

Gospel Reflections for the Year of Matthew

www.messenger.ie/bookshop/

Each Other's Keepers

In any group, small and big, things cause friction. Everyone thinks his or her way is right. We can fight over who is right. Some things are worth a fight, others not.

In the big questions of life, we need the advice, support and love of the other. Many people ask themselves, "*Why I didn't give an honest opinion about a decision like marriage or a job or a course of studies which seemed ill-advised to everyone?*" We all have good and not-so-good tendencies. We can only advise as best we can, sensitively and wisely, and hope we get a hearing.

We are afraid to hurt, to be rejected. Why do we let so many people drink themselves into trouble and never tell them? The terror of a neighbourhood, no matter what age, needs to be confronted. The problem of drugs in a neighbourhood is not confronted. Crime is not reported.

I am my sister's keeper

In small and big things, we are each other's keeper. Jesus is saying something like that today.

Parents can find this difficult as they try to guide the family well and not lose them. We have social responsibility in the family and in our neighbourhood and even worldwide for the common good.

God wants the best for each of us. We can help each other to goodness, we can support each other, advise each other, pray for and with each other, and help each other on our way to God.

*Recall an occasion when someone gave you good advice,
even when you may not have liked it at the beginning.
Be grateful!*

Give me wisdom, Lord, when others ask me for advice or an opinion.

DOWN & CONNOR DIOCESAN TRUST BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE VACANCY "Pastoral Ministry Co-ordinator" (2 yr Fixed Term Contract) based within the Jesuit Centre at 193 -195 Donegall Street, Belfast, BT1 2FL. 35 hrs per week (flexibility required), £29k per annum, closing date Thurs 10 September @ 12noon. Full details including application form see <http://www.downandconnor.org> or <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk>

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH, DONEGALL STREET, BELFAST @ 6 pm on Sunday, 6 September Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions. This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4 Oct), under the theme "Living Water".

THE CHOSEN – SEASON 2 AT THE BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE Weekly screenings will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre on 4, 11, 18, 25 Sept, 2, 9, 16 & 23 Oct. Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371

CATHOLIC MEN'S RETREAT - STANDING IN THE BREACH A Catholic Men's Retreat at **Portglenone Monastery** on **Saturday 19 Sept 26, from 9am– 1pm**. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

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BEGINNING EXPERIENCE is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on Saturdays 26 Sept, 24 Oct & 21 Nov. Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

ANAM CARA, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening on **Monday 14 Sept @ 7.30pm** in the Crowne Plaza, Shaws Bridge, Belfast. Online support meeting also available. For more info 01 4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

MACMILLAN COFFEE MORNING YOU'RE INVITED! Join us for the cause, the chatter or the tasty treats at St Clare's Community Hall on Friday 11 September 2026 between 9.30am – 12pm.

GH TYRES AND AUTO SERVICES: 40a Glenavy Road, Crumlin. Punctures repairs, Wheel Balancing, Wheel Alignment, Batteries, General Service and repairs Tel: 0289 4423 113.

JOIN THE GLENNAVY GARDEN CENTRE TEAM! Seasonal staff to work 16-24 hours per week. If you have interest or know of anyone who might be interested, contact Dominic 07874005422 or email to glenavygardencentre@outlook.com.

ST. JOSEPH'S GAC: Lotto results 28 August 2026 Winning no's 2-10-15-28 Jackpot £7,500. No Jackpot Winner. 2 Lucky dip Winners, £25 each – Fionnuala McLernon – Karen Stockham. Next week's jackpot is worth £7,550. The members of St. Joseph's GAC thank you for your support.



**Twenty Third Sunday in Ordinary Time
6 September 2026**

Very Rev. Rory Sheehan P.P.: St Joseph's Presbytery, 59 Chapel Road, Glenavy, BT29 4LY Tel: 94 422278 (If unavailable and in an emergency only, contact Fr Declan Mulligan P.P. Aghagallon 92 651214)
Parish Office at St Joseph's Glenavy: Monday- Friday 10am -3pm
Parish Support Officer: Joan McShane Tel: 94 422278
Email: glenavy@downandconnor.org
Parish Website: glenavyandkilleadparish.com
www.facebook.com/glenavyandkilleadparish
A member of Lisburn Pastoral Community

Season of Creation 2026



"Future generations will never forgive us if we miss the opportunity to protect our common home. We have inherited a garden; we must not leave a desert for our children."

Joint statement from Pope Francis, the Ecumenical Patriarch Bartholomew and Archbishop Justin Welby of Canterbury.

THEME: "LIVING WATER"

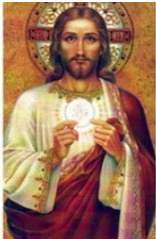
This year's theme, "Living Water", explores Ezekiel 47:9 and 12 as a powerful biblical vision of hope and ecological healing. Set amid exile and loss, the image of living water flowing from God's sanctuary reveals divine healing that renews land, water, biodiversity, and human responsibility towards the whole creation.

"Swarms of living creatures will live wherever the river flows. There will be large numbers of fish, because this water flows there and makes the salt water fresh; so, where the river flows everything will live. [...] Fruit trees of all kinds will grow on both banks of the river. Their leaves will not wither, nor will their fruit fail. Every month they will bear fruit, because the water from the sanctuary flows to them. Their fruit will serve for food and their leaves for healing." (Ezek 47:9,12)

PRAYING WITH AWARENESS IN THE SEASON OF CREATION Living among Others Jesus' invites us to stay awake, to seek and respond to the signs of God's loving presence that are all around us. Websites like Sacred Space and Pray-as-you-go follow the structure of the Examen of Consciousness — or Awareness Prayer — in offering guidelines for prayer. The points listed below are to help you heighten your awareness of living in response to God's presence by considering aspects of everyday life. They may enhance your prayer in this Season of Creation as you reflect on them or discuss them with others. **OUR STARTING POINT** The beauty of creation reflects the infinite beauty of the Creator and ought to inspire the respect and submission of man's intellect and will. (Catechism of the Catholic Church, §341) The Catechism teaches that the order, harmony, and beauty we find in creation are not incidental — they point beyond themselves to the Creator who gave them. How do you notice yourself relating to the created world? When have you recently noticed real beauty in creation - something that stopped you, even briefly? What did that moment invite in you? We are commissioned to till and to keep, to work and to guard the garden the Earth (Genesis 2:15): what efforts do you notice yourself making to care for and protect creation?

Tom Layden, S.J.
Chair, Diocesan Ecumenical Commission

7—13 September 2026 Mass Intentions

	<u>ST JOSEPH'S</u>	<u>MATER DEI</u>	St James
Mon	9.30am Communion Service		Monday Adoration 7pm—8pm
Tue		7pm In Honour of Our Lady 6.30pm Rosary 7.30pm Divine Mercy Chaplet 7.30—8.30pm Adoration	
Wed		9.30am Mass of Thanksgiving for Doctors and Nurses in the Cancer Centre 10am—12pm Adoration	
Thurs	9.30am P.I. Adoration 7pm—9pm		
Fri	9.30am In Honour of The Holy Name of Mary		Feumore Mass Centre Sun Adoration 6.30pm—7.30pm Divine Mercy Chaplet, Chaplet for Holy Souls & Rosary afterwards starts at 6.15pm Mon Adoration 11am—12pm
Sat		5.30pm Sacrament of Reconciliation 6pm P.P.	
Sun	9.30am Noel McComb (2nd Anniv) 12.00pm Mass	10.45am Mass	

Recently Deceased Brendan Kevin Flood (*Glengormly*)

Anniversaries Mary Mallon (1st), Hilary McKavanagh, Fidelma Ward, Louis Heatley, Brigid Trowlen, Nathan Crean, Paddy O'Hara, Jim McGarrell, Liam Brankin, Ernie Thomas.

Baptisms We welcome into God's family Cathal John McNamara, Naoise Joseph Morgan, Torin Lewis Damien Stevenson & Kaii Paul Thomas.

Sanctuary Lamps Special Intention, C.H.

A BLESSED STATUE OF OUR LADY OF FATIMA is available through The Legion of Mary to any sick parishioner for one week. If you would like to avail of the statue, please contact the parish office.

Sanctuary lamp intentions: A Sanctuary Lamp burns for a week in each of our two churches. If you would like to dedicate a lamp for a loved one or a special Intention please contact the Parish Office. There is a suggested offering of £5.

Collection 30 August 2026

Weekly Offering: £3,017

Thank you for your generosity

Parish Draw 2026-27 (Week 18)

Winner £50 Seamus Kavanagh (*Crumlin*)

Winner £100 G & M McGarry (*Crumlin*)

Congratulations to our winners!

Following Christ is a 7-week journey in growing in love of God and one another. When Jesus was calling his first Disciples, he said, 'come and follow me'. We receive this calling ourselves today. God comes toward us calling us to himself to be Disciples of Christ. It takes an effort on our part to respond to that call. Will you strive to live the Christian life that Jesus calls you to and make the effort to attend the Following Christ course? It is a course that will help you to understand what it means to be a Disciple of Christ offering practical ways in which to live out your Catholic faith through learning to pray, read scripture, engage in the sacraments and more. The course runs from **7 September to 19 October, 7 – 9pm in Mater Dei Pastoral centre**. The topics covered are; Personal Prayer, Hearing God in Scripture, The Power of the Sacraments, Forgiving One Another, The Spirit-Empowered Life, The Heart of a Disciple and Going on with the Lord. www.christlife.org

CELEBRATING CANON COLM An event will take place on Sunday 27 September 2026 at 3pm in St Clare's Hall to celebrate Canon Colm's time with us in Glenavy and Killead parish. The event, which will be an admission free, will comprise of afternoon tea catered by St Clare's Hall team, followed by entertainment. If you would like to attend, please text Rose Crozier by 13 September 2026 on 07720 074213 to confirm your place. If you can contribute in any way to the entertainment, please contact Rose Crozier as above by 13 September 2026 with details. A collection for a gift for Canon Colm will take place on Sunday 6 and 13 September. Envelopes are available at the rear of both churches. Collection boxes will be placed in the porches on 13 and 20 September. Thank you in anticipation of your support.

SEASON OF CREATION 1 SEPTEMBER TO 4 OCTOBER, Feast of St Francis, a dedicated time for Christians to commit to prayer, protection of the environment and care for creation. Volunteers needed for the parish Season of Creation Team, please contact the parish office.

THE CHILDREN'S LITURGY HAS RESUMED We would welcome new helpers. We have a very flexible rota & it is just during term time. If you could help even one Sunday per year, call or email the parish office or speak to one of us at Mass any Sunday.

BALLYMACRICKET PRIMARY SCHOOL 'OUR PAST, OUR PRESENT, OUR FUTURE'

This year Ballymacricket is celebrating its 170th anniversary. As we look at our past, present and future, we'd love your help to remember times gone by. If you have any old photos or stories about the school, please leave them in the school office or email ophillips404@c2kni.net We invite past pupils, families, friends and members of the local community to join us on Sunday 20 September, following 9.30am Mass, in the school hall, to celebrate.

FRIENDS OF THE ORDER Equestrian Order of the Holy Sepulchre of Jerusalem Lieutenancy of Ireland help sustain the living Christian presence in the Holy Land. The Order is a Catholic Order under the protection of the Holy See, dedicated to supporting the Latin Patriarchate of Jerusalem and the Christian communities of the Holy Land. To register your interest as a Friend or to donate holysepulchre.ie/friends, Facebook: [EHOSJ Ireland](https://www.facebook.com/EHOSJ-Ireland) Email: friends@holysepulchre.ie Tel: 086 3253882

Liturgical 'Sign of Peace' The Sign of Peace remains an integral part of the celebration of the Eucharist and has been reintroduced as a normal practice across the Diocese. The customary expression of the Sign of Peace in Ireland is a handshake. However, other non-contact forms of the sign of peace such as a nod, a bow or a smile are also legitimate expressions of the Sign of Peace. No offence should be taken if someone prefers to express a non-contact Sign of Peace. The Diocese encourages all to continue to exercise good hygienic practices, and if you exhibit flu-like symptoms, you are encouraged to remain at home.

Church Webcam The church webcam for live stream of Masses can be accessed via the Parish Website www.glenavyandkilleadparish.com Go to the top line and click on webcams and pick either *Mater Dei* or *Glenavy*. It can also be accessed at www.churchmedia.tv. Select *Antrim* & search for *St Joseph's, Glenavy or Mater Dei, Crumlin* and the churches will appear. Click on the play button to view live stream. The webcams enable us to attend Mass, however they do not allow us to receive the Eucharist, The Body of Christ. When possible, we should attend Mass in the Church whenever our circumstances permit in order to receive Holy Communion.

MUSIC AT ST JOSEPH'S There is an urgent need to recruit an organist or guitarist or pianist, if you or someone you know would be interested in this position please contact Canon McBride as soon as possible.

Making your offering to the church Parishioners are encouraged to make donations to the parish either by using the parish envelopes or by means of bank transfer. It is of great benefit to the parish when we can record donations so that gift aid can be claimed, if applicable. If you would like to donate using envelopes and don't already do so, please contact the parish office. Alternatively, if you are able, you are encouraged to make a monthly offering to the Church by means of a **Bank Transfer to: Parish of Glenavy and Killead Sort Code 98 04 60, Account 10654677**. The relevant forms are available at the back of the Churches.

Both forms need to be completed with one sent to your Bank and the other to the parish office. If you have any queries, please contact the Parish Support Officer in confidence. Please note that there is a separate account number for the Parish Draw and this should not be used when making a weekly donation.

DEACONS Those who are discerning a vocation to the permanent diaconate are encouraged to make contact with the Diocesan Director, Rev Brett Lockhart for the Permanent Diaconate, b.lockhart@downandconnor.org.

CCTV CAMERA'S Please be aware that St Joseph's Church and graveyard and Mater Dei Church and grounds are monitored by CCTV.

COFFEE IN THE COURTYARD during the summer months after 10.45am Mass in Mater Dei, weather permitting. Volunteers are needed. If you can help, please contact the Parish office.

SAINT VINCENT DE PAUL—CRUMLIN CONFERENCE (ST JAMES) Emergency helpline 07754427088. Donations can be made via the Crumlin SVP conference bank account. Account number 41965035, sort code 980460. **ST JOSEPH'S GLENNAVY CONFERENCE** SVP Emergency helpline 07784955647. Donation can be made to our bank account, Sort Code 98-04-60. Account Number 41966009. Your support is very much appreciated as we support those most vulnerable in your local community.

Anniversaries August: Joseph Corr, Alice Murphy, Mary Ellen Connor, Patrick O'Hara, Mary Braniff, Tony Wilkinson, Martin Jones, Patrycia Wyrebek, Mary McGowan, Gerry Gibson, Gabriel McErlean, Mary Meenan, Sheila Donaghy, Lena Rice, Terence Lynch, Frank McLaughlin, Peter McGrath, Innocentia McMullan, Marion McCabe, Joseph Monaghan, Monaghan & McGrath Families, Christine Murphy, Desi Turner, Harry Brady, Hugh Smyth, Margaret Rice, Brian McCormick, Bridie, Jim, & Joseph McAllister, Annie Konrad, Eilish Doherty, Rose McMullan, Cedric Veitch, Alice & Alec O'Reilly, Tony Graham, Gabriel Sheridan, Kathleen Shields, David O'Neill, Shelia Doran, Hugh Smith, Kevin & Harry Wylie, Sadie Brown, Kathleen O'Neill, Samuel McGreevey, James Fox, Irene & Brian Edwards, Carole Mahood, Tommy & May Dempsey, William, Mary, Seán & Bernard Colligan, Lily Quinn, Sinead Brady, Leanne Brady, Delia Wasson, Philip Gary, Richard (Ricky) Patterson, Rosemary McRoberts, Helen McKeown, Finn & Shea Whelan.

Months Mind: John McGuinness, Daniel Mailey, Eammon Kerr, James Faulkner, Gerald O'Neill, William Begley, Matt McCarthy.

Recently Deceased: Matthew McCarthy, Kathleen Teresa (Kate) Devlin, Bridie Lynch, Ann Beattie, Patrick Wade, Mary (May) Flood, Francis Loughran, Bernard Tolan.

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Baptism Lines, Marriage Lines etc: will be copied from our register and we will telephone when they are ready. Identification is needed for all Certificates.

Funerals: If you would like your loved one's funeral recorded, please let us know when we are taking the details or let the undertaker know. We need to know beforehand if it has to be recorded.

Marriages: If you want your Marriage to be recorded please inform us when booking the wedding. It is not automatically recorded on the day.

Readers: David Wasson, Brian Lundy, Kathleen Osbourne, Arthur Kealey, Chris McMullan, Paul Currie, Michael Stevenson, Betty Magee.

James Baker, Michelle McCullogh, John McParland, Wilma Lynch, Kate Lynch, Jinno Carlloe, Daniel, Rose Kilmartin, Sr. Kathleen Savage, Joseph Bennett.

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Stella Maris, the Catholic seafarer's charity is looking for volunteers to help with ship visiting, knitting woolly hats and make appeals at Christmas and Easter for eggs and toiletries, For further information please contact peter.mullen@stellamarisemail.org or 07745543959

HOLY CROSS CHURCH ARDOYNE

432 CRUMLIN ROAD BT14 7GE

TEL: 90748231 FAX: 90740340

Emailpassionistshc@ukgateway.net

www.holycrossparishbelfast.com

{Church Services TV}

Office Hours: Weekdays 9am – 5pm

Mon, Tues, Wed, Thur 6 – 8 Houben

CLOSED 1-2, SUNDAYS 9.30AM -1.30.

6-8 PM, SICK CALLS 24/7



Sunday 6th September 2026 23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time.

Passionists Community: Fr. Charles Cross CP Superior
& Parish Priest, Fr. Aidan Troy CP. 07517889434 (24/7) Assistant,
Bro. Conor Quinn CP

Weekday Masses: Monday – Saturday 10am.

Weekend Masses: Sat. Vigil 7pm, Sun. 10, 12, & 7pm, Novena to Our Lady of Sorrows Monday 7pm, First Friday: Healing Mass of St. Charles & Penance Service 7pm.

Confessions: 20 Minutes before each mass by the celebrant of the mass.

Sick Calls: are normally covered by the Priest on duty
Tel: 90748231 pastoral care of sick in hospital is covered by
The Hospital Chaplain.

Baptisms: From September onwards 2nd Saturday of the month 12noon
Baptism Meeting first Sunday of the month 1pm.

Funerals: are celebrated at 10am mass (unless there is more than one funeral or because of time due at the cemetery).

Wedding Bookings: Please contact Parish office 028 90748231.

Pre Marriage-Courses: Wilma 07791148340 after 6pm.
City Hall forms www.groni.gov.uk.

Relic of St. Charles: available at Chapel of Passionist saints.

Requests for Home Blessings: Can be made with any of the priests.
Please phone Parish office 028 90748231.

Children's liturgy: Sunday 12 noon.

Music Sunday: 7pm Vigil Tanya and Anne, 10am Mass Betty & James,
12 noon Mass Organist Mark P. Lavery & Holy Cross Choir.
7pm folk Group.

Welcome to all the new pupils back in our three parish primary schools. It is not easy to leave the gentle, bright, warm days of summer behind and enter back into the routine of learning and study. I love the line from the Book of Ecclesiastes 3:1 *"There is a season for everything.....a time to keep and a time to discard, a time to tear and a time to sew, a time to keep silent and time to speak, a time to love and a time to hate, a time for war and for peace...."*

May our new time together in our various occupations be one of love and respect for each other. In the second reading today at Mass on this Sunday (Romans 13:8-10) in the last sentence, St. Paul says: *"Love is the one thing that cannot hurt your neighbour; that is why it is the answer to every one of the commandments"* The Gospel (Matthew 18:15-20) however speaks about the reality of conflict within the Christian community. It gives some guidelines in how to resolve our difficulties with each other. Forgiveness and love must be always to the fore in the Christian community. We cannot simply turn a blind eye to one or more members who consistently, either knowingly or unknowingly, act or live contrary to the values that is central to its identity. Today's Gospel speaks of a structure of reconciliation that both deals with moral deviance and the injuries that come about when people live together in common. The purpose of the exercise is to *"win back your brother/sister"* (Matthew 18:15). The response in our Responsorial Psalm 94 states: *"O that today you would listen to his voice! Harden not your hearts"*. The psalm goes on to mention two geographical areas where the chosen people who were fleeing from the Egyptians through the Red Sea turned against God. The places are called *Meribah* and *Massah!* (Exodus 17:7). It was there that they quarrelled and fought against God - it was the place where they *hardened* their hearts against His plans. We also have the ability to "harden our hearts" against each other. The prophet Ezekiel in today's first reading (Ezekiel 33:7-9) is reminded by the Lord of his pastoral responsibility towards those who stray from His ways. The Gospel ends with the assurance that Jesus is with the community in all their struggles. *"I tell you solemnly once again, if two of you on earth agree to ask anything at all, it will be granted to you by my Father in heaven. For where two or three meet in my name I shall be there with them"* (Matthew 18:20). Matthew's Gospel begins and ends with the assurance of Jesus presence within the Christian community. At the beginning of the Gospel he writes *"Behold, a virgin shall conceive and bear a son and his name shall be called Emmanuel (which means, God with us)"* (Matthew 1:23). At the end of his Gospel - *"Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptising them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, teaching them to observe all that I have commanded you; and lo, I am with you always to the end of the age"* (Matthew 28:19-20). Have a blessed academic year!

Father Charles C.P.

S.V.D.P: Meeting Wednesday night at 7pm in the Houben Centre.

Holy Cross Choir: 7:30pm Wednesday. In the Houben Centre

AA: Wednesday 7pm – 8:00, Saturday 11 – 1pm Houben Centre

NA: Sunday 7:30 – 8:30pm in the Houben Centre

Prayer Group: 8pm Sunday in the Houben Centre

Legion of Mary: 7pm Thursday in the Houben Centre.

First Friday Film: 8pm in The Houben Centre.

Old School Café: 9:30am – 1:30pm. Monday – Friday

We Welcome new volunteers

Weekly Bingo each Tuesday: From 7pm Flax Room

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Ardoyne Shankill Health Partnership:

Monday: Gentle Exercise & Relaxation 10:30 – 11:30am

Tuesday: Dancing Sessions/Tea & coffee 10:30 – 12noon

Wednesday: Sewing 10:30 – 12:30, Relaxation Stress Management

-2-3pm. **Thursday:** Art/Painting class 12:30 – 2:30pm.

Friday: Crochet/knitting class 10am – 12noon. Tel: 028 90756638.

Legion of Mary Auxiliary Membership: The Legion invites you to become an auxiliary member. There are no meetings to attend. You simply pray the Legion prayers at home every day. This is a great support to the mission of the Church. Contact the Parish office, if you feel called to be and auxiliary Legionary. Contact Conor 07798865887.

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Church Collections July:

5th 1st coll. £2,584.78, 2nd Coll. £430 = £3014.78.

12th 1st Coll. £2,241.28, 2nd Coll. £350 = £2,591.28.

19th 1st Coll. £2,217.62, 2nd Coll. £480 = £2,697.62.

26th 1st Coll. £2,703.34, 2nd Coll. £415 = £3118.34.

Church Collections August:

2nd 1st Coll. £2,715.40, 2nd Coll. £400 = £3,115.40.

9th 1st Coll. £2,500.34, 2nd Coll. £410 = £2,910.34.

15th Feast of The Assumption = £530.

16th 1st Coll. £2665.47, 2nd Coll. £465 = £3,130.47

23rd 1st Coll. £2,496.04, 2nd Coll. £415 = £2,911.04.

30th 1st Coll. £2,621.97, 2nd Coll. £360 = £2,981.97.

Feast Days this Week: 8th the Nativity of The Blessed Virgin Mary, 9th St. Ciaran 10th St. Peter Clever, 12th the Holy Name of Mary, St. Ailbe.

We thank everyone who contributed to all our collections.
your support for Holy Cross is much appreciated. *'The Parish Team'*

Additional Masses during Lent: Monday Novena Mass as usual 7pm, Wednesday 7pm.

Confessions: 15 Minutes before each mass by the celebrant of the mass.

Music Sunday: 7pm Vigil Tanya and Anne, 10am Mass Betty & James, 12 noon Mass Organist Mark P. Lavery & Holy Cross Choir. 7pm folk Group.

Readers: Sr. Kathleen, Wilma Lynch, Arthur Kealey, Michelle McCullagh, Brian Lundy, Chris McMullan, John McParland
Kate Lynch, Michael Stevenson, Kathleen Osbourne, Rose Kilmartin, Betty Magee.



Holy Family Parish

A praying, caring community, centred in Christ

Holy Family Parish is a member of a Family of Parishes, comprising the parishes of St Patrick’s, Holy Family and St Gerard’s.

MASS SCHEDULE

SUNDAYS

Holy Family Church: 6pm Vigil & 10.30am
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: 9am & 12noon

WEEKDAYS

Holy Family Church: 9.15am Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: 10.00am Thursday, Friday & Saturday

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION

Holy Family Church: Saturday 5.15pm-5.45pm
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: Saturday after 10am Mass

BAPTISMS

(Prior booking via Parish Office)

Holy Family Church: Saturdays at 4pm
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: Sundays at 1pm

DEVOTIONS

Eucharistic Adoration: Daily 10am-10pm (St Thérèse)
Pilgrim Prayer: Tuesday 8pm on the Parish Facebook page
Novena to Our Mother of Perpetual Help: Wed 9:15am Mass
First Saturday: 10am (Holy Family)
Taizé Prayer: last Friday of the month 8-9pm (Holy Family)

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Mon 14: The Exaltation of the Holy Cross
Tue 15: Our Lady of Sorrows
Wed 16: St Cornelius and St Cyprian, martyrs
Thu 17: St Robert Bellarmine and St Hildegard of Bingen



“The Cross is the ladder by which we climb to heaven.”
Anonymous

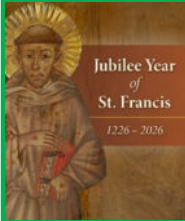
CONTACT INFORMATION

Parish Clergy: Very Rev. Michael Spence PP,
Rev. John O’Lavery CC & Rev. Deacon Brendan Dowd

Parish Telephone (Office hours): 90743119
Office hours: Mon-Thu 9.30am-2.30pm, Fri 9.30am-1.30pm
Address: 226-228 Limestone Road, Belfast BT15 3AP

Emergency Sick Calls only (24hrs): 07928968773
Society of St Vincent de Paul (Helpline): 028 90351561

Email: holyfamily@downandconnor.org
Website & Webcam: www.holy-familyparish.com



24TH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

13TH SEPTEMBER 2026

Readings: A (II) Psalter: Week IV



Living Water
Season of Creation 2026

Immersion in Living Water
EZEKIEL 47:9, 12

The symbol above for this year’s Season of Creation depicts water flowing from the Temple of God – at first a tiny stream that grows deeper, and deeper and as it does so, it brings life to dead areas and restores fertility to damaged or barren ecosystems. Through living water comes healing; but in order to receive new life, we too must step into the water and also become part of God’s river of life, taking part in the healing of creation.

St Colmille's
Laudato Si' Group
in association with **trócaire**
invite you to join us for

Heroes for Humanity

A series of workshops exploring the principles of Catholic Social Teaching through the lives of four remarkable individuals.

St Colmille's Parish Hall
191a Upper Newtownards Road, Belfast, BT4 1JB

Beginning at 7.15 pm

Ending with a supper around 8.45 pm

All are welcome!

Wednesday
9 September 2026
Saint Oscar Romero

Wednesday
16 September 2026
Sister Dorothy Stang

Wednesday
23 September 2026
Dorothy Day

Wednesday
30 September 2026
Martin Luther King Jr

EVENTS

FOOD DRIVE

To mark the Season of Creation, and as we also celebrate the time of harvest, the parish is again organising a food drive, to support our local food banks. NON-PERISHABLE FOODS can be left in both churches, in the gathering space in Holy Family church, and at the sacristy in St Thérèse church, between 19th and 27th September. Your support for this initiative will be greatly appreciated by the many people who rely on food banks.

AN ECONOMY OF ENOUGH in a Time of Crisis and Opportunity. Earth Day Conference report launch on 24th September at 7.30pm, in 22 Lower Windsor Ave. For details, email info@jointhedotstogether.org.

JUBILEE YEAR OF SAINT FRANCIS

Before the San Damiano Cross St. Francis prayed: “Most high, glorious God, enlighten the darkness of my heart. Give me right faith, certain hope, and perfect charity, sense and knowledge, Lord, that I may carry out Your holy and true command.”



HOLY FAMILY PARISH
PRESENTS
AN EVENING OF MUSIC
IN
HOLY FAMILY CHURCH
LIMESTONE ROAD
SUNDAY 4TH OCTOBER 2026
7PM

FEATURING:
NEIL MARTIN
CAVEHILL COMMUNITY CHOIR
& FRIENDS

TICKETS £10
available from the parish office
supporting the work of
Newington Day Centre
Est. 1978

Join us for tea and coffee after. For your comfort bring a cushion.

SUNDAY 4TH OCTOBER AT 7PM, our Parish Community will present an evening of music in Holy Family Church in support of the work of Newington Day Centre. Tickets £10, available now from the parish office, and after weekend Masses, from next weekend. On the night you will have the opportunity to enjoy some of the wonderful talent our parish has to offer including Neil Martin, Cavehill Community Choir, Conor Caldwell, our Schools and other local talent.

PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

WEEKLY OFFERING. The weekly collection on Sunday 6th September came to £2,966.10, plus £1,990 in standing orders, and the monthly collection, for the support of the priests, was ££2,794.02, plus £635 in standing orders. Online donations in August amounted to £375. Thank you for your continued generosity and support. For information on standing order and contactless methods of donation, please contact the parish office.

PARISH 100 CLUB. Week 18 winners: Charles O’Kelly, Joanne Laverty, Mary Rose McAleer & Philomena Donaldson (Promoter). Congratulations to all the winners.

WEEKDAYS MONDAY 14TH, TUESDAY 15TH & WEDNESDAY 16TH SEPTEMBER:
There will be a Gathering for the Priests of Down & Connor in Dromantine for these days. As a result, there will be **No 9.15am** Mass on these mornings. However, Deacon Brendan will be leading a Eucharistic Adoration Prayer Service and Benediction at 9.15am on each morning. The normal Mass schedule will resume on Thursday 17th September. Apologies for the inconvenience.

PIONEER ASSOCIATION IN DOWN & CONNOR. Meeting on 27th September at 3pm in Holy Family Gathering Space. Open to all Pioneers, working towards a fresh start, new energy, and renewed commitment, within our Diocese.

SONAS SUPPORT. Learning Disability Day Centre, based in the Houben Centre, at Holy Cross church. Contact 90133636 or info@sonassupport.co.uk. www.sonassupport.co.uk.

PADRE PIO MASS AND BLESSING WITH RELIC. 23rd September at 7pm, in St Vincent de Paul church, Ligoniel. Collection to support the parish of St Vincent de Paul.

THE CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY AT QUEEN’S. Sunday Mass resumes in 28 Elmwood Ave. on 20th September, at the new earlier time of 7pm. Visit qubcatholic.org.

BEGINNING EXPERIENCE. A peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. Support programme in St Bride’s Hall, Derryvolgie Ave. on 26th September, 24th October & 21st November. Booking essential. T: Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com.

BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE. *A Year of Ignatian Prayer.* Starts 26th September; Suggested donation: £200–£280. Bursaries available. Registration required. *The Chosen – Season 2.* Weekly screenings on Fridays at 10.45am. And job vacancy for *Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator*. For all, visit belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk.

NORTH BELFAST DEMENTIA CARERS SUPPORT GROUP. Meets 15th Sept. in Chichester Library at 1.15pm. Activity– Nutrition tips & info. E: niamh@reachoutni.org.

CRAOBH NAOMH PÁDRAIG IRISH/GAEILGE CLASSES, ALL LEVELS. From 16th September at 7 pm in Arás Mhic Reachtain (opposite the Waterworks). Cost per term for adults is £30. Teenagers - no cost. Term will last for 12 weeks.



REST IN PEACE

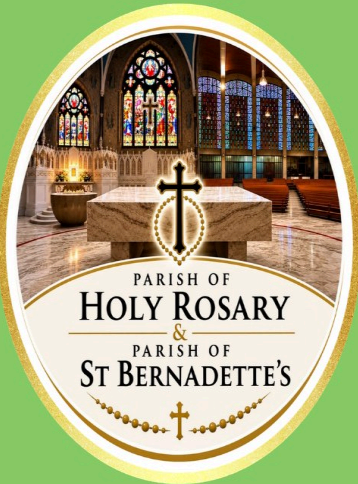
Recently Deceased: Jordan Flannery, Matilda Logan, Felicitas Kerr
Month’s Mind: Bertha Tracey
Anniversaries: Christy Matthews, John Blackham, Paul O’Neill, Bob Monahan, Vincent O’Toole, Vera Duffy, Sheila O’Brien, Kathleen McCrudden, Geraldine Hart, Molly Martin, Victor Gormley (1st), Josephine Kerr (1st), Anna & Frank Greene, Joe McCann, Mark Varini, Mary, James, Larry & John Hart, Patrick White, Joseph Catney, Rosaleen Deignan
Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord!

For more information and resources:
www.holy-familyparish.com

MASS INTENTIONS

Sat 12 (6pm):	Molly Martin
Sun 13 (9am):	For the People of the Parish
Sun 13 (10.30am):	Victor Gormley (1 st)
Sun 13 (12 Noon):	Josephine Kerr (1 st)
Mon 14:	No Mass
Tue 15:	No Mass
Wed 16:	No Mass
Thu 17:	Anna & Frank Greene
Fri 18:	Joe McCann
Sat 19 (10am):	Alfie Dowd





MASS SCHEDULE

SUNDAYS

ST BERNADETTE'S PARISH
Vigil 6.00pm & 11am

HOLY ROSARY PARISH
9am, 10.30am & 12.30pm

WEEKDAYS
St Bernadette's Parish:
Mon, Tues & Wed 9.30am
Holy Rosary Parish:
Thurs, Fri & Sat 10.00am

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION
Good Shepherd church Saturday **10.30am**
St. Bernadette's church Saturday **5.15pm**

BAPTISMS
(Prior booking via Parish Office)
Holy Rosary Church: Third Sunday of the month at 2p.m.
St Bernadette's Church: First Saturday of the month at 2p.m.

CONTACT INFORMATION

Fr. Brendan Hickland, PP (028) 90642446 (Option 1)
b.hickland@downandconnor.org

Fr. Babu Panattuparambil Vareed Assistant Priest
(028) 9079 3023.

Rev. Patrick Keown (Deacon) p.keown@downandconnor.org

Kylee (Parish Support Officer) Office Hours
Mon-Thurs 9.15a.m - 1p.m. Closed Fridays

Holy Rosary Parish Office (028) 90642446 Option 2
holyrosary@downandconnor.org

Philomena (Finance Officer) p.dawson@downandconnor.org
More Information and resources:
holyrosaryparishbelfast.net and www.st.bernadettesparish.org

COME AND SING WITH US!

St. Bernadette's Parish Choir is looking for new members! We return to our musical duties on **Sunday 6th September**, singing each week at the **11.00am Sunday Mass**, with a rehearsal beforehand.

There are no auditions, and you don't need to be an experienced singer - just someone who enjoys singing and would like to be part of our choir. We warmly welcome singers of all ages, so if you've ever thought about joining us, now is the perfect time to give it a try!

For more information, speak to Marty Lavery, our organist and choir director, or to any member of the choir.

Down and Connor Cantor Training

Adults (18+) involved in parish music are invited to take part in Cantor Training at St Joseph's Parish Centre, Dunloy. Training takes place on Saturday 3 October, 17 October and 7 November, from 10.00am to 3.00pm (registration from 9.30am). Attendance at all three days is required for commissioning as a parish cantor. To request an application form, contact your parish office.



TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

SUNDAY

6th September

Readings: A (I) ♦ Psalter: Week 3



? LIFE AFTER ALPHA ?
INVITATION TO CONTINUE THE JOURNEY
ChristLife 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' Course

When Jesus called his first Disciples he said, "Come Follow Me." He still makes that call to us today. The 'ChristLife' series is an opportunity for you to respond to that call and continue that journey you embarked upon with Alpha. **FOLLOWING CHRIST** is a 7-week course with a one day Retreat to help you grow as a disciple of Jesus. The course will commence on **TUESDAY 15 SEPTEMBER 2026 at 7:00pm** in **HOLY ROSARY PARISH CENTRE, 503 Ormeau Road, BT7 3GR**.

Each evening will follow a format similar to the Alpha Course and include a video presentation and small group discussions each evening. We will also have time for tea and coffee and a little something to eat! The evening should last no more than a couple of hours.

To register for **'FOLLOWING CHRIST'** course, please send your full name, your e-mail address and preferably your mobile telephone number to **stbrigids@downandconnor.org**

A short information video can be found here:
christlife.org/about/christlife-process/following-christ/

St Bernadette's Third World Group - Lima Mission

Father Coney and staff members from St Bernadette's Children's Centres in Lima will be speaking at St Bernadette's Masses **Sat 5th & Sunday 6th September**. Their aim is to thank the Sponsors for their continued support over many years, and at the same time promote the sustainability of the projects. The Third World Group is collecting annual sponsorship payments after both Masses this weekend and also on **12th & 13th September**. If you would like to sponsor a child within the Centres please speak to us after Mass. We will be happy to give further details. Many thanks to all sponsors for your continued support.

FÁILTE - WELCOME GROUP

There will be a get together of the group and new members in the coffee lounge (St Bernadette's parish centre) on the **13th September after 11am mass**. We are blessed to have 16 members and would be delighted if more parishioners came along to join us. You will find it to be a very worthwhile and enriching ministry to be part of. Beannacht Dia libh.

HLI Ireland

Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29th September at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

THE WEST BELFAST HISTORICAL SOCIETY

The September **Friday the 11th of September at 7.30pm** in St. Michael's Parish Centre, The September talk is entitled: "The Lusitania and the U Boat Campaign 1914 -1918" The guest speaker will be Mr Michael McConway

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required. Episode dates: **11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October**. Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie 07955 282371



PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

WEEKLY COLLECTION:

Holy Rosary: £1997.00
St. Bernadette's: £1065.52

Many thanks for your continued generosity and support

The Monthly Offering Collection for the support of the priests will be taken up this weekend, after Communion. The Building Fund Collection will be taken up next week, in Holy Rosary. Collection offering can be made by standing order or the Dona machines in the church porch.

St Bernadette's Parish Centre
for all bookings and enquiries please email:
stbernadettes@downandconnor.org

Holy Rosary Senior Citizens

Senior Citizens monthly meet-up returns after summer break on Monday 7th September at 8pm. New members very welcome.

St Bernadette's Retirement Group

St Vincent de Paul have invited us to join them for their trip to Mount Stewart on Thursday 17th September.

If you're interested please phone Frances 07800562398 or leave your name in the sacristy.

Welcome back after our beautiful summer.

We hope to see you at our next coffee morning on Wednesday 23rd September after Mass.

New members are welcome. £5 registration.

Our Thursday weekly walk: we meet at 10:15 in the church carpark. All members are welcome to join in at any time.

B.I.N.G.O is back, we're hoping for a FULL HOUSE!
18th October & 15th November



REST IN PEACE

Recently Deceased:

Georgia Ann Nugent
Joesph Rollins
Michael McKinney
Philip Smith
Edward (Teddy) Dickson
Thomas (Tommy) Napier
Patrick (Pat) McCarney
Frank Maguire
Gerald (Gerry) Henvey

Anniversaries:

Raymond Glover (6pm)
Laura Heaney (9am)
Denis Carey (10.30am)
Eileen Higgins & Paul Cavana (12.30pm)
David Carville, Joesph Woods,
Francis McGinty

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord

Parish of Blaris

Sunday 6th September 2026
The Twenty Third Sunday in Ordinary Time

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH

Masses Monday – Friday 10.00am

Saturday Vigil: 6.30pm

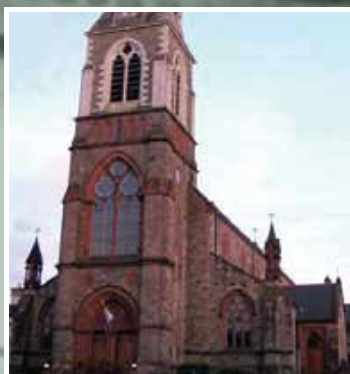
Sunday: 10.00am & 12 noon

LIVE WEBSTREAMING OF ALL MASSES

Please note many parishes in the Diocese have webcams installed which provide live coverage of various Masses taking place daily throughout the Diocese. These can be accessed by visiting www.downandconnor.org Links to Parish Webcams. Live Church webcam links: CHURCH SERVICES. TV & MCN MEDIA CHURCH WEBCAMS

*'For where two or three meet in my name,
I shall be there with them.'*

Matthew 18:20



Fr. Dermot McCaughan, PP: 028 9266 2341
Fr. Eamon Magorrian, CC: 028 9266 2348

Parish Office Opening Hours:
Monday-Friday 10.30am-4.00pm.
Closed 1.00pm-2.00pm.

Parish Office: 028 9266 0206 Fax: 028 9266 5690
Email: lisburn@downandconnor.org
Pastoral Centre: 028 9260 7110
www.parishoflisburn.org

INTRODUCTORY RITES

Congregation stands

**Entrance Hymn or
Entrance Antiphon**

PPs 118: 137, 124

All: You are just, O Lord,
and your judgement is right;
treat your servant in accord with your
merciful love.

GREETING

Priest: In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and
of the Holy Spirit.

All: Amen

Priest: Grace to you and peace from God our Father and
the Lord Jesus Christ.

All: And with your spirit.

PENITENTIAL ACT

Priest: Brothers and sisters, let us acknowledge our sins,
and so prepare ourselves to celebrate the sacred
mysteries.

All: I confess to almighty God
and to you, my brothers and sisters,
that I have greatly sinned,
in my thoughts and in my words, in what I
have done and in what I have failed to do,

Striking your breast as you say:

through my fault, through my fault,
through my most grievous fault;
therefore I ask blessed Mary ever-Virgin,
all the Angels and Saints,
and you, my brothers and sisters,
to pray for me to the Lord our God.

Priest: May almighty God have mercy on us,
forgive us our sins,
and bring us to everlasting life.

All: Amen

Lord, have mercy.
Christ, have mercy.
Lord, have mercy.

Lord, have mercy.
Christ, have mercy.
Lord, have mercy.

GLORIA

All: Glory to God in the highest,
and on earth peace to people of good will.

We praise you, we bless you,
we adore you, we glorify you,
we give you thanks for your great glory,
Lord God, heavenly King,
O God, almighty Father.

Lord Jesus Christ, Only Begotten Son,
Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father,
you take away the sins of the world,
have mercy on us;
you take away the sins of the world,
receive our prayer;
you are seated at the right hand of the Father,
have mercy on us.

For you alone are the Holy One, you alone are the
Lord, you alone are the Most High,
Jesus Christ, with the Holy Spirit, in the glory of
God the Father. Amen.

THE COLLECT

Priest: Let us pray.

Pause for silent prayer

Priest: O God, by whom we are redeemed and receive
adoption, look graciously upon your beloved sons
and daughters, that those who believe in Christ
may receive true freedom
and an everlasting inheritance.
Through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son,
who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the
Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever.

All: Amen.

THE LITURGY OF THE WORD

Congregation Sits

FIRST READING

A reading from the prophet Ezekiel

33:7-9

The word of the Lord was addressed to me as follows, 'Son
of man, I have appointed you as sentry to the House of
Israel. When you hear a word from my mouth, warn them
in my name. If I say to a wicked man: Wicked wretch, you
are to die, and you do not speak to warn the wicked man to
renounce his ways, then he shall die for his sin, but I will
hold you responsible for his death. If, however, you do
warn a wicked man to renounce his ways and repent, and
he does not repent, then he shall die for his sin, but you
yourself will have saved your life.'

All: The word of the Lord
Thanks be to God.

RESPONSORIAL PSALM

Ps 94:1-2. 6-9. R v.8

(R) O that today you would listen to his voice!
Harden not your hearts.

1. Come, ring out our joy to the Lord;
hail the rock who saves us.
Let us come before him, giving thanks,
with songs let us hail the Lord. **(R)**

2. Come in; let us bow and bend low;
let us kneel before the God who made us
for he is our God and we
the people who belong to his pasture,
the flock that is led by his hand. **(R)**

3. O that today you would listen to his voice!
'Harden not your hearts as at Meribah,
as on that day at Massah in the desert,
when your fathers put me to the test;
when they tried me, though they saw my work. **(R)**

SECOND READING

A reading from the letter of St Paul to the Romans

13.8-10

Avoid getting into debt, except the debt of mutual love. If
you love your fellow men you have carried out your
obligations. All the commandments: You shall not commit
adultery, you shall not kill, you shall not steal, you shall not
covet, and so on, are summed up in this single command:
You must love your neighbour as yourself. Love is the one
thing that cannot hurt your neighbour; that is why it is the
answer to every one of the commandments.

All: The word of the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Congregation stands

ACCLAMATION

Jn 17:17

All: Alleluia, alleluia!
Your word is truth, O Lord,
consecrate us in the truth.
Alleluia!

GOSPEL

Priest: The Lord be with you.

All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: A reading from the holy
Gospel according to Matthew

18:15-20

All: **Glory to you, O Lord.**

Jesus said to his disciples: 'If your brother does something wrong, go and have it out with him alone, between your two selves. If he listens to you, you have won back your brother. If he does not listen, take one or two others along with you: the evidence of two or three witnesses is required to sustain any charge. But if he refuses to listen to these, report it to the community: and if he refuses to listen to the community, treat him like a pagan or a tax collector.

'I tell you solemnly, whatever you bind on earth shall be considered bound in heaven; whatever you loose on earth shall be considered loosed in heaven.

'I tell you solemnly once again, if two of you on earth agree to ask anything at all, it will be granted to you by my Father in heaven. For where two or three meet in my name, I shall be there with them.'

The Gospel of the Lord.

All: **Praise to you Lord Jesus Christ.**

Congregation sits

HOMILY

Congregation stand

THE CREED

All: **I believe in one God,
the Father almighty,
maker of heaven and earth,
of all things visible and invisible.**

**I believe in one Lord Jesus Christ,
the Only Begotten Son of God,
born of the Father before all ages.
God from God, Light from Light,
true God from true God,
begotten, not made, consubstantial with the
Father; through him all things were made
For us men and for our salvation
he came down from heaven,**

(bow your head up to the words 'and became man')

**and by the Holy Spirit was incarnate of the Virgin
Mary, and became man.**

**For our sake he was crucified under Pontius
Pilate, he suffered death and was buried,
and rose again on the third day
in accordance with the Scriptures.
He ascended into heaven
and is seated at the right hand of the Father.**

**He will come again in glory
to judge the living and the dead**

and his kingdom will have no end.

**I believe in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the giver of
life, who proceeds from the Father and the Son,
who with the Father and the Son is adored and
glorified, who has spoken through the prophets.**

**I believe in one, holy, catholic and apostolic
Church. I confess one Baptism for the forgiveness
of sins and I look forward to the resurrection of
the dead and the life of the world to come. Amen.**

PRAYER OF THE FAITHFUL

Congregation sits

THE LITURGY OF THE EUCHARIST

Offertory Procession

*The gifts of bread and wine which will become the Lord's body
and blood are brought to the altar.*

The celebrant raises the host on the paten saying:

Priest: Blessed are you, Lord God of all creation,
for through your goodness we have received
the bread we offer you:
fruit of the earth and work of human hands,
it will become for us the bread of life.

All: **Blessed be God for ever.**

*The celebrant pours wine and a little water into the
chalice, saying quietly:*

Priest: By the mystery of this water and wine
may we come to share in the divinity of Christ
who humbled himself to share in our humanity.

*The celebrant then raises the chalice above the
altar and says:*

Blessed are you, Lord God of all creation,
for through your goodness we have received
the wine we offer you:
fruit of the vine and work of human hands,
it will become our spiritual drink.

All: **Blessed be God for ever.**

Bowing, the celebrant says quietly:

Priest: With humble spirit and contrite heart
may we be accepted by you, O Lord,
and may our sacrifice in your sight this day
be pleasing to you, Lord God.

Then the celebrant washes his hands, saying quietly:

Wash me, O Lord, from my iniquity
and cleanse me from my sin.

Pray, brothers and sisters, that my sacrifice and
yours may be acceptable to God,
the almighty Father.

All: **May the Lord accept the sacrifice at your hands
for the praise and glory of his name, for our
good and the good of all his holy Church.**

PRAYER OVER THE OFFERINGS

Priest: O God, who give us the gift of true prayer and of peace, graciously grant that through this offering, we may do fitting homage to your divine majesty and, by partaking of the sacred mystery, we may be faithfully united in mind and heart. Through Christ our Lord.

All: **Amen**

Congregation stands

EUCCHARISTIC PRAYER III

Priest: The Lord be with you.

All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: Lift up your hearts.

All: **We lift them up to the Lord.**

Priest: Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.

All: **It is right and just.**

PREFACE (VI of Ordinary Time)

Priest: It is truly right and just, our duty and our salvation, always and everywhere to give you thanks, Lord, holy Father, almighty and eternal God.

For in you we live and move and have our being, and while in this body we not only experience the daily effects of your care, but even now possess the pledge of life eternal.

For, having received the first fruits of the Spirit, through whom you raised up Jesus from the dead, we hope for an everlasting share in the Paschal Mystery.

And so, with all the Angels, we praise you, as in joyful celebration we acclaim:

ACCLAMATION

All: **Holy, Holy, Holy Lord God of hosts.
Heaven and earth are full of your glory.
Hosanna in the highest.
Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord.
Hosanna in the highest.**

Priest: You are indeed Holy, O Lord, and all you have created rightly gives you praise, for through your Son our Lord Jesus Christ, by the power and working of the Holy Spirit, you give life to all things and make them holy, and you never cease to gather a people to yourself, so that from the rising of the sun to its setting a pure sacrifice may be offered to your name.

Therefore, O Lord, we humbly implore you: by the same Spirit graciously make holy these gifts we have brought to you for consecration, that they may become the Body and + Blood of your Son our Lord Jesus Christ, at whose command we celebrate these mysteries.

For on the night he was betrayed he himself took bread, and, giving you thanks, he said the blessing, broke the bread and gave it to his disciples, saying:

TAKE THIS, ALL OF YOU, AND EAT OF IT,
FOR THIS IS MY BODY
WHICH WILL BE GIVEN UP FOR YOU.

In a similar way, when supper was ended, he took the chalice and, giving you thanks, he said the blessing, and gave the chalice to his disciples, saying:

TAKE THIS, ALL OF YOU, AND DRINK FROM IT,
FOR THIS IS THE CHALICE OF MY BLOOD,
THE BLOOD OF THE NEW AND ETERNAL
COVENANT, WHICH WILL BE POURED OUT FOR
YOU AND FOR MANY FOR THE FORGIVENESS
OF SINS.

DO THIS IN MEMORY OF ME.

Priest: The mystery of faith.

All: **Save us, Saviour of the world,
for by your Cross and Resurrection
you have set us free.**

Priest: Therefore, O Lord, as we celebrate the memorial of the saving Passion of your Son, his wondrous Resurrection and Ascension into heaven, and as we look forward to his second coming, we offer you in thanksgiving this holy and living sacrifice.

Look, we pray, upon the oblation of your Church and, recognising the sacrificial Victim by whose death you willed to reconcile us to yourself, grant that we, who are nourished by the Body and Blood of your Son and filled with his Holy Spirit, may become one body, one spirit in Christ.

May he make of us an eternal offering to you, so that we may obtain an inheritance with your elect, especially with the most Blessed Virgin Mary, Mother of God, with blessed Joseph, her spouse, with your blessed Apostles and glorious Martyrs with Saint Patrick and with all the Saints, on whose constant intercession in your presence we rely for unfailing help.

May this Sacrifice of our reconciliation, we pray, O Lord, advance the peace and salvation of all the world. Be pleased to confirm in faith and charity your pilgrim Church on earth, with your servant Leo our Pope and **N** our Bishop, the Order of Bishops, all the clergy, and the entire people you have gained for your own.

Listen graciously to the prayers of this family, whom you have summoned before you: in your compassion, O merciful Father, gather to yourself all your children scattered throughout the world. To our departed brothers and sisters and to all who were pleasing to you at their passing from this life, give kind admittance to your kingdom. There we hope to enjoy for ever the fullness of your glory through Christ our Lord, through whom you bestow on the world all that is good.

Priest: Through him, and with him, and in him, O God, almighty Father, in the unity of the Holy Spirit,

All: all glory and honour is yours,
for ever and ever.
Amen.

Congregation stands

THE COMMUNION RITE

Priest: At the Saviour's command
and formed by divine teaching,
we dare to say:

All: **Our Father, who art in heaven,
hallowed be thy name;
thy kingdom come,
thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our trespasses,
as we forgive those who trespass against us;
and lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.**

Priest: Deliver us, Lord, we pray, from every evil,
graciously grant peace in our days,
that, by the help of your mercy,
we may be always free from sin
and safe from all distress,
as we await the blessed hope
and the coming of our Saviour, Jesus Christ.

All: **For the kingdom, the power and the glory
are yours now and for ever.**

Priest: Lord Jesus Christ, who said to your Apostles:
Peace I leave you, my peace I give you,
look not on our sins, but on the faith of your Church,
and graciously grant her peace and unity
in accordance with your will.
Who live and reign for ever and ever.

All: **Amen.**

Priest: The peace of the Lord be with you always.
All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: May this mingling of the Body and Blood of our Lord
Jesus Christ bring eternal life to us who receive it.

All: **Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, have mercy on us.
Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, have mercy on us.
Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, grant us peace.**

Congregation kneels

The celebrant says quietly:

Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God,
who, by the will of the Father
and the work of the Holy Spirit,
through your Death gave life to the world,
free me by this, your most holy Body and Blood,
from all my sins and from every evil;
keep me always faithful to your commandments,
and never let me be parted from you.

INVITATION TO HOLY COMMUNION

Priest: Behold the Lamb of God,
behold him who takes away the sins of the world.
Blessed are those called to the supper of the Lamb.

All: **Lord, I am not worthy
that you should enter under my roof,
but only say the word
and my soul shall be healed.**

Priest: May the Body of Christ
keep me safe for eternal life.

Priest: May the Blood of Christ
keep me safe for eternal life.

COMMUNION ANTIPHON

Cf. Ps 41:2-3

All: **Like the deer that yearns for running streams,
so my soul is yearning for you, my God;
my soul is thirsting for God, the living God.**

Purifying the chalice the celebrant says quietly:

What has passed our lips as food, O Lord,
may we possess in purity of heart,
that what has been given to us in time
may be our healing for eternity.

PRAYER AFTER COMMUNION

Congregation kneels

Priest: Let us pray.
Grant that your faithful, O Lord,
whom you nourish and endow with life
through the food of your Word and heavenly
Sacrament, may so benefit from your beloved Son's
great gifts that we may merit an eternal share in his
life. Who lives and reigns for ever and ever.

All: **Amen**

THE CONCLUDING RITES

Priest: The Lord be with you.

All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: May the peace of God,
which surpasses all understanding,
keep your hearts and minds
in the knowledge and love of God,
and of his Son, our Lord Jesus Christ.

All: **Amen**

Priest: And may the blessing of almighty God,
the Father, and the Son, + and the Holy Spirit,
come down on you and remain with you for ever.

All: **Amen**

Then the celebrant, with hands joined and facing the people, says:

Priest: Go in peace.

All: **Thanks be to God.**

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We remember our beloved dead:

RECENTLY DECEASED: Mona Mulholland: Ted Rooney.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY: Cathy McMullan

ANNIVERSARIES: Pat Loughran: Matthew McKibben: Mary Wilson: Gerald (Gerry) McGrath:
Fr Denis Newberry: Ernie Gordon: Elizabeth Gallagher: Michael McGann: Gerald & Sheila Kelly:
Tommy Catney: Claire Fox: Magdalene Lagan.

THIS WEEK'S CALENDAR

Tuesday 8th September – The Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Wednesday 9th September – St Ciaran, Abbot

Saturday 12 September – The Holy Name of Mary

INDIAN CATHOLIC COMMUNITY

Mass in Syro-Malabar Rite will be celebrated in St. Patrick's Church at 3pm this afternoon, 6th September.



CHILDREN'S LITURGY will commence again on Sunday 13th September 2026 during 10am Mass. This group welcomes all children from 4-11 years of age (Primary 1 to Primary 7). Please note that you must register your child/children **BEFORE** this date. If you would like your child to be registered, there will be a registration session on **Sunday 6th September before and after 10am Mass in the Pastoral Centre**. If a child has not been registered they cannot attend. If you already registered your child last year, you do not need to re-register. Additionally, if you would like to be part of our Children's Liturgy Team of Volunteers, please contact the Parish Office. We look forward to welcoming the children back in September.

**New Suzuki Method baby/
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Contact Keri
07709495255
Suzuki Method NI

PIC • COLLAGE

SCRIPTURE GROUP resumes after our summer break on Tuesday 8th September .

We meet in the Parish Pastoral Centre every Tuesday 7:30 - 8:30 to study, discuss and reflect on the Mass readings for the following weekend.

A YEAR OF IGNATIAN PRAYER 2026-2027 – BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE

There are a few places remaining on our immersive programme in **Ignatian Spirituality**, which returns on Saturday 26th September; offering ten in person Saturdays (10am–4pm) in the BJC and seven online **Integrative Practice Pause Points** to support prayer, discernment and reflective living. Open to those new to Ignatian Spirituality and those seeking to deepen their practice. Suggested donation: **£200–£280**. Bursaries available.

For dates and registration, please visit: <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/a-year-of-ignatian-prayer-2026-2027/>

THE CHOSEN – SEASON 2 AT THE BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE

Weekly screenings of The Chosen: Season 2 will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required. Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October.

Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk

DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG

Saturday 19th September

Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake.

Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs.

BULLETIN NOTICES AND ANNIVERSARIES

Bulletin Notices should be with the Parish Office by 12 noon on Monday to be included in the weekend bulletin.

**Please note all emails to Parish Office should be addressed to –
lisburn@downandconnor.org**

**DOWN AND CONNOR DIOCESAN TRUST
BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE**

Vacancy "Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator"

The Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator will support the Director of the Belfast Jesuit Centre & Chaplain to the Ulster University, Belfast. Full details relating to the vacancy can be found on the Diocesan website at www.downandconnor.org clicking on the tab: Job Vacancies, also of the Community NI website: belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk and nijob.com

THINKING ABOUT BECOMING CATHOLIC OR WANT TO DEEPEN YOUR UNDERSTANDING OF THE FAITH?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith.

The 2025–2026 programme begins on Wednesday 1st October and runs weekly from 6.30–8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away. To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20).

The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.

All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

CALLED & GIFTED - DISCOVER YOUR SPIRITUAL GIFTS

Have you ever wondered how God might be working in your life, or what gifts He has given you to use for others? Called and Gifted is a guided process to help you discern the Spiritual gifts you received at your Baptism, and how God is calling you to use them.

We invite you to journey with others to discover:

- Who God is calling you to be: How the Holy Spirit is at work in your life
- The unique gifts you have been given to share with others.

Where?

- 120 Cliftonville Road, Belfast **When?** Saturday 26 Sept, 9.30am-4pm: Wednesday 21st Oct, 7pm-9pm: Wednesday 4th Nov, 7pm-9pm: Wednesday 18th Nov, 7pm-9pm: Saturday 5th Dec, 9.30am-4pm
- Cost: £50 per person

Attendance on all training dates is required. This training involves the use of online resources so requires access to a laptop, tablet or smartphone and a basic level of digital skills. **Please click on the link to register to attend by 11 Sept 2026.** <https://forms.cloud.microsoft/e/EbEJb01BDs> If you require further information, please contact us at: email: pathwaystothefuture@downandconnor.org Tel: (028) 9069 0920.



COFFEE MORNING

In aid of the Anthony Nolan Appeal on Sunday 13th September 10.30am – 1.30pm. Everyone welcome.

ST PATRICK'S GAC

Senior Ladies started off their Championship with an emphatic win. Next up for them is the short trip to Davitt Park to take on Davitts this evening (Sun 6th September) with throw in at 6pm.

Last weekend we had the wonderful "Festival of Football" which saw around 400 children from 15 different clubs take part in an underage tournament. Congratulations to U10.5 St Patrick's team who won the Cup.

Commiserations to the U8.5 St Patrick's team who were runners up.

Congratulations are also due to the U16 girls team who recently won the league.

This was a fantastic achievement for the girls and management team - Well done.

*Lord, may everything we do this day
begin with your blessing and continue with your help.
May everything we say this day begin with your love
and continue with your grace.
May everything we plan this day begin with your inspiration
and continue with your peace.
So that throughout our lives all that we begin in you may be happily ended,
all that we fail to do may by you be mercifully mended,
and all that we seek though you may by you be lovingly attended. Amen.
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The Loughshore Parishes



St Mary's, Greencastle; St Mary, Star of the Sea, Whitehouse;
St James', Whiteabbey & St Colman's, Greenisland



13 September 2026

24th Sunday in Ordinary Time

MASS TIMES & SERVICES

SATURDAY VIGIL

5.00pm – Star of the Sea, Whitehouse

6.30pm – St Mary's, Greencastle

SUNDAY MASS:

9.30am – St Colman's, Greenisland

11.00am – St James', Whiteabbey

WEEKDAY MASSES:

Star of the Sea, Whitehouse: Tuesday 7.00pm

St Mary's, Greencastle: Wednesday 9.30am

St Colman's: Thursday 10.00am

St James': Friday 10.00am

MORNING PRAYER & COMMUNION SERVICE

St Colman's: Monday 10.00am

ST PEREGRINE'S NOVENA:

First Monday of the month at 7.00pm in St Mary's, Greencastle

NOVENA TO MOTHER OF PERPETUAL SUCCOUR:

Every Tuesday at 7.00pm in Star of the Sea, Whitehouse

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION:

Every Wednesday in St Mary's, Greencastle 10am – 1pm

DIVINE MERCY CHAPLET:

After 10.00am Mass on Friday in St James'

DIVINE MERCY EVENING – Rosary, preaching, healing prayers and Eucharistic Adoration on the second Friday of the month 7.00pm – 9.30pm St James' Church.

LEGION OF MARY

The Legion of Mary is a lay association of pious, Marian Catholics, who specialise in both prayer and work. They meet at 7pm every Friday in St. Mary's Church, Greencastle.

BAPTISMS: Baptisms are taking place on Saturdays in St James', Whiteabbey. Please contact the parish office for further information.

Parish Priest:

Fr. David Delargy

Parish Office:

824 Shore Road Newtownabbey BT36 7DG

Tel: 0289037 0845

(open Mon – Fri 9.00am – 1.00pm)

E-mail: loughshore@downandconnor.org

website: www.loughshoreparishes.org

Links to webcam via parish website or www.churchmedia.tv

The Loughshore Parishes is a member of a Family of Parishes, comprising the parishes of St Mary's on the Hill, St Nicholas', Carrickfergus and the Loughshore Parishes (Greencastle, Whitehouse, St James' & St Colman's)

REST IN PEACE

Recently deceased: Annie Butler, John Beckett (USA)

Anniversaries: Alice Gillen née O'Rorke (4th), Mary Wilson née O'Rorke (5th), Tom Hayes, William McKernon (35th), Mary Gillen, Sean Gillen, Kathleen Gillen, Brian Privilege

MASS INTENTIONS

Saturday

Greencastle 6.30pm – Alice Gillen anniversary

LOUGHSHORE NET TEAM

We are delighted to welcome the Net Team for 2026/2027 to the Loughshore Parishes this week. We ask God to bless Simeon, Mary, Thomas, Olivia, Natalia and Christine in their ministry and look forward to all that God will do through them in the year ahead.



BLESSING OF SCHOOL BAGS

This weekend, 12th & 13th September, Fr David will be blessing the school bags of all children returning to school. We warmly invite the children and young

people of our parish to bring their school bag to any of the Vigil Masses or Sunday Masses in the parish.

We pray for our children and young people as they return to school. May God keep them in His care. May the Holy Spirit open their minds to all that is true, beautiful and good.

POPE'S PRAYER INTENTION FOR SEPTEMBER - FOR THE CARE OF WATER

Let us pray for just and sustainable management of water so that everyone may have equal access to this vital resource.  [Pray with the Pope video](#)

SEASON OF CREATION

1st September–4th October

A message from Bishop Alan on the Season of Creation is available to read on the  [parish website](#).



BAPTISM WELCOME MEETING

We invite parents considering Baptism for their child in October to join us at 7.30pm on Monday 5th October in St James' Parish Hall for

our Baptism Welcome meeting. Both parents and godparents are invited to be present. We look forward to meeting you. Refreshments provided.



The Loughshore Parishes



St Mary's, Greencastle; St Mary, Star of the Sea, Whitehouse;
St James', Whiteabbey & St Colman's, Greenisland



13 September 2026

24th Sunday in Ordinary Time

LOUGHSHORE SACRAMENTAL CLASS

Parents of children attending non Catholic schools, or children who previously missed out on making their sacraments, wishing to be prepared for sacraments in 2027 should register their interest by forwarding the following information to

loughshoresacraments@gmail.com

- **Child's name & school**

- **Preparation classes required for first penance & communion OR for confirmation.**

- **Parent or guardian's name and contact number**

Registration is open until 4th October.

First Penance and Communion classes begin on Sunday 18th October in St. James Hall at 12pm. These classes are run fortnightly until May. The cost is £30 for books and materials. Confirmation classes will not begin until after the transfer tests are completed. More information to follow.

COULD YOU HELP SHARE THE TRUE SPIRIT OF CHRISTMAS?

Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell Trócaire's Gifts of Change — meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide everything you need including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. Last Christmas, 50 parishes took part — and we'd love to grow that number even more this year! If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call 028 9080 8030.

HUMAN LIFE IRELAND Join Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29th September at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

AN EVENING OF MUSIC

Sunday 4th October at 7pm in Holy Family Church. Featuring Neil Martin, Cavehill Community Choir & friends. Tickets £10 from the Holy Family Parish Office

QUEEN'S CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY

The Catholic Chaplaincy at Queen's reopens for the new academic year on Monday 14th September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming.

Our first Sunday Mass is 20th September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Please note the new time! New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org

ABIDE WOMEN'S CONFERENCE

20th – 22nd November at the Great Northern Hotel Bundoran, Co. Donegal. Speakers include: Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Mark Wharton & more. Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, from Cork & Ross Diocese. We would love to welcome you this weekend. For more details please visit Abide in His Love at: eventbrite.ie Registration link: <https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com>

ST JAMES' HALL EVENTS

Céilí dancing will be starting back on Monday 21st September at 7.30pm. All welcome. *Bingo* will be held on Saturday 26th September at 7.30pm.



PIONEER GATHERING

Sunday 27th September - A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down & Connor will take

place on Sunday 27th September at 3.00pm in Holy Family Gathering Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast.

This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who would like to support a fresh start, new energy, and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.



EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION

Down & Connor Diocese is renewing and developing its Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes

throughout the Diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting at ONE of these venues:

- *Thursday 1st October The Parish Centre, Ballymena, 2 Broughshane Road, BT43 7DX 8pm,*

- *Friday 2nd October St Patrick's Centre, Downpatrick, Market Street, BT30 6LZ 8pm*

Registration from 7.30pm. See poster in the church for details.

CELEBRATION OF MASS AND BLESSING WITH HOLY RELIC OF SAINT PADRE PIO.

Wednesday 23rd September at 7pm. St Vincent de Paul Parish, 171 Ligoniel Road, Belfast.

Pray, Hope and Don't Worry.



SUNDAY 6TH SEPTEMBER 2026
TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
 Sunday Cycle A, Psalter Week 3



✱ MASS TIMES & LITURGIES

OUR LADY OF THE ASSUMPTION CHURCH NEWCASTLE

WEEKDAY MASSES:

Mon, Tues, Thurs, Fri at 10am

LITURGY OF THE WORD & HOLY COMMUNION: Wed & Sat 10am

WEEKEND MASSES:

Saturday Vigil Mass at 6pm & Sunday Mass at 11.30am

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH

BRYANSFORD: Open for Private Prayer Only. Open daily from 10am To 5pm

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION:

Fridays, 10.30am-5.00pm

CONFESSIONS

1st & 3rd Saturday, 3.30-4.00pm

BAPTISMS: 1st & 3rd Sat, 3-3.30pm. Book in sacristy after Mass. Bring long birth certificate

WEDDINGS: Arrange with Fr Jim after Mass. Weddings can also be arranged in St Patrick's, Bryansford.

The Parish of Maghera is a part of the Diocese of Down and Connor Trust and operates in accordance with the Diocesan policies. Registered UK Charity No. **XN46141** Charity Name: **Down and Connor Diocesan Trust**

✱ FAMILY OF PARISHES

Parish of Dundrum & Tyrella

Mon-Thurs 9.30am; Sat 10am [Dundrum];

Fri 9.30am [Ballykinlar];

Saturday Vigil 6pm [Ballykinlar];

Sunday Mass 11am (Dundrum)

Parish of Kilmegan & Kilcoo

St. Malachy's Church, Castlewellan

Mon, Tues, Thurs, Fri 9.30am

Saturday Vigil 5pm

Sunday 10am

[Kilcoo]; Sat Vigil 5pm & Sun

Mass 10.00am (Kilcoo);

Mon 9.30am; Wed-Fri 9.30am

Tues 9.30am [Aughlinsnafin]

✱ CONTACT DETAILS

PARISH PRIEST: FR JIM CRUDDEN

Parochial House 24 Downs Road Newcastle 028 437 22401

PARISH MANAGER: BRENDA WEBB

Parochial House 24 Downs Road Newcastle 07840 028461

emails: b.webb@downandconnor.org / brennda@parishofmaghera.com

PARISH SUPPORT & FINANCE

OFFICER: VIRGINIA HUGHES

(On annual leave)

Parish Office, Parochial House, 24 Downs Road, Newcastle, BT33 0AG. Tel: 028 437 22401

Office Hours: Tue-Fri 10am-1pm (Closed Monday). Emails:

Newcastle@downandconnor.org / parishoffice@parishofmaghera.com

Web: www.parishofmaghera.com

FB: Parish of Maghera D&C

To access the Parish webcam:

<https://www.mcn.live/camera/our-lady-of-the-assumption-church-newcastle>

SACRISTANS: STEPHEN BODEN /

ANTHONY CREELMAN

Tel: 028 4372 7691 (after Mass)

PARISH SHOP: EUGENE SMALL

14 Main Street - 028 4372 3399

Opening Time: Mon, Tue, Thu, Fri, Sat - 10.30am-4.30pm (Closed Wednesday)

ROOM/HALL HIRE: PARISH CENTRE

& ST PATRICK'S HALL: EAMON

LENEGHAN / JOE DUGGAN -

Office at 14 Main Street Tel: 028

4372 3399, Office Hours Mon,

Wed & Fri 9.30am-1.30pm

Email: newcastlebookings@downandconnor.org

SAFEGUARDING. If you have a concern, suspicion or wish to report an allegation of abuse,

please contact: Philip O'Hara,

Diocesan Designated Liaison

Person, 120 Cliftonville Rd,

Belfast BT14 6LA Tel: 07534991124

E: philip.ohara@soddc.org

SVT IF YOU ARE IN NEED OF HELP

Please Contact the St Vincent

de Paul Helpline: 07889780330 or

Lifeline on: 0808 808 8000

✱ MINISTRY OF WELCOME

RECENTLY BAPTISED

Cian Nina / Callan Michael / Rosie Mae / Niamh Christina

BEREAVEMENT MINISTRY

Please remember in your prayers:

RECENTLY DECEASED: Danny Dennon

/ Cathal McKibbin

ANNIVERSARIES: Derek Murphy /

Catherine Kane / Teresa

McCrickard / Deacon Mark

Leneghan

✱ MASS INTENTIONS

SAT, 5TH - 13TH SEPTEMBER 2026

Sat, 5th 6pm Sheila McEvoy

Sun, 6th 11.30am Fiona, Margaret

& Seamus McKibbin / Thomas &

Anne Walsh / Peter O'Hara /

Annie McQuillan

Mon, 7th 10am Gabrielle Kerr

Fri, 11th 10am Madeleine Blaney

Sat, 12th 6pm Mary McKibbin /

John Harbinson

Sun, 13th 6pm Joseph McFall

"May their souls and the souls of all the

faithful departed rest in peace."

✱ SANCTUARY CANDLES

This week's Sanctuary Candles will

burn for: Fiona, Margaret &

Seamus McKibbin

✱ OFFERTORY COLLECTIONS

16 Aug 2026: £2390.82, Standing

Order: £671.83, Total: £3062.65,

Diocesan Cathedral Fund:

£339.45, Standing Order: £55,

Total: £394.45, Diocesan

Sundries collection (additional)

£464, Holy Day: £703.01. **23 Aug**

2026: £2397.92, Standing Order:

£671.83, Total: £3069.75. **30 Aug**

2026: £2253.95, Standing Order:

£671.83, Total: £2925.78,

Diocesan Sundries collection:

(additional) £427.05, Thank you.

Pope Leo's prayer intention.

September 2026: Water

Management - Let us pray for a

just and sustainable management

of water, a vital resource, so that

everyone may have equal access

to it.

DONATE TO
THE PARISH



PRAYER
PETITION



SCAN QR CODES WITH
YOUR PHONE CAMERA TO:

PARISH
CENTRE / HALL



PARISH
FORMS





VISIT OUR PARISH WEBSITE
www.ourladyqueenofpeacekilwee.com

Parish Office Contact Numbers and Email Addresses

Christ the Redeemer	02890309011	christtheredeemer@downandconnor.org
Derriaghy	028 92660073	derriaghy@downandconnor.org
Nativity	028 90625739	nativity@downandconnor.org
OLQP	028 90616300	ourladyqueenofpeace@downandconnor.org
St Luke's	028 90625739	stlukes@downandconnor.org
St Anne's	02890610112	stannes@downandconnor.org

Pope Leo's prayer intentions for September: For the care of water.

Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.



The Sacrament of Baptism in Our Lady Queen of Peace will be on the **second Saturday of each month at 2.30pm.**

All parents are required to attend a Pre Baptism meeting which is held on the third Tuesday of each month at 7pm in St Colman's.

KNIT & NATTER: Our Lady Queen of Peace Knit & Natter each Wednesday in the Conference room of the Church 10.30-12pm. All new members welcome.

If there is anyone in the parish who is **sick and housebound** and would like a priest to visit, please contact the parish office or email kilweeparish@gmail.com

DIVINE MERCY DEVOTIONS with Adoration & Confession 7-8pm
Nativity Thursday 24th September 2026 Everyone Welcome



DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG - Saturday 19th September

Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm. The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Tele. St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs..

TO MAKE A DONATION TO THE PARISH PLEASE VISIT OUR WEBSITE
ourladyqueenofpeacekilwee.com **DONATE BUTTON**

If you require a box of envelopes, please contact the Parish Office 90616300

BEGINNING EXPERIENCE The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com



ANNIVERSARIES

Patrick & Geraldine McCabe and Margaret & Edward Howell

We pray for those whose anniversaries occur around this time

Eternal rest grant unto them O Lord and may perpetual light shine upon them

URGENT APPEAL for volunteers to give up a little of their time on the **3rd Saturday of each month** to help with the **Church Housekeeping**. If you could give some time to this very necessary work, please contact the parish office 90616300.

HOLY RELIC OF ST PADRE PIO

Celebration of Mass and Blessing with Holy Relic of St Padre Pio Wednesday 23rd September 2026 at 7pm. Saint Vincent De Paul Parish 171 Ligoniel Rd, Belfast BT14 8DP
There will be a collection to support the Parish of St. Vincent De Paul.

COULD YOU HELP SHARE THE TRUE SPIRIT OF CHRISTMAS? Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell **Trócaire's Gifts of Change** — meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. **We provide everything you need** including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call **028 9080 8030**.

PIONEER GATHERING – Sunday 27 September

A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down & Connor will take place on: Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast. This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who would like to support a fresh start, new energy, and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

CATHOLIC MEN'S RETREAT - Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at **Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.** The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

THE DIOCESAN RCIA - (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults)

It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect. The 2026—2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23rd September and runs weekly from 6.30 pm to 8.00pm in St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. To find out more, scan the QR code to visit our information page, or email cia@downandconnor.org to register.



MAY THEY REST IN PEACE

We remember those whose anniversaries occur at this time:

Tracey McGerr (Month's Mind Mass, Saturday, 5th September 6pm),

Seamus Mc Carry (Anniversary Mass, Saturday 12th September 6pm),

Frank Mc Grogan, Kathleen McAleese, Annie McAteer, Rose McTaggart.

MINISTERS OF THE WORD

SATURDAY 12TH SEPT CARMEL CLARKE

SUNDAY 13TH SEPT ANTOINETTE CUSHNAHAN

SATURDAY 19TH SEPT BRIGID McDONNELL

SUNDAY 20TH SEPT DAMIAN McALLISTER

MINISTERS OF THE EUCHARIST

SATURDAY 12TH SEPT BERNIE McKENNA, SHAUNA O'BOYLE, CATHERINE McILFATRICK

SUNDAY 13TH SEPT GED KING, PATRICK CAREY, PATRICK ROGERS

SATURDAY 19TH SEPT MM DUFFIN, CAROLINE

PARISH OF PORTGLENONE**TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN****ORDINARY TIME****Mass Times**

There will be Mass on Monday to Thursday at 9.30am. There will be Mass on Friday evening 7.00pm. A period of Eucharistic Adoration from 6.00pm until 6.50pm will precede Friday's Evening Mass.

Parish Collections

The Weekly Offering amounted to **£1315.90**. The Building Fund account for the month of August amounted to **£1782.00**

Collectors for September

VIGIL MASS: Cheryl-Ann Storey, Richard Convery, Brendan Graham, Patsy Boyd

11.00AM: Kieran Loughlin, Seamus McErlean, Malachy Graham, Damian McAllister

Rotas for September

The rota for the month of September for Eucharistic Ministers and Ministers of the Word is displayed on the notice board at the back of the Church. If you are not available, please contact the Parish Office.

St Vincent de Paul Helpline: 07521034424

Father Rooney's Contact No: 07739 223 313

Portglenone CCE

Portglenone CCE will have a Registration and Open Evening for their Traditional Music Classes on Monday, 7th September 2026 from 7.00pm until 8.00pm. Classes commence on Monday, 14th September. For further information, flyers are

Family Mass

We plan to continue the Family Mass on the last Sunday of each month. A few of our younger readers and Eucharistic Ministers have now moved away to third-level education or to jobs elsewhere. So, we need new young volunteers to read or to do the Offertory procession etc. Anyone interested, please come and give your details to any PPC member or to the Parish Office.

The Revived Assisted-Suicide Bill

The revived assisted suicide Bill brought back by Lauren Edwards MP faces its second reading on Friday 11th September. The vote on this date can be won. Several MPs have already expressed reservations about bringing it back or forcing it through Parliament. The Prime Minister has now said the debate should wait until palliative and social care are properly funded. MPs from Northern Ireland will have the opportunity to vote on this Bill. If assisted suicide is legalised in England and Wales, this would again put pressure on NI to follow suit. One of the most effective



ST. PATRICK'S BALLYPHILIP
TWENTY-FOURTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
Sunday 13th September 2026



Fr Feargal McGrady PP Tel: 028 427 28234 Web: www.portaferryparish.com
Email: portaferry@downandconnor.org Livestream: www.churchmedia.tv
Parish Office: 028 427 28373, Monday – Friday 9.00am – 1.00pm

Parish Bereavement Ministry

This group offers support for anyone experiencing bereavement. If you would like to talk to a member please Telephone: 07564293692

ST PATRICK'S COMMUNITY CENTRE CONTACTS:
MADELINE DYNES 07999945936 & JAMES MAGEE 07542530006
During Business Hours

	St Patrick's Portaferry	St Cooley's Oratory	St Patrick's Ballygalget
Sunday 13 th September TWENTY-FOURTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME	11am Mass		9.30am Mass
Monday 14 th September The Exaltation of the Holy Cross		7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Novena Mass	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Tuesday 15 th September Our Lady of Sorrows			9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Wednesday 16 th September St Cornelius. St Cyprian		7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Mass	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Thursday 17 th September St Hildegard. St Robert Bellarmine			9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Friday 18 th September	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass	Eucharistic Adoration 11.00am – 6.00pm	7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Mass
Saturday 19 th September St Januarius	5.45pm Adoration 6.30pm Vigil Mass		5.00pm Vigil Mass

Our prayers are requested for the happy repose of the soul of Joe Kelly, recently deceased and for the following whose anniversaries occur around this time: Paddy Smyth, Dominic Pucci, Oliver Lynch, Abi Rogers, James & Mary McGrath, Robert & Mary Moore, Ellie McDonnell, John Smyth, Charles Denvir, Sammy Denvir, Annie Mason, Peter Grant, Letitia Lennon, Mary McCluskey, Jean McCormick.

May their souls and the souls of all the faithful departed, rest in peace, Amen.

ROSARY IN ST. COORY'S ORATORY: on Tuesday 15th September at 7pm,
in honour of Our Lady of Sorrows.



MASS INTENTIONS

Saturday 12th September: **Paddy Smyth, Dominic Pucci**

Sunday 13th September: **Oliver Lynch**

Monday 14th September: **James & Mary McGrath, Robert & Mary Moore, Ellie McDonnell, John Smyth**

Saturday 19th September: **Johnny & Pauline McCarthy, Maeve & Joey Crangle, Noreen Murray**

Sunday 20th September: **Elaine McVeigh (First Anniversary)**

The Bereaved of the Community will be remembered in a special way at Mass on Wednesday 16th September in St Cooley's Oratory at 7.30pm. Everyone is invited for a cup of tea and chat in the Parish Office afterwards.

The Apostolic Workers would like to thank all the parishioners who donated so generously, sponsoring sacred vessels and gave to our church door collection.

We have raised the magnificent amount of £4,264.00

Your sponsorship and donations for the last year 2025 went to Missions in Kenya, Nigeria and Zimbabwe. Again, thank you for your kindness and generosity.

Children's Liturgy

The new term of Children's Liturgy begins at the Masses weekend 27th and 28th September.

We look forward to welcoming primary school children from P1 upwards.

A consent form must be completed and signed by a parent or guardian before attending.

Forms are available in the main porch of St Patrick's and may be returned to a member of the Children's Liturgy team or to the parish office.



If you are having difficulties with your expenses ring our confidential telephone: 07508 549701. We can help. Thank you for your support and generosity.

Weekly Offering: £1,426.00 Weekly Standing Orders for August: £1,461.00

Monthly Offering: £1,488.00. Monthly Standing Orders for August: £270.00

Cathedral Fund: £928.00. Building & Cemetery Fund: £1,381.00.

Thank you for your continued support and generosity.



PORTAFERRY AND BALLYGALGET BAPTISM MINISTRY

Baptism Information sessions will begin after Halloween. Dates will depend on Baptisms that are booked via the Parish office.

Parents/ Guardians/ Godparents and Grandparents will be invited to attend. The information sessions will be:

- Short
- Informal
- Explain the rite of Baptism
- Provide refreshments
- Provide a welcome gift for each child.

Over the next few weeks, we will be setting up 'Baptism trees' in St Patrick's Portaferry and St Patrick's Ballygalget beside the Baptismal fonts. The name of each child to be baptised will be hung on the tree as a welcoming gesture from our Parish communities.

May the time of preparation for Baptism be filled with peace, gratitude and the loving presence of God in our families.

The Folk Group would welcome new members, young (from P6) and anyone else who enjoys music and singing and might like to try out being part of a choir.
Anyone interested in joining us please come along any Sunday and learn as you go.
Contact Bernie Doran on 078 4992 7581 or Lorna Spence on 078 5064 8091.

HARVEST SERVICE in Portaferry Methodist Church, Sunday 27th September at 7pm, Rev Alan Wardlow, the Past President of the Methodist Church in Ireland will lead the service alongside other local church leaders. A joint churches choir will help us in our music as we thank God for his goodness to us.
Light refreshments provided after the service.
Food or financial gifts will be welcome but must be shelf stable goods that will be donated to the local Food Bank. These can be brought to the church Sat morning 26th at 09:30-10:30am or brought on Sunday evening to the service.



Notices for the parish bulletin need to be with the parish office by Wednesday 12noon.
Anniversary notices can be left in the anniversary boxes in either church,
(Boxes beside the candle shrines), sent by email, or rang into the office.

St Mary's Primary School & Nursery Unit, Portaferry. Could You Spare an Hour?

As we begin another new school year, St Mary's Primary School & Nursery Unit is seeking volunteers from our parish and wider community to help enrich the lives of our children. Whether you could support reading, maths activities, sports coaching, art, languages, gardening or simply share a skill, hobby or life experience, even a small amount of your time can make a meaningful difference.
If you can spare one hour a week, one hour a month, or help with a particular project, we would love to hear from you.
Contact the school on 028427 28278 or email pgilchrist570@c2kni.net

Share your time. Share your talents. Help our children learn, grow and shine.

BALLYGALGET, PORTAFERRY & ARDKEEN PARISHES
A Great Day Out for Friends, Family & Our Parish Community!
Day Out
FAITH, HERITAGE & COMMUNITY
Explore. Experience. Enjoy Together.

A SHEPHERD'S LIFE AT GLENSHANE COUNTRY FARM
SHEEP SHEARING DEMONSTRATION
Step into the past and experience life on the farm. Watch a live sheep shearing demonstration and see working sheepdogs, hold baby lambs and more.

THE GORTA EXPERIENCE AT FRIELS
THE GORTA EXPERIENCE
A powerful and moving visitor experience that brings the story of the Great Famine to life.

DINNER AT FRIELS BAR & RESTAURANT, SWATRAGH
Relax and enjoy a delicious 3-course dinner in the warm and welcoming surroundings of Friels.

TRAVEL IN COMFORT WITH CONNECTIONS IRELAND
✓ Modern, luxury coach
✓ Air conditioning
✓ Spacious seating
✓ Friendly, professional driver

PRICE: £60 PER PERSON
Includes coach travel, all admissions & 3-course dinner

FULLY GUIDED THROUGHOUT THE DAY
Our day out will be fully guided throughout by a professional tour guide accredited by Tour Guides Northern Ireland.

TOUR GUIDES NORTHERN IRELAND

DATE: THURSDAY 24 SEPTEMBER 2026
DEPARTURE: LEAVING PORTAFERRY SQUARE AT 9.00 AM SHARP
RETURN: APPROX. 6.00 PM
WHO CAN JOIN? Open to everyone in the Parishes of Ballygalget, Portaferry & Ardkeen.

TO SECURE YOUR PLACE CONTACT:
SEAMUS DORRAN
ON 07813968171

ALL PLACES ALLOCATED ON A FIRST COME FIRST SERVED BASIS.
Don't miss out - book early to avoid disappointment!

Together in Faith. Together in Community.

THIS SUNDAY !!!
Abi's Butterfly Breeze 2026
In memory of Abi... ...for Memories for you

13th September at 1pm
Medals and chipped timing entry
£20 entry 10k
£10 entry 5k
Route starts at Portaferry GAC

The money raised through Abi's Butterfly Breeze Portaferry 10K will help support Bright Future, Inspire's counselling service for young people set up in memory of Abi.

INSPIRE
Mindfulness. Mental. Recovery.

SCAN ME



St. Patrick's Community Centre, Portaferry

Bingo this Sunday 13th September at 3pm in aid of Air Ambulance.

Mon. Tea/ Chat, Gentle Exercise, Whist, Quiz, Light. Lunch 11.00am Text 07873284252
Bridge 2pm. **Ferry Fit** 6.45pm. **Tin Whistle for Beginners** 7.00pm beginning Mon. 14th
Sept. Text 07542530006. **Ferry Fit** 7.45pm
Tin Whistle for Improvers 7. 50pm beginning Mon. 14th Sept. TEXT 07542530006

Tues. Portaferry Crafters (Textiles) 10.30am Text 07999945936
Ceili Dancing 7.15pm Text 07395200128
Ukulele Beginners 6.30pm; Improvers 7.15pm Text 07999945936

Wed. Gently Does It 9.30am (Gently Does It) Text 07999945936
Judo 5.00pm Text 07929905310

Thurs. Community Centre Singers 10.30am Text 07999945936
Jo Jingles 12.00pm Text 07395200128
The Hive (Arts & Crafts) 12.30pm Text 07999945936
"Painting Portraits" beginning 24th Sept. 7pm. Text 07542530006 for Registration
Ferry Film Club (Last Thursday in the month) 7.00pm
Ferry Fit 8.00pm

Fri. Party Dance 9.30am Text 07999945936
Walking Group 11.00am
Netball for P5 to Year 10 6.00pm to 7.00pm Text 07542530006

Sat. Flower Arranging (1st Sat of each month) 12 noon text 07999945936

See our Face Book page for further details: Stpatricksccommunitycentreportaferry
or text the relevant number with your details and the activity which interests you.
To hire any of our six rooms, please text 07542530006 or 07999945936

BAPTISMS: Portaferry Parish: 2nd & 4th Sunday of the month

Ballygalget Parish: 1st & 3rd Sunday

Please book with the parish office, (**Not the parochial house.**) Portaferry: 02842728373

Mon - Fri 9am - 1pm. Ballygalget: 07398623134 Wed or Fri 9am - 1pm.

A copy of your child's Birth Certificate (Long version) is required prior to Baptism date.

QUEEN'S CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY – WE'RE BACK!

The Catholic Chaplaincy at Queen's reopens for the new academic year on Monday 14 September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming.

Our first Sunday Mass is 20 September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Please note the new time!

New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org and on our socials. Staff and alumni are always welcome too.

Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions or candle lighting — and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!

Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith.

The 2026–2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23rd September and runs weekly from 6.30–8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants.

All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away.

To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org or scan the QR code.



Pioneer Gathering – Sunday 27 September

A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down & Connor will take place on:

Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast.

This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who would like to support a fresh start, new energy, and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

Beginning Experience – Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November and would be most grateful if you could include the following information in your Church Bulletin at your earliest convenience.

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Poetry & Presence: [Link to Poetry & Presence Flyer](#)

Poetry & Presence begins on Thursday 1 October at 7pm in the **Belfast Jesuit Centre**, opening with the theme of **Water** in this **Season of Creation**. You're invited into a quiet, reflective evening of poetry, art, music, and Scripture: a space to pause, breathe, and let the imagery of water in God's story speak to the depths of your own heart.

 Thursday 1 October  7.00pm  Belfast Jesuit Centre

To register, visit <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/poetry-presence/>

Hybrid Book Launch: [Link to Book Launch Flyer](#)

The **Belfast Jesuit Centre** will host a special hybrid book launch on **Monday 19 October at 7.00pm** for **Conquest or Leaven: Reflections of a Catholic Priest in Palestine/Israel** by **Fr David Neuhaus SJ**.

Join us for a short talk from the author, a guided conversation, and live Q&A with Fr Neuhaus who will join us via live video link. His story - from South African Jewish roots to Christian faith and Jesuit ministry in the Holy Land - offers a powerful and unique perspective on justice, peace, and human dignity.

 Books will be available at a discounted rate.  Visit <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/hybrid-book-launch-conquest-or-leaven-by-david-neuhaus-sj/> to register. We look forward to welcoming you to this thoughtful and urgent conversation.



13th September 2026

THE PARISHES OF PORTSTEWART, PORTRUSH & BUSHMILLS & ST. MALACHY’S COLERAINE

North Connor Pastoral Community

Fr Kevin McGuckien PP Telephone: 028 7083 2534 Email: k.mcguckien@downandconnor.org
TWENTY FOURTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME



Sunday A / Psalter Week 4

MASS TIMES

STAR OF THE SEA CHURCH, PORTSTEWART

TUESDAY: 7.00pm
WEDNESDAY – FRIDAY: 9.30am
SATURDAY VIGIL MASS: 4.30pm
SUNDAY MASS: 10.00am

CHILDREN’S LITURGY AT 10.00AM MASS

CONFESSION:

SATURDAY: 4.00pm
EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION - THURSDAY 10am-5pm

ST. MALACHY’S CHURCH, COLERAINE

TUES, THURS, FRI & SAT: 10.00am
SUNDAY MASS: 11.30am & 5.00pm

CONFESSION:

SATURDAYS: After 10.00am Mass
SUNDAYS: 4.30-4.50pm

ST. PATRICK’S CHURCH, PORTRUSH

FRI: 10.30am
SUNDAY MASS: 12 Noon

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION - FRIDAY 11am-1pm

OUR LADY & ST PATRICK’S CHURCH, BALLYMONEY

MON & WED: 10.00am
FRIDAY: 7.00pm
SATURDAY VIGIL MASS: 6.00pm
SUNDAY MASS: 9.30am

DOWN & CONNOR DIOCESAN RETREAT

The priests of the Diocese of Down and Connor will be on retreat for a few days this week. The retreat will be held in Dromantine Retreat Centre outside Newry. Please keep all the priests of the Diocese in your prayers. **Please note there will be NO MASS in Portrush on Monday or Tuesday of this week.**

COLLECTIONS

PORTSTEWART

Last weekend’s Collections: Weekly Offering: £1686
Monthly Offering: £1117
Our account details are: Portstewart Parish
Sort Code: 95-04-28 Account number: 91011049

PORTRUSH

Last weekend’s Collections: Weekly Offering: £399
Monthly Offering: £364
Our account details are: Portrush Parish
Sort Code: 95-06-79 Account number: 00254207

ST. MALACHY’S COLERAINE

Last weekend’s Collections: Weekly Offering: £1202
Monthly Offering: £751
Our account details are: St Malachy’s Church
Sort Code: 90-48-00 Account number: 88609151

THANK YOU FOR YOUR SUPPORT AND GENEROSITY!

PORTSTEWART

Parish Support Officer: 028 7083 2534
Email: portstewart@downandconnor.org
Parish Office Hours: Mon 9.00am -1.00pm
Tues 2.00pm-5.00pm, Wed & Fri: 9.00am – 5.00pm

REST IN PEACE

RECENT: Dr. James Harley, Jody Campbell, Paul O’Neill, Sean Hughes, Mary Convery, Marion Getty RIP
ONE MONTH AGO: Stacey McLaughlin RIP
ANNIVERSARIES: James Campbell, Pat Hendrick, Roisin McCarron, Aaron Lundy, Patrick McNicholl, Tony O’Connor, John Mullan, Paddy McGarry, Susan McGarry, Joseph McGarry, Gertrude Trainor, James Trainor, Ann-Marie Nash, Phyllis Marshall, Janet Kennedy, Nan McCorriston, Marino McGowan RIP
The Month’s Mind Mass will be celebrated for Dr. James Harley next Saturday 19th at 4.30pm Vigil Mass and for Paul O’Neill on Sunday 20th at 10.00am Mass.

NEXT WEEKEND – 19 & 20 SEPT (PORTSTEWART)

VIGIL MASS: 4.30pm

Minister of the Word: Clíodhna Rae
Eucharistic Ministers: Margaret McQuillan, Martina Murphy, Alison Rankin/Deirdre McCann
SUNDAY MASS: 10.00am
Minister of the Word: Paddy Mulvenna
Eucharistic Ministers: Mary McKenna*, Seamus O’Hara*, Margaret Conway*, Brian Lenehan

COLERAINE

Email: coleraine@downandconnor.org
Parish Office: Thurs: 9.00 – 5.00pm
REST IN PEACE

RECENT: Vincent McGuigan, Roisin Ward, Eileen Morrison, Suzanne McEvoy, Marion Getty RIP
ANNIVERSARIES: Patrick McWilliams, Augustine Taggart, Veronica Taggart, Vonnice Clerkin, George Orr, Gemma McCullough RIP

PORTRUSH

Fr Patrick Delargy: 028 7082 3388
Email: portrush@downandconnor.org
PARISH OFFICE: Tuesday – 9.00am-1.00pm
NEXT SUNDAY – 20 SEPT (PORTRUSH) 12.00 Noon
Minister of the Word: Stephen O’Neill
Eucharistic Minister: Rose Minihan
REST IN PEACE

RECENT: Leanne Cosgrove, Jim Devine, Denis Dickson RIP
ANNIVERSARIES: James Campbell, Brian Minihan, Marino McGowan, Phyllis Marshall, Ann-Marie Nash RIP

FAMILY OF PARISHES SAFEGUARDING COMMITTEE

The next meeting of committee is Wed 16th Sept at 7pm in Marian Hall, Portstewart. All members are asked to attend.

ANGELS AND SAINTS PROGRAMME PORTRUSH

We’re all familiar with angels and saints in our Liturgy, private prayers and in Scripture. Fr. Paddy invites you to attend a short programme exploring the wider importance of ‘Angels and Saints’ in our faith, based around the book of the same title. (Cost £11.99)
Programme Details: Thursday 8th October – Thursday 12th November – 6 weeks from 7pm-8.30pm in St. Patrick’s Hall, Portrush. To register for the programme and to reserve a book, please contact Kieran Hill at kc.hill@btinternet.com
Tel: 07964287839

HEALTHY AND SMART CHILDREN FOUNDATION

Dr Christian will be making an appeal for his charity at Masses in Portrush and Ballymoney this weekend. Fund raising for the GOD’S GIFT OF SIGHT project, to provide free cataract surgeries for 100 blind people and 3,000 pairs of glasses for poor people in churches and communities in Nigeria.
Charity Name: Healthy And Smart Children Foundation
Bank Name: Charity Aid Foundation Bank
Account Number: 73016017 **Sort code:** 405240
www.healthysmartchildren.org



ST. PATRICK’S INDOOR BOWLING CLUB

Commences Sunday 13th September at 7.00 pm in St. Patrick’s Hall, Portrush. New Members Welcome!

FAMILY OF PARISHES YOUTH GROUP RETURNS

The Youth Group Returns on Sat 19th Sept. after 4.30pm Mass from 5.30-7.30pm in the Marian Hall, Portstewart. New members welcome. Open to all secondary school aged children. Looking forward to seeing our young people returning and meeting new friends. Join us for Friendship, Faith, Fun and Pizza! 🍕🍕



ART CLASSES

Our Art classes start back in the St. Mary’s, Star of the Sea Parish Centre, Portstewart on Mon 21st Sept from 11.00am-1.00pm & and on Wed 23rd Sept from 7 30pm-9 30 pm. Anyone wanting to join the classes, please come along. You will be very welcome! 😊 Phone 07877136638.

PORTSTEWART CHILDREN’S CHOIR

Choir practice after 10.00am Mass on Sun 13th Sept.!

PARISH PASTORAL COUNCIL MEETINGS

Portrush: Thurs 17th Sept at 7pm in Parochial House
Coleraine: Sun 20th Sept at 12.30pm in Parochial House
Portstewart: Thurs 24th Sept at 7pm in Marian Hall

SAM HENRY WEEKEND FUNDRAISER – SETS CÉILÍ

A traditional Irish Céilí in the heart of Portrush today, Sunday 13th September from 3pm-6pm in St. Patrick’s Hall, 112 Causeway Street, Portrush. Music by Duntally Céilí Band. Fear an Tí: Ronan Eastwood. Supper Provided. Admission is £10/€12. Proceeds in aid of Sam Henry Weekend & local charities. For more info contact Pat: 07511480074 / email: northcoastrad@gmail.com

LITTLE STARS’ BABY AND TODDLER GROUP

Each Tuesday from 10am-11.30am in St. Mary’s, Star of the Sea Parish Centre, Portstewart. All are welcome!

FLAME CLUB: ST. MARY’S, STAR OF THE SEA PARISH CENTRE

Each Friday from 6-8pm for children 6 yrs. old & over. All are welcome! Contact Emer for more info: 07709043921.

BLESSING OF ANIMALS

Once again, our Family of Parishes will be marking the Church’s Season of Creation with a blessing of pets and animals. This year the blessing takes place in the grounds of Our Lady & St Patrick’s in Ballymoney on Sunday 27th September at 2pm. All welcome to attend.

PILGRIMAGES TO KNOCK SHRINE

LEGION OF MARY ANNUAL PILGRIMAGE
Sunday 27th September 2026
Coach leaves Dunloy Parish Centre: 7am
St. Malachy’s Church Carpark pickup: 7.20am
Returning by 9.30pm
Information & booking: **07919354256**

FAMILY OF PARISHES PILGRIMAGE
Saturday 3rd October
Led by Fr Kevin
Pickups: Ballymoney, Portrush, Portstewart & Coleraine — approx. 7am
Return: approx. 10.30 at pickup locations
£35 per adult • £10 per child under 18
Book: **07724092063**

We are blessed to be able to offer two opportunities to our parish community to honour Our Blessed Mother Mary. Parishioners are warmly invited to join either pilgrimage, depending on what suits your schedule and spiritual needs. Both are beautiful opportunities to enjoy time away from the noise and busyness of our lives and immerse ourselves into a day of prayer and reflection.

ST COLUM’S PRIMARY SCHOOL OPENING OF YEAR MASS

The Opening of the School Year Mass for St. Colum’s Primary School will be held in St. Mary’s, Star of the Sea Church, Portstewart on **Friday 18th September at 10.30am.** Family, friends and parishioners are all invited to join us.



SACRED HEART PARISH
Sunday 6th September 2026
23rd of Ordinary Time



Deacon: Joe Baxter

Parish Office: 1B Glenview Street, Belfast, BT14 7DP
Email: sacredheart@downandconnor.org
Phone: 028 9075 1543
Emergency Phone Number: 07427189388
Hours open: 9am-2pm , Mon, Tues, Wed, Fri
Parish Support Officer: Cathy Carroll
Sacristan: Collette Delaney
Acolyte: Thomas Liddy
Parish Webpage: <https://www.sacredheartparishbelfast.com>
Webcam [sacredheartparishbelfast.com/Webcam](https://www.sacredheartparishbelfast.com/Webcam)

~Mass Times~

Saturday Vigil: 6.00pm: Vigil

Sunday Masses: 9.30am: Patrick McKeever, Anniversary Mass
11.30am: Fr Newberry, Anniversary Mass

Weekday Masses: Monday 11.30am John Donnelly RIP, Funeral Mass
Tuesday 7.00pm: Novena Angela Fox, Anniversary Mass
Wednesday 10.00am: Kevin Cassidy, Month's Mind Mass

Confessions & Adoration: Saturday: 5.00pm - 6.00pm.
Divine Mercy: Friday 2.15pm, Exposition, Prayer and Confessions

~Sacrament of Baptism~
Baptisms are held on the 1st & 3rd Sundays of each month, at 12.30pm.
Please contact the parish office to arrange a baptism.

~Sacrament of Marriage~
Please contact the Parish Office to arrange.

~Upcoming Feast Days~
5th September
St Teresa of Kolkata
8th September
Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary
9th September
St Ciaran

**~Recently Deceased~**
John Donnelly
Siobhan Walker
Mary Johnson
Martin Dunlop
Danny Deeds
Patrick Pryor
Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord

~Anniversaries~
Kera Crawford
Christine Donnelly (nee Burns)
Bill Winter
Peggy Winter
Sean Winter
Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord

~Sanctuary Candles~
Mary Johnson
Charles Grant
Thomas McCrudden
Annie Brady
Colette Donaldson
The MacQuillan Family
A Donation of £5 per candle is greatly appreciated

~Baptisms~
Welcome into our community
Theo Wallace
Caoimhin Og Corr

~Weekly Collection~
£1202.51
~Sr Speight Collection~
£3000.00

The Parish Thanks You
For Your Kindness And Generosity

~A Spiritual Communion~
Jesus, I believe that you are present in the **Most Blessed Sacrament**. I love You above all things, and I desire to receive You into my soul. Since I cannot now receive You Sacramentally, come at least spiritually into my heart, I embrace You as if you are already there, and I unite myself wholly to You.

The Lord asks of you only this, that you act justly, love tenderly and walk humbly with your God.
(Micah 6:8)

DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

Pope Leo's Prayer Intentions for 2026

August: For Evangelisation in the City

Let us pray that in large cities often marked by anonymity and loneliness we find ways to proclaim the Gospel, discovering creative paths to build community.
Amen

Opening Mass for the Season of Creation. 6pm, Sunday 6th September, St. Patrick's Church, Belfast. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions. Marking the beginning of the Season of Creation, 1 Sept–4 Oct, when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water". In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to "beat swords into ploughshares" (Is 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue." All welcome.

St Joseph Men's Camino. Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one. Join men from across Ireland, Saturday 12th September for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch, dinner. Speaker: Fr Mark Quinn. Open to men 18+. Cost €65 (student €55). Registration details can be found at www.dominicans.ie/events or op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

St Colmcille's
Laudato Si' Group
in association with **trócaire**
— invite you to join us for —

Heroes for Humanity

A series of workshops exploring the principles of Catholic Social Teaching through the lives of four remarkable individuals.

Each event will be in
St Colmcille's Parish Hall
191a Upper Newtownards Road,
Belfast, BT4 3JB

Wednesday
9 September 2026
Saint Oscar Romero

Wednesday
16 September 2026
Sister Dorothy Stang

Wednesday
23 September 2026
Dorothy Day

Wednesday
30 September 2026
Martin Luther King Jnr

Beginning at
7.15 pm

Ending with a cuppa
around **8.45 pm**

All are welcome! ♥

Urgent: Stop assisted suicide. We now have just over 2 weeks left before MPs will vote at the Second Reading of the assisted suicide Bill in the House of Commons on September 11th. Not Dead Yet UK have provided postcards you can send to your MP to ask them to vote NO to assisted suicide in the vote in the House of Commons on 11 September. Please take action now—collect a red and white postcard, fill in your details, add a stamp and post it to your MP today!

The Chosen – Weekly screenings of The Chosen: Season 2 will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/ coffee at 10.45am, episode at 11.00am, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; Episode dates: 11, 18 & 25 Sept, 2, 9 & 16 Oct. Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk .All welcome

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach.

Portglenone Monastery, Saturday 19th September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme of the retreat is 'It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me'. (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

Now entering its third year,
A Year of Ignatian Prayer offers a spacious, immersive journey into Ignatian spirituality.

Whether you are already familiar with Ignatian spirituality, or encountering it for the first time, the programme invites you to deepen your relationship with God, grow in interior freedom, and cultivate a more attentive, discerning way of living.

The year will unfold through ten in-person days at the **Belfast Jesuit Centre**, supported by seven online integrative Practice Place Points to help you weave the graces of each season into daily life.

Across the programme we'll explore:

- Ignatian's Man For Our Times
- Images of God
- Approaches to Prayer: Lectio Divina, imaginative contemplation, the Examen, journaling
- Finding God in all things
- Making Attention to Feelings: Conversation/Declaration
- Discernment
- God Calls Me
- What next?

This list offers a flavour rather than a full syllabus. Throughout, the emphasis will be on practice, experience and integration, discovering how Ignatian spirituality can take root in the rhythms of everyday life.

Scan here to register or visit our website

Suggested donation: £200 - £250. Bursaries available.

Belfast Jesuit Centre: 703-705 Donegan Street, Belfast BT1 2EL
www.belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk | bjc@jesuit.ie | 0779 630 6339

JESUIT

Pioneer Gathering – Sunday 27 September. A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down & Connor will take place on: Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast. This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who would like to support a fresh start, new energy, and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

Day Retreat to Lough Derg. Saturday 19th September. Leaving St Paul's Church, Fall's Rd at 6.30am and returning at 7.30pm. Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival, light lunch and retreat. Price: £45 + bus (price determined on uptake. Call St Paul's Parish on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs to register.

Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith? The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those not baptised, baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith. The programme begins Wednesday 1st October, weekly, 6.30–8pm, St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend with participants. All welcome, whether you're exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away. To register: email rcia@downandconnor.org

Mass cards are available from the office. £2.50 each

Chatty Café. Wednesday 10.30am -12.30pm. Come join us for a cuppa & a chat.

AA Meeting upstairs in the Parish Centre every Monday & Friday, 6.30pm-7.30pm, and Thursday at 7pm. (Ladies Group)

Cocaine Anonymous (CA) meet every Tuesday at 7pm upstairs in the Parish Centre.

The Spred Group are finished for the Summer and will rejoin on Monday 7th September at 7pm.

The Stitch and Crocheting Group meet Thursday evenings, 7pm in the Parish centre. Come along and learn a new skill.

Lifeline-24hr 7 days a week 0808 808 8000
Samaritans anytime night or day 116 123
St Vincent De Paul 028 90351561
Cancer Lifeline 028 90 351999
AA 02890351222

AI-Anon Family Groups 028 9068 2368
PIPS 0800 088 6042
Youth Education Health Advise 02890 757 809
Diocesan Safeguarding Officer Philip O'Hara 07534 992 124

Sacred Heart of Jesus, I place all my trust in Thee



St. Anne's Parish

Fr. Martin O'Hagan, PP
Rev Pat McNeill, Deacon
Sr. Mary Murray, Parish Sister

Parish Office: 02890610112
www.saintannesparish.net

Parish Centre: 07762909559
Email: stannes@downandconnor.org

Twenty-Third Sunday in Ordinary Time
Where two or three are gathered in my name....



Mass this Week

St Anne's
Saturday 5pm Vigil (Confessions 4.30pm)
Sunday 11.00 am
Monday & Wednesday 10.00 am

St Colman's Sunday 12.00 noon
Tuesday 10.00 am

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament this week:
St Anne's Monday 12 noon to 1 pm

Parish Office:

Closed until 9am Tuesday 15th September.

Parish WhatsApp Group –keep up to date with what is happening in our parish community. Text your full name and number to **07565012056** to be added.

YOUR GIVING:

This Weekend 5th & 6th September
Weekly Offering
Monthly Offering for Priests

Last Weekend –
Weekly Offering-Envelopes £1004.00 Loose £616.30
Building & Maintenance Fund £312.50

Set up a **Standing Order**. You can download the forms from our website...or **Donate Online** to St. Anne's Parish
A/C No. 07707787 Sort Code 93 83 00

Solar Panel Water Project - 30th August

The Basement Club and friends would like to thank all those who attended their fundraiser on Sunday 30th August. To those who attended and participated so generously, to those who donated cakes, gifts etc, we are extremely grateful. A total of £2655 was raised at the event on Sunday, this combined with £2450 from a GoFund Me appeal running alongside means that plans can progress to build 2 Solar panelled water stations in the Uttar Pradesh region of Northern India. 1 water station will be dedicated to the memory of Catherine McGinley, the other to deceased members of the Basement.

We Remember:

Recently Deceased
Months Mind -
Anniversary -

Noreen Fegan
John Johnston
Joseph McGreevy

Opening Mass for the Season of Creation

6.00 pm on Sunday, 6th September in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions.

This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept-4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water". 1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to "beat swords into ploughshares" (Is 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue."

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each day at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at 10.45am, episode at 11.00am, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All welcome; no registration required. Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23 Oct.
Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk

Cantor Training Adults (18+) involved in parish music are invited to take part in Cantor Training at St Joseph's Parish Centre, Belfast. Training takes place on Saturday 3 October, 17 October and 24 November, from 10.00am to 3.00pm (registration from 9.30am). Attendance at all three days is required for commissioning as a parish cantor. Application form on St Anne's website: www.saintannesparish.net or at your parish office or

St Colmcille's

Laudato Si' Group

in association with **trócaire**

— invite you to join us for —

Heroes for Humanity

A series of workshops exploring the principles of Catholic Social Teaching through the lives of four remarkable individuals.



Wednesday
9 September 2026
Saint Oscar Romero



Wednesday
16 September 2026
Sister Dorothy Stang



Wednesday
23 September 2026
Dorothy Day



Wednesday
30 September 2026
Martin Luther King Jr



Each event will be in
St Colmcille's Parish Hall
191a Upper Newtownards Road,
Belfast, BT4 3JB



Beginning at
7.15 pm



Ending with a cuppa
around **8.45 pm**

All are welcome! ♥

Beginning Experience – is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor.

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Down and Connor Vocations Newsletter available in the porch and on the Parish Website: www.saintannesparish.net

DIOCESAN NOTICES – All available on the parish website:
www.saintannesparish.net

**Downpatrick Family of Parishes
Parishes of Saul & Ballee and Kilclief**

**Twenty Third Sunday of Ordinary Time
Sunday 6th September 2026**

Mass Schedule for the coming week:

Date	St Patrick's Saul	Stella Maris Strangford	St Joseph's Ballycruttle	St Malachy's Kilclief	St Tassach's Carlin
Sunday 6 th Sept	9.30am		12noon	11am	
Monday 7 th Sept	10am	7.30pm			
Tuesday 8 th Sept	10am				
Weds 9 th Sept	10am				
Thursday 10 th Sept					
Friday 11 th Sept	7pm			9.30am	
Saturday 12 th Sept	5pm	6.30pm			
Sunday 13 th Sept	9.30am			11am	12noon

Masses are available to view online at www.saulandballeeparish.com and www.churchmedia.tv

Eucharistic Adoration in St Patrick's Church, Saul each Tuesday after 10am Mass concluding at 8pm. Holy Hour from 2-3pm

Our Lady of Knock Novena each Monday evening in Stella Maris, Strangford at 7.10pm.

The Sanctuary Lamp in St Patrick's Church, Saul has been lit for private intentions. If you would like it lit for your intentions please contact the Parish office. The cost is £5 per week.

Eucharistic Adoration

Down & Connor Diocese is renewing and developing its *Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee* in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in Parishes throughout the Diocese. You are welcome to attend an information meeting on Friday 2nd October in St Patrick's Centre, Downpatrick at 8pm. Registration from 7.30pm. Please see the poster in the Churches for further details.

We invite you all to join us for a cup of tea and biscuits after 7pm Mass on Friday 11th September in St Patrick's PS, Saul to celebrate Fr Aidans 40th Anniversary of his Ordination to the Priesthood.

Start of School Term Masses will be celebrated as follows:-

St Patrick's PS, Saul on Monday 7th September at 10am

St Malachy's PS, Kilclief on Friday 11th September at 9.30am

Recently Deceased: John Lundy

Parish of Saul & Ballee

Anniversary Masses

Saturday 5th September – Kenny Kelly, Thomas & Elizabeth McCormick

Sunday 6th September – Michael Burns (12noon)

Wednesday 9th September – Spencer Cusack

Friday 11th September – Niall Laverty

Saturday 12th September – James Hynds

Sunday 13th September – Raymond Blaney (12noon)

Saturday 19th September -Dermot Vint

Sunday 20th September – Patrick Grant (12noon)

Parish of Kilclief

Anniversary Masses

Saturday 5th September – Jason Hynds

Sunday 13th September – Kevin Cultra, Seamus McMorro, Mary Polley, Patrick King

Saturday 19th September – Anna & William Shields

	Saul & Ballee	Kilclief
Weekly Collection	£1,822.20	£

Hymns – St Malachy's, Kilclief

Entrance: 348v1 Praise to the Lord

Offertory: 183v1 I am the bread of life

Communion: 466v1, 2 You shall cross the barren desert

Recessional: 175v1 Go to the Mass is ended

Hymns - St Patrick's, Saul

Entrance – 240 Do not be afraid

Offertory – 256 Fill my house

Communion – 165 Be still for the presence of the Lord

Recessional – 330 He's got the whole world in his hands

Legion of Mary Annual Trip to Knock will take place on Sunday 27th September. The cost is £30 per person, making the usual stops for breaks. Pick up points are at the following Churches:-

Newcastle – (back of the Church) 6.15am, Castlewellan – 6.30am, Downpatrick – 6.45am,

Crossgar – 7am and Saintfield – 7.15am

To book your place you can place your money in an envelope along with your name and phone number and drop it into the Parish offices in Saul or Downpatrick (Patrician Youth Centre) or you can phone Geraldine on 07845 422723

IT COULD BE YOU!!!

I am deeply indebted to all the volunteers we have in our 2 Parishes. In fact, we could not function without each of you.

One of the biggest fears that prevent people from volunteering is that they could still be there in 15 years time!!

I don't want that for anyone which is why I am making this appeal.

We are always looking for new volunteers –

- For practical things such as cleaning our churches, helping with the flowers, collectors and counters.
- For the roles of Eucharistic Minister or readers, especially from the younger members of our congregations.
- For the various committees in the Parishes, I can assure you we try to keep the meetings brief and not too often.

If you would be interested, I'd love to hear from you – even to explain what the various roles entail. I am eager to revamp our Parish Pastoral Councils. To look at what can be done to make our Parishes and our celebrations more vibrant and meaningful.

Thank you all for your continued support.

Fr Aidan

Beginning Experience – Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November and would be most grateful if you could include the following information in your Church Bulletin at your earliest convenience.

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach - a Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

Day Retreat to Lough Derg on Saturday 19th September. Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm. The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs..

MYMY is an accredited counselling service for adults based in Newcastle. If you or someone you know could benefit from counselling please give us call on 028 4372 7549, email hello@mymy.org.uk or self-refer via our website."

St Joseph Men's Camino - *Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one.* Join men from across Ireland on Saturday 12th September for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith.

The 2025–2026 programme begins on Wednesday 1st October and runs weekly from 6.30–8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away.

To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org or scan the QR code.



Opening Mass for the Season of Creation - 6.00 pm on Sunday 6th September in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions. This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water". 1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to "beat swords into ploughshares" (*Is* 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue."

SAFEGUARDING - If you have a concern, suspicion, or wish to make an allegation of child abuse, or abuse in relation to an adult at risk, please contact the Diocesan Safeguarding Office: Philip O'Hara, Designated Liaison Person, 120, Cliftonville Road, Belfast BT14 6LA. Mobile: 07534 992124 or Telephone: 028 90 492798. Email: philip.ohara@soddc.org or visit <https://downandconnorsafeguarding.com>

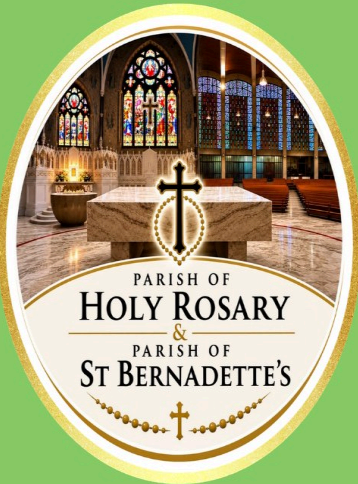
Very Rev Fr Aidan Brankin, Parish Priest 02844 612525 (Saul) or 02844 260101 (Strangford)

Saul Office: 02844 612525, Office Hours: Mon to Fri 9.30am to 12noon 10 St Patrick's Rd, Downpatrick, BT30 7JG

Kilclief Office: 02844260101 Office Hours: Monday 1pm to 3pm 8 Shore Rd, Strangford, BT30 7NL

Website: www.saulandballeeparish.com

Email: saul@downandconnor.org strangfordandkilclief@downandconnor.org



MASS SCHEDULE

SUNDAYS

ST BERNADETTE'S PARISH
Vigil 6.00pm & 11am

HOLY ROSARY PARISH
9am, 10.30am & 12.30pm

WEEKDAYS
St Bernadette's Parish:
Mon, Tues & Wed 9.30am
Holy Rosary Parish:
Thurs, Fri & Sat 10.00am

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION
Good Shepherd church Saturday **10.30am**
St. Bernadette's church Saturday **5.15pm**

BAPTISMS
(Prior booking via Parish Office)
Holy Rosary Church: Third Sunday of the month at 2p.m.
St Bernadette's Church: First Saturday of the month at 2p.m.

CONTACT INFORMATION

Fr. Brendan Hickland, PP (028) 90642446 (Option 1)
b.hickland@downandconnor.org

Fr. Babu Panattuparambil Vareed Assistant Priest
(028) 9079 3023.

Rev. Patrick Keown (Deacon) p.keown@downandconnor.org

Kylee (Parish Support Officer) Office Hours
Mon-Thurs 9.15a.m - 1p.m. Closed Fridays

Holy Rosary Parish Office (028) 90642446 Option 2
holyrosary@downandconnor.org

Philomena (Finance Officer) p.dawson@downandconnor.org
More Information and resources:
holyrosaryparishbelfast.net and www.st.bernadettesparish.org

COME AND SING WITH US!

St. Bernadette's Parish Choir is looking for new members! We return to our musical duties on **Sunday 6th September**, singing each week at the **11.00am Sunday Mass**, with a rehearsal beforehand.

There are no auditions, and you don't need to be an experienced singer - just someone who enjoys singing and would like to be part of our choir. We warmly welcome singers of all ages, so if you've ever thought about joining us, now is the perfect time to give it a try!

For more information, speak to Marty Lavery, our organist and choir director, or to any member of the choir.

Down and Connor Cantor Training

Adults (18+) involved in parish music are invited to take part in Cantor Training at St Joseph's Parish Centre, Dunloy. Training takes place on Saturday 3 October, 17 October and 7 November, from 10.00am to 3.00pm (registration from 9.30am). Attendance at all three days is required for commissioning as a parish cantor. To request an application form, contact your parish office.



TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

SUNDAY

6th September

Readings: A (I) ♦ Psalter: Week 3



? LIFE AFTER ALPHA ?

INVITATION TO CONTINUE THE JOURNEY

ChristLife 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' Course



When Jesus called his first Disciples he said, "Come Follow Me." He still makes that call to us today. The 'ChristLife' series is an opportunity for you to respond to that call and continue that journey you embarked upon with Alpha. **FOLLOWING CHRIST** is a 7-week course with a one day Retreat to help you grow as a disciple of Jesus. The course will commence on **TUESDAY 15 SEPTEMBER 2026 at 7:00pm** in **HOLY ROSARY PARISH CENTRE, 503 Ormeau Road, BT7 3GR.**

Each evening will follow a format similar to the Alpha Course and include a video presentation and small group discussions each evening.

We will also have time for tea and coffee and a little something to eat!

The evening should last no more than a couple of hours.

To register for '**FOLLOWING CHRIST**' course, please send your full name, your e-mail address and preferably your mobile telephone number to **stbrigids@downandconnor.org**

A short information video can be found here:
christlife.org/about/christlife-process/following-christ/

[St Bernadette's Third World Group - Lima Mission](#)

Father Coney and staff members from St Bernadette's Children's Centres in Lima will be speaking at St Bernadette's Masses **Sat 5th & Sunday 6th September**. Their aim is to thank the Sponsors for their continued support over many years, and at the same time promote the sustainability of the projects. The Third World Group is collecting annual sponsorship payments after both Masses this weekend and also on **12th & 13th September**. If you would like to sponsor a child within the Centres please speak to us after Mass. We will be happy to give further details.

Many thanks to all sponsors for your continued support.

[FÁILTE - WELCOME GROUP](#)

There will be a get together of the group and new members in the coffee lounge (St Bernadette's parish centre) on the **13th September after 11am mass**. We are blessed to have 16 members and would be delighted if more parishioners came along to join us. You will find it to be a very worthwhile and enriching ministry to be part of. Beannacht Dia libh.

[HLI Ireland](#)

Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29th September at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

[THE WEST BELFAST HISTORICAL SOCIETY](#)

The September **Friday the 11th of September at 7.30pm** in St. Michael's Parish Centre, The September talk is entitled: "The Lusitania and the U Boat Campaign 1914 -1918" The guest speaker will be Mr Michael McConway

[The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre](#)

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: **11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October.** Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie 07955 282371

PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

WEEKLY COLLECTION:

Holy Rosary: £1997.00
St. Bernadette's: £1065.52

Many thanks for your continued generosity and support

The Monthly Offering Collection for the support of the priests will be taken up this weekend, after Communion. The Building Fund Collection will be taken up next week, in Holy Rosary. Collection offering can be made by standing order or the Dona machines in the church porch.

[St Bernadette's Parish Centre](#)
for all bookings and enquiries please email:
stbernadettes@downandconnor.org

[Holy Rosary Senior Citizens](#)

Senior Citizens monthly meet-up returns after summer break on Monday 7th September at 8pm. New members very welcome.

[St Bernadette's Retirement Group](#)

St Vincent de Paul have invited us to join them for their trip to Mount Stewart on Thursday 17th September.

If you're interested please phone Frances 07800562398 or leave your name in the sacristy.

Welcome back after our beautiful summer.

We hope to see you at our next coffee morning on Wednesday 23rd September after Mass.

New members are welcome. £5 registration.

Our Thursday weekly walk: we meet at 10:15 in the church carpark. All members are welcome to join in at any time.

[B.I.N.G.O is back, we're hoping for a FULL HOUSE!](#)
18th October & 15th November



REST IN PEACE

Recently Deceased:

Georgia Ann Nugent
Joesph Rollins
Michael McKinney
Philip Smith
Edward (Teddy) Dickson
Thomas (Tommy) Napier
Patrick (Pat) McCarney
Frank Maguire
Gerald (Gerry) Henvey

Anniversaries:

Raymond Glover (6pm)
Laura Heaney (9am)
Denis Carey (10.30am)
Eileen Higgins & Paul Cavana (12.30pm)
David Carville, Joesph Woods,
Francis McGinty

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord

The Liturgy

Sunday Mass Saturday: 6.00 pm (Vigil Mass) Sunday: 9.30 am 12.00 noon	<u>Weekday Mass Times</u> Monday: 7.00 pm Tuesday: 9.30 am Wednesday: 9.30 am Thursday: 9.30 am Friday: 7.00 pm Saturday: 12 noon
Confession Monday: 7.30 pm – 8.00 pm Friday: 6.30 pm – 7.00 pm Saturday: 12.30 pm – 1.00 pm & 5.30 pm – 6:00 pm Eucharistic Adoration Monday: 7.30 pm – 8.00 pm	Baptisms 1 st & 3 rd Sunday of the Month at 1.30pm Please contact the Parish Office to book <i>(One month's notice required)</i> Marriages At least 6 months' notice required prior to date of Marriage. Please contact Fr Sheehan

PARISH OFFERTORY COLLECTION

(Total includes Basket Collections, Standing Orders and Dona Donations)

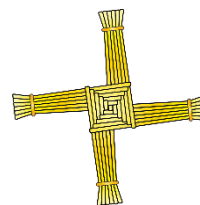
Weekly Collection 6th Sept: £7727.90

Monthly Collection 6th Sept: £4975.46

Mass Intentions for week ahead

Mon 14th Sept 7pm: *Special Intention*
 Tues 15th Sept 9.30am: *Bernard Downey (A)*
 Wed 16th Sept 9.30am: *Patricia Gilligan (A)*
 Fri 18th Sept 7pm: *Special Intention*
 Sat 19th Sept 12 Noon: *Malachy Owens (A)*
 Sat 19th Sept 6pm: *Samuel McShane (A)*

St Brigid's Parent and Toddler Group will start back on Thursday 17th September from 10.00am until 11.45am in St Brides Parish Hall.



Saint Brigid's Parish

24th Sunday in O T
 13th September 2026, Year A

Parish Priest: Fr Michael Sheehan **Tel:** 028 9066 5409

Parish Office: 028 9066 5409; (9 am - 1 pm Weekdays)

Address: 40 Derryvolgie Avenue, Belfast, BT9 6FP

Email: stbrigids@downandconnor.org **Website:** stbrigidsparishbelfast.org

Livestream/Webcam: youtube.com/@stbrigidsparishbelfast



24th Sunday in Ordinary Time

First Reading: Reading from the book of Ecclesiasticus Sir 27:30-28:7
Forgive your neighbour the hurt he does you, and when you pray, your sins will be forgiven

Responsorial Psalm: Ps 102:1-4.9-12
The Lord is compassion of love, slow to anger and rich in mercy.

Second Reading: Reading from the St Paul to the Romans Rm 14:7-9
Alive or dead we belong to the Lord.

Gospel: According to Matthew Mt 18:21:35
I do not tell you to forgive seven times, but seventy-seven times.

Anniversary List

Please pray for those whose anniversaries are at this time: Joseph Murtagh, Raymund Shearer, Patricia Gilligan, Malachy Owens, Desmond Shearer, Kathleen and Tom Kelly, Maureen Salters, Geraldine Donnelly, Kevin Mulholland, Mary Maguire, Brigid and John McKenna, Barney and Cis McCartan, Charlie Grant;

May they rest in peace

QUEEN'S CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY – WE'RE BACK!

The Catholic Chaplaincy at Queen's reopens for the new academic year on **Monday 14 September**, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. Our first Sunday Mass is 20 September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Please note the new time!

ST BRIGID'S MORNING PRAYER

We are recommencing morning prayer at **7.30am on 14th September 2026 in the Side Chapel** and each subsequent Monday until the beginning of Advent during which we will meet each weekday morning until just before Christmas.

All parishioners and friends are warmly welcomed

The format follows the Morning Office includes a reading and reflection on the gospel and introduces the rhythm of the daily office and especially the psalms to our daily lives. Why not come along and experience for yourselves?

Women's Prayer Group

*Are you looking to find a closer relationship with God?
If so, St Brigid's Women's Prayer Group may be for you.*

We are a group of women of all ages who come together once a month. It's a very gentle hour in which we study a passage of scripture and pray. It's a community that continues to grow, developing relationship with not only God, but with one another too.

We meet the third Wednesday of each month, for about an hour, in the Parish Office at 7.30pm. We start with a cup of tea and a chat. There is always wisdom, support and good humour to be found amongst us. If you decide to join us you will receive the warmest of welcomes.

The next meetings are 16th September, 21st October, 18th November and 16th December.

Further info from Mary 07718263019

The Men's Morning Prayer group

Recommences on Friday 18th September at 7.30am in 40 Derryvolgie Avenue. This is an opportunity to reflect on the gospel for the following Sunday recite the morning office and build fraternity, as we seek to follow Christ in our daily lives.

CHAPLET OF DIVINE MERCY

We're back after our summer break!!

You are warmly invited by your local Lay Dominicans to join us as we pray the chaplet of Divine Mercy in St Brigid's church every FRIDAY at 3pm.

It's a beautiful way to start the weekend, so please join us.



? LIFE AFTER ALPHA ?

INVITATION TO CONTINUE THE JOURNEY ChristLife 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' course



FOLLOWING CHRIST is a 7-week course with a one day Retreat to help you grow as a disciple of Jesus. The course will commence on **TUESDAY 15 SEPTEMBER 2026 at 7:00pm in HOLY ROSARY PARISH CENTRE, 503 Ormeau Road, BT7 3GR.**

To register for 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' course, please send your full name, your e-mail address and mobile telephone number to stbrigids@downandconnor.org

St Brigid's One World Group

Annual Collection and Standing Order Appeal 2026

Please help people suffering from extreme poverty in developing countries whose needs are growing every year because of:

- the spiralling costs of food and other basic commodities
- devastating floods and droughts caused by climate change
- the impacts of war
- growing inequalities between rich and poor
- the significant reduction of aid from Governments.



Please contribute to our Annual Collection this weekend and/or consider making a regular donation by setting up a Standing Order online with your bank or by completing a Standing Order form.

If you are a UK taxpayer and Gift Aid your donations, we can claim a further 25% of the amount from HMRC.

Gift Aid envelopes and Standing Order forms are available at the back of the Church.

Donations may be made electronically or Standing Orders set up online

Account No 68825172 Sort Code 90-22-07

Envelopes can also be returned in the collection basket at any Mass over the coming weeks.

For information, email stbrigids1wg@gmail.com or phone Kevin on 07525634440

Confirmation Preparation Classes 2026/2027

Enrolment for St Brigid's Parish Confirmation Preparation Classes 2026/27 is now open to Year 7 pupils, who are not attending St Brigid's Primary School, and Year 8 pupils. Each class lasts one hour, 5.45pm-6.45pm, on Tuesdays in St. Brigid's Parish Hall. **The limited places available** will be awarded on the first come first served basis. Please contact the Parish Office stbrigids@downandconnor.org or 90665409 for further enrolment details.



Living Water
Season of Creation 2026

Immersion in Living Water
EZEKIEL 47:9, 12

Season of Creation 2026 (1 September – 4 October). Join us ...

The Season of Creation is the annual Christian celebration which invites us to respond in hope and commit to positive action meeting the challenge and responsibility to care for creation - our common home. As we journey through the Season of Creation from 1 September through to the feast-day of St Francis of Assisi on 4 October, let us each take one action to care for our planet, our common home.

What action will we take in this season to show care for our planet, our common home?

Action an Eco - tip

- Endeavour to buy locally sourced food on one shopping visit
- Make one journey on foot or use public transport
- Select one day and turn off all non- essential lights

Start the conversation with family and friends – what can we do to care for our common home? Involve young people in our conversations – their voice matters - they will inherit the planet that we create.

Read and consider what others are saying

Keep informed and join wider discussions by visiting info@jointhedotstogether.org
Read My Appeal (paragraphs 13 - 16) Laudato Si' - On Care for Our Common Home - visit www.vatican.va

Contribute your ideas and talents

Join our parish 'Care for Common Home' group to share ideas on eco-tips and suggestions for future talks/events — contact through the Parish Office.

Let's rise to the challenge

Pope Frances had every confidence that we can make change happen.
'All of us can cooperate as instruments of God for the care of creation, each according to his or her own culture, experience, involvements and talents' (LS14).

St Brigid's Care for Our Common Home Group

We are continuing our discussions around moving to solar panels - an action to reduce parish building carbon emissions.

St Brigid's Care for Our Common Home Group

Stretch. Breathe. Connect.

The Parish Community Association welcomes you back to our much-loved **Yoga sessions**—designed to refresh your body and lift your spirit.

- Starting:** Monday 14th September 2026
- Time:** 12:30 pm (*doors open at 12:15 pm – come early and settle in!*)
- Venue:** St Brigid's Parish Centre – Main Hall
- Open to:** All ages, all abilities – absolutely everyone is welcome!

Why you'll love it:

- **Expert guidance** – Learn poses safely and at your own pace
- **Just £5** – Quality wellness that won't break the bank
- **Friendly vibes** – A lovely way to meet new people in our community

Please bring your own yoga mat – you'll need it for the full session.

Come as you are. Leave feeling brighter.

Give it a go – your mind (and body) will thank you. We can't wait to see you there!

Set Dancing

The Parish Community Association welcomes you back to our weekly Set Dancing classes with Ronan Eastwood

Have fun, keep fit and get ready for the Fleadh next year!

- Starting:** Wednesday 16th September 2026
- Time:** 11:15am- 12:45pm (*doors open at 11:00am*)
- Venue:** St Brigid's Parish Centre – Downstairs Hall
- Open to:** All ages, all abilities – absolutely everyone is welcome!
- Only £5 per session**

Classes will run every week with a break on 28th October and a pre Christmas party on 16th December in the afternoon from 1:30pm - 3:30pm

Gaeilge agus Cultúr weekly in St Bride's Parish Hall

Tuesday 8th September, 2pm to 3pm. Irish for those with a little.

Thursday 10th September, 10am to 11am Irish for beginners.

Thursday 17th September, 1.30 to 3.30 amateur dramatics, no experience necessary.

Thursday 24th September 6.30 to 8.30 Gaeilge Choir, no fluency required.

Contact Máire for more information 07748482025/ amharcababu@hotmail.com



ST COLMCILLE'S CHURCH, HOLLYWOOD PARISH

Fr Stephen P McBrearty PP

2A My Lady's Mile, Holywood, BT18 9EW Tel: 028 9042 2167 Office Hours: 10.00am – 2.00pmEmail: holywood@downandconnor.orgWebsite: www.stcolmcilleshollywood.org**SEASON OF CREATION****Opening Mass for the Season of Creation 6pm on Sunday 6th September****St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast:**

Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions. This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water". 1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to "beat swords into ploughshares" (Is 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue." Further information on the Season of Creation can be found on our website.

**Lay Bereavement Ministry – Volunteers Needed**

Parishioners are invited to consider becoming

Lay Bereavement Ministers, a new ministry**replacing Bethany Bereavement.** Ministers offer

compassionate support to those who are grieving through visits, telephone contact, group support and parish remembrance events. We are looking for people with good listening and communication skills, a caring and non-judgemental approach, reliability, and an active parish faith. A minimum team of 4 people is required, with ministry carried out in pairs. Teams can also work across a Family of Parishes. **Training: 29 September–14 November** at the Diocesan Offices, 120 Cliftonville Road, Belfast. Attendance at all six sessions is required. **Application deadline: 12 noon, Friday 18 September.** Places are limited. Further information is on our website

www.stcolmcilleshollywood.org**MASS TIMES**

Saturday vigil Mass 6.30pm

Sunday 10am & 12noon

Weekday Mass

Monday at 7.00pm

Tuesday Wednesday &

Thursday at 9.30am

Friday at 7.00pm

~~~~~  
**Tuesday - St Anthony's Novena during the Mass.**  
 ~~~~~

~~~~~  
**Friday–Novena of Our Lady of Perpetual Succour during Mass.**  
 ~~~~~

~~~~~  
**Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament for 30 mins before each Mass**  
 ~~~~~

Eucharistic Adoration

Every Saturday

12noon – 5.00pm

And before weekday Mass

For 30 Mins

~~~~~  
*Confession is by appointment only – Please contact the parish office for further details*  
 ~~~~~

Church Opening Times For Private Prayer

Monday and Friday

Open all day for evening

Mass at 7pm

Tuesday, Wednesday &

Thursday open until 3pm

Saturdays 12noon to 5pm

and Sunday until 1pm.

~~~~~

**REMEMBERING OUR DEPARTED**

***We pray for those who have died recently and for those whose anniversaries occur around this time.***

**Recently Deceased** Frank Cross Sherry Campbell (Donaghadee), Patricia Higgins, Philip Smith, Fr Michael McConville, Cyril Devins (Dublin), Jim Toner, Rita Loughlin, Paul Clarke. Frances McClay, Eileen Brogan

**Months Mind:** Damien Bintley, Terry Malone, Norman Smith

**Anniversaries:** Daniel Kane, Graham MacManus, Robert Brennan, V Rev Samuel Kerr, V Rev Denis Newberry, Rev Denis McAteer,



# 23<sup>rd</sup> Sunday in Ordinary Time

## Sunday 6<sup>th</sup> September 2026



O God, by whom we are redeemed and receive adoption, look graciously upon your beloved sons and daughters, that those who believe in Christ may receive true freedom and an everlasting inheritance. Through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son, who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, for ever and ever.



St Vincent de Paul Helpline Number:  
07845 854671

To donate directly to our bank account, the details are as follows:

**Account Name: Ulster Bank Springhill**

**Account Number: 10523499**

**Sort Code: 98-07-60**

If you would prefer to phone directly to donate money, please phone 028 90750161 and mention Holywood. Thank you for your continued support during these difficult times. If you can, please remember to Gift Aid your donation



**RECHARGE**

### St Colmcille's Ballyhackamore at

7.30pm Join us on the first and third Tuesday every month to recharge your spiritual batteries through prayer, study and friendship. First Tuesday – Adoration with Guided Meditation and Confession. Third Tuesday Group Study Course.

### Beginning Experience – Bereavement Support

Beginning Experience is a peer ministry supporting those who are bereaved, separated or divorced. It is part of the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce can be devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support over three Saturdays:

📅 Saturday 26th September

📅 Saturday 24th October

📅 Saturday 21st November

📍 St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Avenue, Belfast

**Booking is essential.**

For further information or to book a place, please contact Marie on 07896 119669 or email

[belfastbe@yahoo.com](mailto:belfastbe@yahoo.com).

*You do not have to walk through loss alone.*

### The Continuous Prayer for Marriage & Family

**Life:** Fr Johnny's prayer intentions for September 2026 can be found in the News & Events section of the website

### Defibrillator Training – Volunteers Needed

Our new defibrillator is located just inside the church entrance, beside the toilets. While it is simple to use without prior training, we are offering short training sessions in September to help parishioners feel confident using it in an emergency.

We still need volunteers from all three weekend Masses to complete the training. No first aid experience is required.

If you would like to take part, please contact the Parish Office with your usual Mass time and contact details thank you.

### St Joseph Men's Camino

*Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect; every man needs one.* Join men from across Ireland on **Saturday 12th September** for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55).

Registration, accommodation and details:

[www.dominicans.ie/events](http://www.dominicans.ie/events). Enquiries:

[op.evangelisation@gmail.com](mailto:op.evangelisation@gmail.com).

### Diocesan Vocations Summer Newsletter

We are delighted to share with you the Diocese of Down and Connor Vocations Summer Newsletter. The newsletter offers an insight into the many ways in which vocations are being nurtured and encouraged across our Diocese, as well as the work taking place to support those discerning God's call. We invite parishioners to take some time to read and reflect on the newsletter and to continue to pray for vocations to the priesthood, religious life and all forms of Christian service. Copies of the Newsletter are on our website

[www.stcolmcillesholywood.com](http://www.stcolmcillesholywood.com)



## DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG

**Saturday 19th September**

Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to St Paul's at 7.30pm the day includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me"

(Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.

All men are very welcome. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon – Thurs to book a place.

## Marriage Enrichment Weekend 2nd to 4<sup>th</sup>

**October:** Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2nd to Sunday 4th October 2026 at the "Focolare Centre" "Curryhills", Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage.

[www.marriageencounter.ie](http://www.marriageencounter.ie)

## Bereavement Information Evening – Supporting Surviving Siblings

**Tuesday 15 September at 7pm | Online**

Bereaved parents and adult siblings (18+) are warmly invited to join Anam Cara for an evening focused on supporting siblings following the death of a child or sibling.

The event is open to families bereaved at any age, in any circumstances, and regardless of how long ago the bereavement occurred.

Hear from bereavement specialists and local organisations, including LauraLynn, The Student Grief Network, Childhood Cancer Ireland, Jacinta's Smile and Rainbows. Register online at: **Anam Cara Online Bereavement Information Evening**

Please share this event with anyone in your community who may benefit.

For information packs or more about Anam Cara's services: [info@anamcara.ie](mailto:info@anamcara.ie) | 085 288 8888

**Beginning Experience:** The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast

**Booking essential.** To find out more, contact Pauline [07519289185](tel:07519289185) or Marie [07896119669](tel:07896119669) or email [belfastbe@yahoo.com](mailto:belfastbe@yahoo.com)



**Thinking about becoming Catholic, or want to deepen your understanding**

**of the faith?** The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation and community for adults wishing to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect with their faith. The 2026-2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23<sup>rd</sup> Sept and runs weekly from 6.30pm to 8pm in St Mary's Hall Chapel Lane Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés, and friends are also welcome to attend alongside participants. Further details are on our website.



**The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre:** Weekly screenings of *The Chosen*:

*Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at 10.45am, episode at 11.00am, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October.

Contact: [bjc@jesuit.ie](mailto:bjc@jesuit.ie) | 07955 282371 | [belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk](http://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk)



**St Vincent de Paul – Treasurer**  
**Could you help us?** We are

looking for a reliable and community-minded person to take on the role of Treasurer for our St Vincent de Paul Group. If you have bookkeeping experience or have previously held a similar position, we would love to hear from you. Your experience would be greatly appreciated and would be a valuable help to our group. If you think you might be interested, or would simply like to find out more, please leave your contact details with Claire in the Parish Office.



**Stay Connected with Our Parish!**

Join the PPC Facebook Page! Want to stay up to date with parish news, events, announcements, photos, and other important information? Follow and like our PPC Facebook page to keep connected with our parish community throughout the week.

👉 Find us on Facebook: St Colmcilles Parish  
Join us online. Stay connected. Be part of our parish community!

## VACANCY – PASTORAL MINISTRY CO-

**ORDINATOR Belfast:** Jesuit Centre, 193–195 Donegall Street, Belfast. The Diocese of Down and Connor is seeking to appoint a Pastoral Ministry Co-ordinator on a 2-year fixed-term contract. The successful applicant will support the Director of the Belfast Jesuit Centre and Chaplain to Ulster University, helping to develop pastoral and spiritual programmes, support volunteers, and create welcoming spaces for students of all faiths and none. Hours: 35 hours per week, including some evening work salary: £29,000 gross per annum Closing date: 12 noon, Thursday 10 September 2026. For the full Role Profile, Employment Application Form and details on how to apply, please visit [www.downandconnor.org](http://www.downandconnor.org) and click Job Vacancies, or visit [www.belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk](http://www.belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk), Community NI or nijob.com. Down and Connor Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer.



## A Year of Ignatian Prayer 2026-2027 Belfast Jesuit Centre

There are a few places remaining on our immersive programme in Ignatian Spirituality, which returns on Saturday 26<sup>th</sup> September; offering ten in-person Saturdays (10am–4pm) in the BJC and seven online Integrative Practice Pause Points to support prayer, discernment and reflective living. Open to those new to Ignatian Spirituality and those seeking to deepen their practice. Suggested donation: £200–£280. Bursaries available. For dates and registration, please visit: <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/a-year-of-ignatian-prayer-2026-2027/>

## Community Set Dancing Classes in Holywood

are starting again on **Monday 14<sup>th</sup> Sep (7.30pm - 9.00pm)**. Great exercise and good fun. Very different to Riverdance. No need to come with a partner - just comfortable shoes and a friendly disposition! This is an adult class but children over the age of 14 are welcome but need to be accompanied by a parent or guardian. Each class costs £5 (£3 for those under 25). Please call Kevin Mac Mahon on 07940 803839 to reserve a place or for further information

## Abide in His Love Women's Conference.

The Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran,  
**20–22 November 2026.** Join women from across Ireland for a faith-filled weekend with inspiring speakers including Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Fr Mark Wharton, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Oisín Martin, the Dominican Sisters of Nashville, Bishop Fintan Gavin, and more. A conference not to be missed!

Register now: <https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com/>

## Lough Derg – August & September 2026

*"A pilgrimage gives us time and space to encounter God more deeply."* — Pope Leo XIV

### One Day Retreats:

5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20 September (€50).

### Special themed retreats include

St Peregrine, Pioneer Pilgrimage, St Carlos Acutis, Vocations Monstrance and Divine Mercy:

### Other Events:

20 August: Heritage Day Tours (€15)

30 August: Lakeshore Pilgrim Path Pilgrimage (€25)

### New for 2026:

Overnight accommodation available before retreats and pilgrimages.

Advance booking essential.

Lough Derg, Pettigo, Co. Donegal •

[www.loughderg.org](http://www.loughderg.org) • 00353 71 986 1518



## Requests for Masses for Deceased Relatives and Friends

### In remembrance of loved ones –

To request a Mass for an Intention of a family member or friend. Please give your request either by calling the office 028 90422167 (Option 2) or by sending an email to

[holywood@downandconnor.org](mailto:holywood@downandconnor.org)

Although we cannot guarantee the date you request will be available,

Fr Stephen will be offering

a Mass for the Intention each day





Thank God and sincere thanks also to our many listeners and supporters as RADIO MARIA IRELAND continues to grow. As an Irish-run Catholic Talk-Radio Station we enjoy commercial free broadcasting - Prayer, Catechesis, Uplifting music, Talks, Interviews and Testimonies – do join our growing faith family! Here's how you can listen:

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# PARISH OF ST COLMCILLE'S BALLYHACKAMORE

*"To know the joy  
of God's love and  
make the love of  
God known to all"*

## 23RD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME- YEAR A

**6<sup>TH</sup> SEP 2026**

Missal Pg 647

### WELCOME BACK!

As September begins, we hope that everyone has had a restful and enjoyable summer. It is wonderful to welcome everyone back, and there is a real sense of excitement about all that lies ahead in the life of our parish.

This year, rather than welcoming a NET Team, we are delighted to be appointing our own Youth Minister, Brendan, who will work with our young people and families and help us continue to develop this important part of our parish mission. We very much look forward to welcoming Brendan and to seeing all that will grow from his ministry among us.

The summer has also given us an opportunity to focus particularly on parish leadership and renewal. We have welcomed new members to our Parish Engagement Group (PEG), and we are continuing to develop our Four Ws, helping to ensure that the many different groups, ministries and organisations which make up our parish remain connected to one another and, above all, to our shared mission.

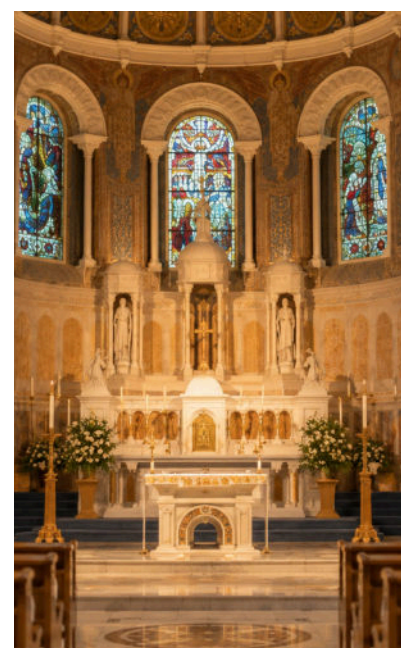
As the next step, I would like to invite the leader or one representative from every group, ministry, committee or organisation connected with our parish to a Four Ws gathering on Tuesday 29th September at 7.30pm in the Parish Centre.

This includes not only our explicitly pastoral or liturgical ministries, but the many groups and organisations who meet in or use our parish facilities. If you are part of the life of this parish, you are part of our mission.

If you lead or represent one of these groups, please contact the Parish Office for further details and to let us know that your group will be represented.

There is much to look forward to in the months ahead. May we begin this new parish year with renewed energy, working together to build a community where everyone is welcomed, valued and invited to share in the mission of proclaiming the Gospel.

*Have a blessed week, Fr Conor*





## MASS THIS SUNDAY

**First Reading:** Ezekiel 33:7-9

### Psalm 94

*O that today you would listen to his voice!  
'Harden not your hearts.'*

**Second Reading:** Romans 13:8-10

### Gospel Acclamation

*Alleluia, alleluia! Your word is truth, O  
Lord: consecrate us in the truth.  
Alleluia!*

**Gospel:** Matthew 16: 21-27

## DECEASED

We pray for the repose of the souls of  
all those who have died recently.

## ANNIVERSARIES

We also remember in prayer all those  
whose anniversaries occur at this time:

**Maureen Forrester, David  
O'Flaherty and Jack Younger.**

## Lost Property

A collection of clothing left in the  
church hall is currently on display on  
the long bench in the church foyer.

If you have lost an item, please check  
the collection and claim it by **Saturday  
12th September**. Any unclaimed  
items after this date will be disposed  
of.

## THIS WEEK AT ST COLMCILLE'S

|     |                                                 |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------|
| SUN | Mass: 9.30am & 11.30am                          |
| MON | Morning Prayer: 9.00am                          |
| TUE | Holy Hour, Confessions: 6.00pm<br>Mass: 7.00pm. |
| WED | Mass: 9.30am                                    |
| THU | Mass: 9.30am                                    |
| FRI | Morning Prayer: 9.00am,<br>Mass: 9.30am         |
| SAT | Confession: 5.00pm – 5.20pm, Mass:<br>5.30pm    |

St Colmcille's  
*Laudato Si' Group*  
in association with **Trócaire**

# Heroes for Humanity

A SERIES OF WORKSHOPS

**WEDNESDAY  
9 SEPTEMBER  
2026**

**Saint  
Oscar Romero**

A workshop exploring the  
life and legacy of a voice  
for **justice** and the poor.

St Colmcille's  
Parish Hall  
191a Upper  
Newtownards Road,  
Belfast, BT4 3JB

Beginning at  
**7.15 pm**

Ending with  
a cuppa around  
**8.45 pm**

*All are welcome!*

## Money Matters

The Monthly Offering Collection for the support of the priests will be taken up this weekend.

If you wish to make your contributions via contactless payment, this is now available using the QR code on the parish website or in the bulletin. We would encourage you to gift aid your donation if you are paying tax; you only need to key this information once, as long as you are using the same debit/credit card to make your donations each time.



<https://donate.mydona.com/st-colmcilles-parish-belfast>

## Parish Safeguarding Training

### *1. Full Child Safeguarding Training for Leaders (Level 2)*

The dates and links for registration for these training sessions are listed below.

Please note that these are face-to-face sessions taking place locally, and there may not be any further Level 2 Child Safeguarding Training opportunities scheduled in your area this year.

BALLYMENA- Sat 12th September 2026

BELFAST- 16 & 23 Sept 2026

NEWCASTLE- Sat 19 Sept 2026



### *2. Training in Online Safety*

There will be a free online training opportunity provided by CiNI on 8th September 2026 regarding online safety that may be of interest to Leaders of children's and young people's activities.

The 3-hour workshop delivered via zoom is an introduction to the issues surrounding on-line child protection. It looks at harm prevention and protection in the on-line world and how we can enable children to be safe, benefit from this world and protect themselves.

You can book directly with CiNI here:



**SAVE THE DATE!**

**PARISH CEILI**

 **FRIDAY 9<sup>TH</sup> OCTOBER**  
**7.30PM – 11.30PM**  
**AT COLMCILLES PARISH HALL**

 **ADMISSION £10.00**  
**PAY AT THE DOOR.**

 **BRING YOUR OWN DRINK AND SNACKS.**

 **WE WILL BE HAVING A BALLOT/RAFFLE ON THE NIGHT - ENVELOPES OF 5 TICKETS IS £5.**



Before each dance, there will be a short practice where the caller will explain the steps. During the dance, she'll continue to call out the moves, so no experience is necessary.

**HALF THE FUN IS LEARNING THE STEPS TOGETHER!**

**COME ALONG TO THIS PARISH SOCIAL COMMUNITY EVENT, ENJOY THE DANCING, CRAIC AND FUN.**



## Parish Group Notices:

### John Paul II Award – Information Session

Calling all 16-17 year olds, especially those who have recently finished their GCSEs!

Come along to find out more about this year's John Paul II Award and hear from young people who have recently completed it, sharing their experiences of volunteering and the benefits of the programme.

**When: Thursday 17 September at 7pm, Where: Parish Hall – Iona Room**

A great opportunity to get involved in parish and community life while gaining a recognised award for your CV and future applications. New members are very welcome!

### St Colmcille's Indoor Mixed Bowling Club

Bowling Club resumes on **Thursday 3rd September 26 at 7pm.**

New members are welcome!

Enquiries: Please contact Deirdre on 07479329938, or just turn up!

### St Colmcille's Parent & Toddler Group

We provide an opportunity for anyone caring for a child from 0 to 4 years to come along with the child and enjoy company, snacks and play. We meet on Wednesdays at 10 am, and we resume on **Wednesday 9th September 2026** after the summer break. If you haven't been before, it's a great way to make new friends. All mums, dads, grandparents, childminders and carers are welcome, with their children!

### Align Physio-led Pilates

Classes will resume **Monday 7th September** in the Parish hall. Class times on a Monday are 9.30am, 10.30am, 7.15pm and 8.15pm. Suitable for all ages, men and women. If interested and for more information, please contact [oliviadavidson42@hotmail.co.uk](mailto:oliviadavidson42@hotmail.co.uk)

### St Colmcille's Parish Youth Group

The Youth Club returns on **Saturday 12 September at 6.30 pm.**

New and existing members (Years 8–11) are very welcome!

Parents who would like to volunteer and help with the Youth Club are warmly invited to contact Jarek on 07704 410446.

## USEFUL CONTACTS

**Parish Office:** [stcolmcilles@downandconnor.org](mailto:stcolmcilles@downandconnor.org).

**Finance Officer:** Philomena Dawson - [p.dawson@downandconnor.org](mailto:p.dawson@downandconnor.org)

**Parish Engagement Group** - [stcolmcillespeg@gmail.com](mailto:stcolmcillespeg@gmail.com)

**Webcam:** <https://st-colmcilles.net/web-camera/>

**Facebook:** <https://www.facebook.com/stcolmcilleschurch/>

**Instagram:** [stcolmcillesballyhack](https://www.instagram.com/stcolmcillesballyhack)

**Parish Office: Mon- Fri 10:00 - 13:00**





# St Gerard's Parish Weekly Bulletin

## 6th September 2026



### Welcome to Celebrate Today's Liturgy Mass Times

**Saturday Vigil- 18.30**

**Sunday Mass—10.30**

**Monday—Liturgy of The Word 9.30**

**Tuesday Mass -9.30**

**Wednesday Mass- 9.30**

**Thursday OMPH Novena Prayer Service- 9.30**

**Thursday OMPH Novena Mass—19.30**

**Friday Mass - 9.30**

**Saturday Silent Meditation—9.30**

**Holy Days** Vigil 7.30pm Morning 9:30

**Reconciliation** Saturday 17.30—18.15  
otherwise by appointment with Priest

**Baptisms** 2nd and 4th Sundays—Baptism  
Preparation course 5pm on 1st Monday of each  
month for those wishing to have their child Baptised  
in St Gerard's—ring Parish office to arrange both.

**Priest** Fr Patrick O'Keeffe CSsR ADM

**Parish Office** 028 90 774833  
726 Antrim Road (office hrs M-F 9.30-1.30)

**Email** stgerards@downandconnor.org

**Website** stgerardsparish.org

**Church Services**: Our live streaming web  
address has been updated. To access MCN  
Media, please go to [www.mcn.live](http://www.mcn.live) on your web  
browser. THE CHURCH WEBCAM CAN BE ACCESSED  
VIA  
[mcn.live/Camera/st-gerards-church-newtownabbey](http://mcn.live/Camera/st-gerards-church-newtownabbey)  
(Playback available on **Recorded** services only -  
Recording Requests can be made through Parish  
office)

*\*For Anniversary Mass Intentions on preferred dates—  
Please (if possible) make requests 3-4 weeks in advance*

### The Apostles' Creed

I believe in God, the Father almighty,  
Creator of heaven and earth,  
and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,  
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit,  
born of the Virgin Mary,  
suffered under Pontius Pilate,  
was crucified, died and was buried;  
he descended into hell;  
on the third day  
he rose again from the dead;  
he ascended into heaven,  
and is seated at the right hand of  
God the Father almighty;  
from there he will come to judge the  
living and the dead.  
I believe in the Holy Spirit,  
the holy catholic Church,  
the communion of saints,  
the forgiveness of sins,  
the resurrection of the body,  
and life everlasting. Amen.

### Congratulations to Mrs Briege Smyth

We are delighted to announce that His Holiness Pope Leo XIV  
has conferred the Benemerenti Medal on Mrs Briege Smyth in  
recognition of her lifetime of dedicated service to St Gerard's  
Church and Parish.  
This prestigious papal honour is a fitting tribute to Briege's faithful  
commitment, generosity, and years of service to our parish  
community.  
Please join us in congratulating Briege on this achievement and in  
keeping her in your prayers as she receives this special recognition.  
The Benemerenti Medal will be presented to Briege during the  
10.30am Mass on Sunday, 6 September 2026.  
All are warmly welcome to attend and share in this joyful  
celebration. Tea and coffee will be served after Mass, providing an  
opportunity for parishioners and friends to congratulate Briege  
personally.  
We thank Briege for her outstanding contribution to parish life and  
celebrate this well-deserved honour with her and her family.

Our Parish Associate Pilgrims Collection for the Down and Connor  
Diocesan Pilgrimage will take place this weekend 5th and 6th  
September.

**Saturday 4th October at 3pm—Blessing of Pets— on this special day  
of the Feast of St Frances all our pets are welcome to St Gerard's  
Church for a special blessing**

Opening Mass for the Season of Creation  
6.00 pm on Sunday, 6th September in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall  
Street, Belfast

Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions.

This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4  
Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action  
for our common home under the theme "Living Water".

1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In  
his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to  
"beat swords into ploughshares" (Is 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for  
nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into  
life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external  
change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a  
deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who  
will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue."

The **Rise & Shine Trust** wishes to thank the parishioners of St Gerard's  
for your kind donations that amounted to £710.16 and 70 euro.  
Remember if you know anyone who would benefit from next years  
trip please contact

**Maurice on 07711504821 [mauricediamond@gmail.com](mailto:mauricediamond@gmail.com) or visit  
[www.riseandshine.ie](http://www.riseandshine.ie).**

**LOCAL IRISH DANCE CLASSES – SEPTEMBER** The Carson Academy of  
Irish Dance welcomes **girls & boys aged 4+** to our fun and friendly  
beginner Irish dance classes. **Mayfield Village Hall** Every Tuesday |  
5:30–6:30pm **Glengormley Integrated Nursery School** Every Saturday  
| 10:00–11:00am Classes commence **week of 7th September**.

**Enquiries & Booking:** WhatsApp: 07803 785103

Email: [carson\\_acd@icloud.com](mailto:carson_acd@icloud.com) New beginners are very welcome!

Craobh Naomh Pádraig will begin Irish/Gaeilge classes on  
Wednesday 16 September 2026 at 7 p.m.  
Classes will be held in Arás Mhic Reachtain, 283-289 Antrim Road  
(opposite waterworks).  
Term will last for 12 weeks finishing on Wed 9 December.  
Cost per term for adults £30. Teenagers - no cost.  
All levels available: bunrang, meánrang, meán rang uachtar, ardrang  
and class for teenagers.

**EUCARISTIC ADORATION** – Down and Connor Diocese is renewing  
and developing its **Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee** in order to  
increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout  
the diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting at  
ONE of these venues

Thur 1<sup>st</sup> October The Parish Centre Ballymena – 2 Broughshane Road  
BT43 7DX 8pm

Fri 2<sup>nd</sup> October St Patrick's Centre Downpatrick – Market Street BT30  
6LZ 8pm

Registration from 7.30pm . See poster in the church porch for details

New Lodge Grotto Monday 7th September 6.30pm Rosary at the  
Grotto 7pm Holy Mass at the Grotto with Fr Francis O'Brien and Fr  
John O'Laverty Followed by refreshments All welcome!

EVERYONE IS INVITED TO STAY AFTER MASS THIS WEEKEND  
AND JOIN US FOR COFFEE/TEA AND CHAT

### PASTORAL COMMUNITY

#### HOLY FAMILY PARISH CLERGY

Very Rev. Michael Spence PP

Rev. John O'Laverty CC

Rev. Brendan Dowd Deacon

Mass Times

HOLY FAMILY CHURCH,

14 Newington Avenue, Belfast, BT15 2HP

Sunday: Vigil (Saturday) 6pm; 10.30am

Holydays: 9.15am

Weekdays: Mon–Wed 9.15am

Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Wed at 9.15am

First Saturday Devotions: First Saturday of the month at 10am

ST THERÉSE OF LISIEUX CHURCH,

71 Somerton Road, Belfast, BT15 4DE

Sunday: 9am & 12pm

Holydays: 7pm Vigil & 10am

Weekdays: Thurs–Sat 10am

Eucharistic Adoration: Mon–Sat, 10am–4pm

ST. PATRICK'S PARISH

CLERGY

Very Rev. Francis O'Brien PP

Mass Times

ST PATRICK'S CHURCH

199 Donegall St Belfast BT1 2FL

Sunday: Vigil (Saturday) 6pm; 9am, 11am & 6pm

Holydays: Please check parish website and Facebook

Weekdays: Tues, Wed, Thurs 10am

Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help

every Wednesday at 10am

Novena in honour of St. Anthony and Blessing with the relic of

St Anthony of Padua every Tuesday at 10am

### Pioneer Gathering – Sunday 27 September

A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to  
renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down &  
Connor will take place on:

Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering  
Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast.

This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who  
would like to support a fresh start, new energy,  
and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be  
delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

Anam Cara, the organisation that supports bereaved  
parents, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening  
on **Monday 14th September at 7.30pm in the Crowne  
Plaza, Shaws Bridge, Belfast.**

This event is free and open to all bereaved parents  
regardless of the age their child died, the circumstances of  
their death, or how recent their death was. You do not need  
to register in advance.

We also offer an online support group meeting. To find out  
more call 01 4045378 or email [info@anamcara.ie](mailto:info@anamcara.ie)

We're grateful for your help in raising awareness of  
this free support for bereaved parents in your parish  
community. For more information visit [www.anamcara.ie](http://www.anamcara.ie).

### September 2026 Shopping List

- Coffee
- Soup
- Jam
- Tea
- Baked beans



northbelfast.foodbank.org.uk  
Registered Charity in Northern Ireland (94C100218)

Ending hunger together



### May They Rest In Peace

#### Recently Deceased

#### Months Mind

Pat Rogan

#### Anniversaries

James Richard Hann, John Hicks, Frank McGoldrick, Malachy Quail,

Patrick and Mary Anne Canning, Denis and Ellen Lane





# Church of St. MacNissi

**TWENTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME**  
**15<sup>TH</sup> & 16<sup>TH</sup> AUGUST 2026**

**WEEKDAY MASSES** - Tuesday-7.00pm,  
 Wednesday – Friday 9.30am

## WEEKEND MASSES

Saturday 6pm Sunday 10am

**CONFESSIONS:** On request after all Masses

## EXPOSITION OF THE BLESSED SACRAMENT

Mon-10am-11am Tues - 5:30pm-7pm

**LEGION OF MARY** Tuesday evening in the  
 Parish Centre after Mass. Fatima statue  
 visitation. To have the statue in your home or  
 to have your intentions prayed for;  
 ☎07798865887

## PARISH CENTRE

Prayer Meeting - Wednesday 7:45pm

**THE ROSARY GROUP** each Thurs at 6pm in  
 the Church and 'live' online mcn media.

**DIVINE MERCY** Friday 3pm

## MONTHS MIND:

Ali McDowell – Sat 15<sup>th</sup> Aug 6pm.

## ANNIVERSARIES:

Eddie McStravick (1<sup>st</sup> Anniversary) Sat 15<sup>th</sup> Aug 6pm  
 Teresa Donnelly, Elizabeth McGuigan,  
 Shirley Murray, Peggy Donnelly, Charlie Devlin,  
 Madge Creighton, John Sawyer, Tom McCormack,  
 Thomas Gavin, Thomas Cardwell, Sarah Martin  
 Patrick McKenna, Charlie O'Boyle, Brian Kerr,  
 Mary Jane Loughran, Annie Hamilton,  
 Rosaleen Kelly, Alice Hurrell, Mary Kate Fallon.

## INTENTIONS WK BEGINNING 17-August

## MONTHS MIND

Joseph McNally – Tue 18<sup>th</sup> Aug 7pm

## ANNIVERSARY MASS

Jim McKenna (1<sup>st</sup> Anniversary) Sat 22<sup>nd</sup> Aug 6pm

Our priest is obligated to offer **Sunday Mass**  
 on behalf of **ALL** the people (*pro populo*) in the  
 parish. The deceased are remembered in our  
*Prayers of the Faithful*.

## FEAST DAYS THIS WEEK

Mon 17<sup>th</sup> Aug – Our Lady of Knock

Wed 19<sup>th</sup> Aug – St John Eudes

Thur 20<sup>th</sup> Aug – St Bernard

Sat 22<sup>nd</sup> Aug - Mary, Queen of Heaven

## PARISH WEEKLY COLLECTION £1,279.00

Thank you for your support of our parish.  
 To set up a standing order for Direct Debit  
 please call or email the parish office to arrange.

## MINISTERS OF THE WORD

|         |                    |                  |
|---------|--------------------|------------------|
| 22/8/26 | Geraldine Ibbotson | Sibéal Dumbleton |
|---------|--------------------|------------------|

## EUCCHARISTIC MINISTERS

|           |                   |                |
|-----------|-------------------|----------------|
| 22/8/2026 | Vincent O'Connell | Gerard McBride |
|           | Brian Fitzsimon   | John Heffron   |
|           | David Skelly      | Gerard Dougan  |

Congratulations to

## Tasha Craig & John Martin

who had their relationship consecrated in the  
 Sacrament of Matrimony on Friday 14<sup>th</sup> August

## CLEANING TEAM 3 on Monday 17<sup>th</sup> August

**SVP Help Line is** 0750 854 9606

**OFFICE OPEN** Monday–Friday 9- 1.pm

**CONTACT; MOBILE** 07734 570890

**Or EMAIL** randalstown@downandconnor.org

**EMERGENCY CONTACT ONLY** 07834 383314

**PARISH WEBSITE** To watch Mass online  
 Select WEBCAM from the parish website menu  
 or go to [mcn.live/cameras/st-macnissis](http://mcn.live/cameras/st-macnissis).  
 Funerals/weds recorded at the specific request  
 of the family

**PARISH DRAW FOR AUGUST** will be held on  
 Wednesday 19<sup>th</sup> August at 4.30pm in the  
 Parochial House.

## YOUTH MINISTRY - SPIRIT AND TRUTH !!

every Wednesday in St  
 MacNissi's Church  
 7pm- 8pm (**Yr 8 – 6<sup>th</sup> Form Welcome**)



**EVER YOUNG" YOUTH GROUP FOR P7  
 LEAVERS** - who will be entering Yr 8 in Sept! @  
**St Oliver Plunkett's Church Toome every  
 Sunday 4pm - 6pm"**

**PILGRIMAGE TO FATIMA** Belfast International  
 7 Nights F/B Avenida Hotel **14th/21st** August  
**£845pps.** Contact **Joe 07776425631**

**KNOCK TRIP 8<sup>th</sup> & 9<sup>th</sup> Sep** 16 seater bus  
 leaving St. MacNissi's Church at 8.am. Luncheon  
 en-route, evening meal and b & b at  
 Knock House Hotel £185pps. (night stay)  
**Contact 07519915325**

## "MEDJUGORJE YOUTH PILGRIMAGE 2027:

Our Youth Minister Dean Millar will be taking a group of young people aged 14 - 18 from Antrim, Randalstown & Duneane Parishes to Medjugorje next summer. If you would be interested in this, please share an expression of interest with Dean at [d.millar@downandconnor.org](mailto:d.millar@downandconnor.org) or via Whatsapp at 07593 925676

**August & September 2026 @ Lough Derg**  
*A pilgrimage has a vital part to play in our life of faith, for it removes us from our daily routines, and gives us time and space to encounter God more deeply. Pope Leo XIV*

**One Day Retreats** – Guided Days of Prayer and Reflection - places available on August 18<sup>th</sup>, 22<sup>nd</sup>, 23<sup>rd</sup>, 29<sup>th</sup> and 31<sup>st</sup> September 5<sup>th</sup>, 6<sup>th</sup>, 9<sup>th</sup>, 12<sup>th</sup>, 15<sup>th</sup>, 19<sup>th</sup> and 20<sup>th</sup> Admission €50. Group discounts available. Advance Booking Essential .

## Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day

Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on **Sunday, 6 September** at **Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry City**. The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, For more information and booking details, please email [info@catholicmothers.ie](mailto:info@catholicmothers.ie).

**St Joseph Men's Camino** Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one. Join men from across Ireland on **Saturday 12th September** for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker **Fr. Mark Quinn**. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, accommodation and details: [www.dominicans.ie/events](http://www.dominicans.ie/events). Enquiries: [op.evangelisation@gmail.com](mailto:op.evangelisation@gmail.com).

The **Knights of St Columbanus, CK12 Downpatrick**, invite you to a special screening of *Matt Talbot – Urban Mystic* at **Newcastle Community Cinema, St Mary's Hall, Main Street, Newcastle**, on **Friday 4th September** at **7.00pm**. Admission is free.

## MONDAY WEEKLY SALSA CLASSES

7-8pm in Tir na nÓg old clubhouse. All welcome, no partner required Contact 07713388035

**THURSDAY 10.30am** Our **WALKING CLUB** meets at the Parish Centre. Welcome Tea and Coffee on return.

**TÍR NA NÓG LOTTO** Tues 11/08/2026

**JACKPOT WINNER:**

**WINNING NUMBERS:** 6,13,18,26

**£25 WINNERS:** Rory McVeigh, Marg D Bunting, Michael McNally, Dermot Corr.

Jackpot  
**£5,000**

Next week  
Tues 18/08/2026

**Kickham's GAC** Wed 12/08/2026

**WINNING NUMBERS:** 4,8,19,24

**£30 WINNERS:**

Yvonne Loughran & Frances Bateson

Next week's draw is on Wednesday 19/08/2026 at 8.30pm. Tickets must be bought by 7.30pm.

**Jackpot £6,400** Tickets are available online at <https://member.clubspot.app/club/creggan-kickhams-gac/fundraisers> from outlets in town or your usual ticket sellers.

## COMMUNITY ADVICE Antrim and N'Abbey (Formerly Citizens Advice)

Monday from 1.30pm to 4.30pm, in Arches. No appointment needed as this is a *drop-in* service

## MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND (2-4 OCT 2026)

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2nd to Sunday 4th October 2026 at the "Focolare Centre" "Curryhills", Prosperous, Co. Kildare.

Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage.

- [www.marriageencounter.ie](http://www.marriageencounter.ie)



# Parish of St MARY'S on the HILL 16th Aug 2026

Churches: St Mary's on the Hill & St Bernard's

## PRIESTS OF THE PARISH

Fr Pat Sheehan & Fr Aidan Kerr

**PARISH OFFICE 028 90832979**

Lorraine Carlin & Patricia Gillespie

Opens Mon – Friday 9am – 1pm

165 Antrim Road. BT36 7QR

e-mail: [stmarysoth@downandconnor.org](mailto:stmarysoth@downandconnor.org)

website: [www.stmarysonthehill.online](https://www.stmarysonthehill.online)

## RECENTLY DECEASED

Liz Dearlove, Harmin Pk

Alicia Devine, Tobar Glen Crescent

Catherine Mooney, Moyola Manor

## MONTH'S MIND

Raymond Hassan, Michael McCorry

## ANNIVERSARIES

Patrick Hughes, Martin Brogan, Billy Moran,  
William McCotter, Angela McClelland, Jim Curran,  
Veronica Mulholland, Sarah Convery, William Burns,  
Baby Michael McKee, May O'Toole, Charlotte  
Fletcher, Patrick O'Neill, Kathleen McAuley,  
Rita Smyth, Mary Horan, Mathai Mani.

## MASS INTENTIONS THIS WEEK

|                       |         |                                        |
|-----------------------|---------|----------------------------------------|
| Sat 15th              | 6.00pm  | Billy Moran<br>M/M Michael McCorry     |
| Sun 16th              | 9.00am  | Angela McClelland &<br>Jim Curran      |
|                       | 11.00am | Martin Brogan<br>M/Mind Raymond Hassan |
| Mon 17th              | 9.45am  | William Burns                          |
| Tues 18 <sup>th</sup> | 9.45am  | Mary Horan                             |
| Wed 19 <sup>th</sup>  | 9.45am  | Patrick Hughes                         |
| Thur 20 <sup>th</sup> | 9.45am  | Veronica Mulholland                    |
| Fri 21 <sup>st</sup>  | 9.45am  | Baby Michael McKee                     |
| Sat 22 <sup>nd</sup>  | 9.45am  | William McCotter                       |

We welcome

**Alivia O'Neill**

recently baptised in the parish.



**NO Divine Mercy in JULY & AUGUST**  
**Back to normal for September.**  
**Baptisms on a Sunday will be at**  
**12.30pm.**

## ST BERNARD'S SITE RE-OPENS

**FEAST OF THE ASSUMPTION** Mass on the 15<sup>TH</sup>  
August at **12.00 noon** in **St. Bernard's Church**

Sunday masses will resume in St Bernard's Church  
Saturday 15th August vigil 6pm, Sunday 16th August  
9am & 11am and baptisms at 12.30pm. No 12.30pm  
mass as we are still in the Summer Schedule.

**However, there will be only limited parking in the  
top carpark at St Bernard's.** While the tarmac will be  
finished the lining of the top carpark will not take  
place until Tuesday 19th August. Some of the top  
carpark will not be available for parking; **the area  
nearest the steps leading to the Church will NOT BE  
OPEN and the GREEN GATES WILL REMAIN CLOSED.**  
The rest of the top carpark is usable but will not be  
lined.

To help with parking we have permission to use the  
school carpark, on the right of the laneway leading to  
the church, until the lining in the top carpark is  
completed.

**Weekday masses will remain in St Marys on the Hill  
Monday 17th & Tuesday 18th August and resume in  
St Bernard's on Wednesday 19th August 9.45am.**

## SUMMER SCHEDULE JULY & AUGUST

|                       |         |
|-----------------------|---------|
| St Bernard's Vigil    | 6.00pm  |
| St Bernard's          | 9.00am  |
| St Mary's on the Hill | 10.00am |
| St Bernard's          | 11.00am |
| St Bernard's          | 12.30pm |

## Mass Times This Week



Monday 10.00am Eucharistic Prayer

Service

Tuesday – Friday 10.00am Mass

Wednesday 7.00pm Novena Mass

Saturday 5.00pm Vigil

Sunday 11.00am Mass



Adoration of The Blessed Sacrament will take place after 10.00am Mass on Wednesday & Friday



Sunday evenings from 6.00–7.30pm, a time of intercession for vocations, with a special hour of prayer and reflection. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament throughout. All are very welcome.

## St Michael the Archangel Parish Bulletin



13<sup>th</sup> September 2026

Twenty-Fourth Sunday In Ordinary Times

Sunday Cycle A, Weekday Cycle 2 Psalter  
Week 4

### Parish Contact Options

CALL 02895 904304 To connect  
and choose the option for the assistance you  
require

PARISH OFFICE Option 1

IN THE CASE OF A SICK CALL Option 2

FUNERAL ARRANGEMENTS Option 3

MASS TIMES AND INFORMATION Option 4

FOR FATHER CIARAN FEENEY Option 5

The Parish Office will be open Monday – Thursday  
9.30am–12.00pm

In the event of an emergency please call the  
Vicariate Mobile on 07549209775

Webcam: [Churchmedia.tv](https://www.churchmedia.tv) or

[saintmichaelthearchangel.godaddysites.com](https://saintmichaelthearchangel.godaddysites.com)

Facebook [Saint Michael the Archangel Parish](#)

Twitter/X [@St-MichaelArch](#)

Email: [stmichaels@downandconnor.org](mailto:stmichaels@downandconnor.org)



We pray for all our deceased relatives and  
friends and for those whose  
anniversaries occur at this time.

**Anniversaries:** Michael McNally, Sarah Smylie,  
John Carland, Brendan Muldoon, Maud Tolan,  
Maureen & Hugh Pedlow, Kathleen Black,  
Frances Goodall, Paddy & Ellen McCrory,  
Meabh Officer, Lilian Doherty, James  
Anderson, John Carlin.

**Recently Deceased:** Sheila Mulligan

You can book an anniversary Mass or give an  
anniversary intention for this section of the  
bulletin by calling or e-mailing the parish office  
02895 904304 (Option 1)

Email: [stmichaels@downandconnor.org](mailto:stmichaels@downandconnor.org)



If we meditated on the most holy sacrament  
of the Eucharist we would not only hear his  
heartbeats, we would hear our hearts beating  
in union with his.

–Servant of God, Catherine Doherty

Heart of Jesus, our life and resurrection, have  
mercy on us!





### St Michael the Archangel Parish Golden Jubilee Celebrations

To celebrate the 50th Anniversary of St Michael the Archangel Parish, we invite our parishioners and parish family to save the following dates as we look forward to 5 days of Jubilee events this September.

#### Jubilee Masses

Saturday 26<sup>th</sup> September at 5.00pm

Sunday 27<sup>th</sup> September at 11.00am

These special Jubilee Masses will be followed by refreshments in the Parish Hall.

#### Jubilee Parish Mission

Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday 28<sup>th</sup> & 30<sup>th</sup> September at 7.00pm, with Mass each evening. We are delighted to welcome Michelle Moran as our Jubilee Mission speaker.

Michelle Moran is an internationally renowned Catholic speaker, evangelist and co-founder of the Sion Community.

Michelle will also share with our school pupils and staff over those 3 days encouraging them in their faith journey.

Further events will take place throughout our

Jubilee Year, including a pilgrimage to St Patrick's Country in Downpatrick next year.

Details of these and other celebrations will be announced in due course.

Please keep these dates free and join us as we give thanks for 50 years of parish life and look forward with hope to the future!



The Offertory Collection for the 6<sup>th</sup> September amounted to £1845.00, The Monthly Collection was £1285.40 Thank you TO MAKE A DONATION TO THE PARISH PLEASE VISIT OUR WEBSITE

[stmichaelsbelfast.co.uk](http://stmichaelsbelfast.co.uk) and click on the **DONATE BUTTON**

Thank you for your continuous support and Generosity

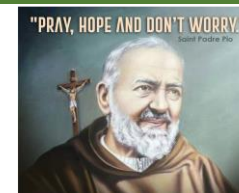
#### Parish Draw 2026/27



If you're not already a member please consider joining our Parish Draw. The draw is a valuable source of income for St Michael's. You can pick up a flyer in the porches for further details. If you're not in you can't win!



This week the sanctuary lamp burns this week for a special intention.



### Celebration of Mass and Blessing with Holy Relic

Wednesday 23<sup>rd</sup> September @7.30pm in St Vincent De Paul Church, Ligoniel Road

#### Pioneer Gathering – Sunday 27 September

A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down & Connor will take place on Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering Space, Holy Family Church, Newton Avenue, Belfast.

This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who would like to support a fresh start, new energy, and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

**St Genevieve's High School** is celebrating its 60th anniversary this year, and as part of our celebrations we are delighted to be staging our school production of The Sound of Music this October. Monday 19th October – Wednesday 21st October at 7pm Please support if you can.

Tickets available from Ticket source. £10

All welcome!

## Beginning Experience

Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November. The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email [belfastbe@yahoo.com](mailto:belfastbe@yahoo.com)

## Catholic Men's Retreat – Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20).

The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.

All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email [sean@catholicminute.co.uk](mailto:sean@catholicminute.co.uk).

## Congratulations to all our winners this month!



### Parish Draw for July 2026

1<sup>st</sup> Prize £500.00 Patrick McArdle  
2<sup>nd</sup> Prize £100.00 Cliodhna Rooney  
3<sup>rd</sup> Prize £100.00 Frances McMahon  
4<sup>th</sup> Prize £100.00 Hugh McConville  
5<sup>th</sup> Prize £100.00 Margaret Hollywood  
Promoters Prize £50.00 Anne Duffy  
Thank you to all who contribute to the

parish draw.

Abide in His Love Women's Conference. The Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran, 20-22 November 2026.

Join women from across Ireland for a faith-filled weekend with inspiring speakers including Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Fr Mark Wharton, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Oisín Martin, the Dominican Sisters of Nashville, Bishop Fintan Gavin, and more.

A conference not to be missed!

Register

now: <https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com>



August & September 2026 @ Lough Derg  
*A pilgrimage has a vital part to play in our life of faith, for it removes us from our daily routines, and gives us time and space to encounter God more deeply.*

*Pope Leo XIV*

**One Day Retreats** – Guided Days of Prayer and Reflection – places available on

Sept. 15th, 19th & 20th

Admission €50. Group discounts available.

Advance Booking Essential .

*Includes Special Themed Retreats:*

*23rd August – St Peregrine*

*5th September – Pioneer Pilgrimage*

*6th September – St Carlos Acutis*

*9th & 12th September – Vocations Monstrance*

*19th September – Divine Mercy Pilgrimage*

**Lakeshore Pilgrim Path Pilgrimage** – In the footsteps of pilgrims through the centuries

Sunday 30th August. 8km & 12km routes, fully guided. Outdoor Mass weather permitting. Admission €25. Advance Booking Essential.

**NEW FOR 2026 SEASON** –Overnight accommodation available on Station Island the night before beginning a Retreat or Pilgrimage.  
*Lough Derg, Pettigo, Co Donegal. F94 PC60*  
[www.loughderg.org](http://www.loughderg.org) email. [info@loughderg.org](mailto:info@loughderg.org) Tel. 0719861518



$$\text{£1} + \text{giftaid it} = \text{£1.25}$$

Making your donations go further with no extra cost to you!

Did you know you can GIFT AID your collections to the Parish? Donating through Gift Aid means we can claim an extra 25p for every £1 you give. It will not cost you any extra. If you pay tax, even a tiny amount on a small pension, we can claim an extra 25p in each £1 you donate to St Michael's Parish. Interested in hearing more? Call in or give us a call.

If you already contribute through the envelope system or by standing order and are a tax payer who would like to gift aid your donations please complete one of the gift aid declarations and return to the office.



## **Sunday 6th September 2026**

We pray for the happy repose of the souls of:

### **Recently deceased:**

Brendan Morris, Paddy Elliot, Patricia McFarlane

### **Anniversaries/Intentions:**

Ann Rice, Gerard Hughes, Benny McKinley,  
Owen & Tom Monaghan



Sunday Mass 11am  
Saturday Vigil Mass 6.30pm  
Mon, Tues, Wed at 10am



Friday at 7.30pm except the first Friday of the month when we have the Mass with the Blessing of the Sick at 7pm.

**Confession is 5.45pm - 6.15pm on a Saturday**

**6pm - 7pm on a Wednesday.**

**Beginning Experience** is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November. The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating.

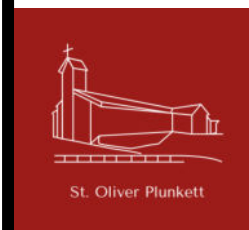
Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in

**St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays**

**(26th September 24th October and 21st November)**

Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669

or email [belfastbe@yahoo.com](mailto:belfastbe@yahoo.com)



## **St Oliver Plunkett Parish**

27b Glenveagh Drive, Belfast,  
BT11 9HX. T: 028 9061 8180

**Fr. Tony McAleese**

**(Office hours 9am - 1pm Mon, Tues, Thurs & Fri)**

E: [stoliverplunkett@downandconnor.org](mailto:stoliverplunkett@downandconnor.org)

[www.stoliverplunkettparish.ie](http://www.stoliverplunkettparish.ie)

Webcam: [stoliverplunkettparish.ie/live-mass](http://stoliverplunkettparish.ie/live-mass)

**SUNDAY 6TH SEPTEMBER 2026**



### **Black Mountain Family of Parishes**

**Our emergency phone 07549209775.**

**Only for those needing the last rites, or in the case of a death. Thank you.**



|                    |              |               |
|--------------------|--------------|---------------|
| Fr McCullagh       | St Agnes     | 028 90615 702 |
| Fr Gabriel Lyons   | St Teresa's  | 028 9061 2855 |
| Fr Ciaran Feeney   | St Michaels  | 028 9508 8030 |
| Fr Brendan Mulhall | Holy Trinity | 028 9059 0985 |
| Fr Patrick Devlin  | St Joseph's  | 028 9061 4567 |

***Fr Colin Grant and Fr Joe McGuigan are both assisting in our family of parishes***

### **Remember.....**

Book your month mind and anniversary Masses early as we only take so many for each mass. We don't like to disappoint. A month mind mass must be booked by the family of the deceased.

**Thanks.**





## Parish Income Update



*If you wish to set up a direct debit in place of using your envelopes, call into the office.*

**Weekly Income Sunday 30th August: £869.64**

***Thank you to all our parishioners for your generosity and continued loyalty to St Oliver Plunkett parish.***



Please note the office is closed on Monday 7th September. We will reopen on Tuesday 8th September at 9am. **Thank you.**



### **Mass for the New School Year**

This Mass will take place on Wednesday 9th September at 10am.  
**All welcome.**

The Carson Academy of Irish Dance welcomes new beginners to our classes at **Carson Studios, Tullyglass Business Park, Springbank Industrial Estate.**

**Beginners – Girls & Boys Age 4+ on** Wednesdays 6–7pm | Thursdays 5–6pm

**Junior Jiggers – Age 2–4 on** Saturdays 11–11:45am

Classes commence **week of 7th September. Enquiries/Booking:**  
WhatsApp: 07429 496240 or Email: [carson\\_acd@icloud.com](mailto:carson_acd@icloud.com)

### **Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach**

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at **Portglenone Monastery** on **Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.**

The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.

All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email [sean@catholicminute.co.uk](mailto:sean@catholicminute.co.uk).

### **DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG**

**Saturday 19th September**

Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm .  
The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs

### **A Year of Ignatian Prayer 2026-2027 – Belfast Jesuit Centre**

There are a few places remaining on our immersive programme in Ignatian Spirituality, which returns on Saturday 26th September; offering ten in-person Saturdays (10am–4pm) in the BJC and seven online Integrative Practice Pause Points to support prayer, discernment and reflective living. Open to those new to Ignatian Spirituality and those seeking to deepen their practice. Suggested donation: £200–£280. Bursaries available. For dates and registration, please visit: <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/a-year-of-ignatian-prayer-2026-2027/>

### **The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre**

Weekly screenings of The Chosen: Season 2 will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at 10.45am, episode at 11.00am, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion.

All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct.

Contact: [bjc@jesuit.ie](mailto:bjc@jesuit.ie) | 07955 282371 | [belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk](http://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk)

### **Vacancy with Down & Connor - Pastoral Ministry Co-ordinator**

Following a review of this Fixed Term Contract, we are re-advertising the role of Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator, which will be based at the Jesuit Centre Belfast and will work alongside the Chaplain to the University of Ulster, Belfast Campus.

We are posting the vacancy on the Diocese of Down and Connor website, [nijobs.com](http://nijobs.com) and the Community NI website, as well as other outlets, with the application pack available from the Diocesan website at Diocese of Down and Connor under the tab /Job Vacancies. The job ad closes at 12 noon on Thursday 10 September 2026.



Parish of Downpatrick

Sunday 06 September 2026

23<sup>rd</sup>, Sunday in Ordinary Time**PRIESTS:** Fr Eugene O'Neill PP, Fr. Jim Conway CC**Contacts:****Parish Office:** 07337 485743 (TEMPORARY PARISH OFFICE NUMBER)**For emergencies please ring (for example- an urgent sick call or a sudden death):** 07841101678**Temporary Address until further notice:** Patrician Youth Centre, John Street, BT30 6HS**New Office hours 10.00am – 2.00pm Monday & Thursday**  
**New office hours 10.00am – 1.00pm Tuesday & Wednesday****Parish Support Officer: Tel: 07337 485743**

You can contact us by telephone or email. Since Downpatrick is a very busy Parish Office; we can't always answer the phone immediately. Please leave a message with your telephone number and we will call you back.

**Parish email:** [downpatrick@downandconnor.org](mailto:downpatrick@downandconnor.org)**Website:** [www.stpatricksdowndpatrick.com](http://www.stpatricksdowndpatrick.com)**Mass Schedule:****Downpatrick Parish Mass Schedule:****Weekend Masses****Vigils**

St. Patrick's 5pm

St Brigid's 6.30pm

**Sunday**

St Patrick's 10.30am

St. Malachy's – 1<sup>st</sup> Sunday of the Month – 9am –**Daily Masses**Monday 7.30pm **St. Patrick's**Tues – Friday 10am **St. Patrick's****St. Colmcille's**

Wednesday 7:30pm

**Sacrament of Baptism:** 2<sup>nd</sup>, 3<sup>rd</sup> & 4<sup>th</sup> Sunday of each month**Confession** available in St Patrick's, Saturdays 4.15pm – 4.45pm**PARISH COLLECTIONS:****30 August 2026****Offertory** £2169 **Medical Missionaries** £1370To donate directly via Bank Transfer the parish bank details are: **Account Name: Parish of Downpatrick, Account Number: 80146471, Sort Code: 95-06-79** (please add an identifying name to your transaction) please contact your bank to arrange.**Dona Card Machine** is available for convenience at Our Lady's Shrine.*Thank You for your ongoing support.***NAME CHANGE****You will have noticed that the new title "PARISH SUPPORT OFFICER" is being used in the bulletin information section and in the job advertisements in this weeks parish bulletin. This is simply the new term for parish secretary being used across the diocese.****MASS INTENTIONS:****Saturday 05 September, St. Patrick's, 5pm:****Anniv:** Dominic Mcilmail, Hubert Doyle,**Monday 07 September, St. Patrick's, 7:30pm:****Anniv:** Mary Ritchie,**Wednesday 09 September, St. Colmcille's, 7:30pm:****Anniv:** Michael Molloy,**Saturday 12 September, St. Patrick's, 5pm:****Month's Mind:** Anthony Sturgess,**1<sup>st</sup> Anniv:** Maudie Marks, John McCormick**Anniv:** Mark McKee, Jackie Walsh, Josephine Torney,**Saturday 12 September, St. Brigid's, 6:30pm:****Month's Mind:** Michael Miller,**Sunday 13 September, St. Patrick's, 10:30am:****Month's Mind:** Dermot MacNabb,**Anniv:** Rosaleen MacNabb,**If you would like a Mass booking, please drop into the sacristy and make the booking directly with the priest.****Your Prayers are Requested for:****Recently Deceased:** Frank Boyd, Oliver Cunningham, Patrick Kearney, Joseph McEvoy,**Anniv:** Andrew Diamond, James Breen, Dominic Mcilmail,**Legion of Mary Annual Trip to Knock** will take place on Sunday 27th September. The cost is £30 per person, making the usual stops for breaks. Pick up points are at the following Churches:- Newcastle – (back of the Church) 6.15am, Castlewellan – 6.30am, Downpatrick – 6.45am, Crossgar – 7am and Saintfield – 7.15am. To book your place you can place your money in an envelope along with your name and phone number and drop it into the Parish offices in Saul or Downpatrick (Patrician Youth Centre) or you can phone Geraldine on 07845 422723**Lectio Divina** will resume on Tuesday 8th September at 11 o'clock (please note the correct day). We will be using the small room in the church that is used on Sundays for children's liturgy. Lectio Divina is the practice of reading scripture, meditation and prayer. New members are very welcome.**RCIA 2026 / 2027:** Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith? The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect with their faith. The 2026–2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23 September and runs weekly from 6.30 to 8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are also very welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away. To find out more, scan the QR code or visit our information page, or email [rcia@downandconnor.org](mailto:rcia@downandconnor.org) to register.**Scouts** will hold a registration evening on Monday 7th September for Beavers from 7 to 8 pm. Tuesday 8th September for Cubs from 7 to 8.30. Any queries contact the scout hall on 02844839841.**DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG:** Saturday 19th September Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm. The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs..**Assist us to live, not to die...**

The Bill to allow assisted dying is being brought before the WESTMINSTER PARLIAMENT on 11 September. The consequences for the sick, vulnerable and old are terrible to contemplate. Please take a card explaining the dangers and consider sending to your MP.

**Safeguarding:** If you have a concern, suspicion, or wish to make an allegation of child abuse, or abuse in relation to an adult at risk, please contact the Diocesan Safeguarding Office: Philip O'Hara, Designated Liaison Person, 120, Cliftonville Road, Belfast BT14 6LA. Mobile: 07534 992124 or Telephone: 028 90 492798. Email: [philip.ohara@soddc.org](mailto:philip.ohara@soddc.org) or visit <https://downandconnorsafeguarding.com>



**DIOCESE OF DOWN AND CONNOR Parish of Dunloy and Cloughmills**

Are seeking to recruit a part-time Caretaker. The role will be based at Bridge Road Dunloy. Availability to work flexible hours is required including evenings and weekends. Rate of Pay £12.71

Full details on [www.downandconnor.org](http://www.downandconnor.org) or Community NI website as well as Church posters. **Closing date 12 noon Monday 28th September**

Down and Connor Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer

**ST OLCAN'S PRIMARY SCHOOL, ARMOY Temporary Building Supervisor**

Required - require a temporary cleaner for 18.5 hours per week with immediate start, initially for 1 month but may be extended, experience preferred. Please send your CV to [mkennedy502@c2kni.net](mailto:mkennedy502@c2kni.net) if you would be interested in this post.

**TRÓCAIRE Could You Help Share the True Spirit of Christmas?** Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell Trócaire's Gifts of Change — meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide everything you need including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. Last Christmas, 50 parishes took part — and we'd love to grow that number even more this year! If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at [mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org](mailto:mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org) or call 028 9080 8030.

**QUEEN'S CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY – WE'RE BACK!**

The Catholic Chaplaincy at Queen's reopens for the new academic year on Monday 14 September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. Our first Sunday Mass is 20 September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Please note the new time!

New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at [qubcatholic.org](http://qubcatholic.org) and on our socials. Staff and alumni are always welcome too. Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions or candle lighting — and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!

**VINTED & MORE NIGHT** Come along & grab a bargain!! Friday 23rd Oct 2026 From 5pm-8pm Cloughmills Community Hall A night filled with selling & buying preloved clothing & local vendors selling their goods!! Free admission / Everyone welcome!! See Vinted & More on Facebook!!

SVP.Helpline 07349983363

Bulletin notices by 12 noon Thursdays



**Twenty Fourth Sunday in Ordinary Time**  
**13 September 2026**

**Very Rev. Canon Colm McBride PP :**

Parochial House 44 Lough Road Loughguile BT44 9JN

**Tel:** 028 276 41206

**Email:** [loughguile@downandconnor.org](mailto:loughguile@downandconnor.org)

**Facebook:** St Patrick's and St MacNissi's

**Parish Office Hours** Mon Wed Thurs 10 a.m.- 2.30 p.m.

Tues 10-4.30. p.m.

***PARISH MASS NOTICE -THIS INCOMING WEEK THERE WILL BE NO  
PARISH MASS ON MONDAY , TUESDAY OR WEDNESDAY***

*We are called to forgive; and that can be really difficult.*

*You have been defrauded by the banks of your life's savings - can you forgive?*

*You were abused as a child - can you forgive?*

*You were done out of a job because another lied to get it - can you forgive?*

*The answer is maybe 'no'.*

*What then does God want?*

*He asks us to open our hearts to the other so that we may forgive. Forgiveness is the deepest of God's desires on our behalf, and he hopes that we can forgive each other.*

*Our hurts and burdens are heavy to carry through life. To forgive can release some of that weight. The person who hurt us may be dead, or may not even know (or care) that we are hurting. When we desire to forgive but don't know how, one way of looking for this strength is to pray for it. We often pray, 'Lord, make my heart like yours'. When we pray that we are praying to be forgiving people!*

*Another way is to pray for the person. When we realise that as God loves me, he also loves everyone, we may find a spark or light of forgiveness in our souls. Out of this we may find the will to meet the other and talk to him or her, and find the grace of forgiveness between us. Forgiveness sometimes comes slowly. When God sees us wanting to be on the road to forgiveness, he gives us the graces we need to unburden ourselves and be able to love like him.*

*Sit in silence for a while, and send a blessing or prayer to someone you need to forgive.*

*Lord, I ask - make my heart like yours. (CatholicIreland.net)*

### PARKING AT ST PATRICK'S CHURCH

Last week a young child on a bicycle was almost knocked down as she attempted to cross the Coolkeeran Road outside the Church.

She had correctly chosen the spot where the Kerb is lowered to accommodate pedestrians moving to and from the Church Car park.

However, vehicles had been parked on the road outside the Church gate and she wasn't immediately seen by the driver of the oncoming vehicle.

Fortunately she wasn't physically hurt.

As parishioners will be aware, the Coolkeeran Road is an arterial road within the parish, the Coolkeeran / Lough Road junction is one of the busiest within our parish.

**It is imperative that parishioners take action now ,change practice and park at all times in the Church car park and not on the road outside the Church gate.**

**HLI IRELAND:** Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29th September at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

**CATHOLIC MEN'S RETREAT - STANDING IN THE BREACH** A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email [sean@catholicminute.co.uk](mailto:sean@catholicminute.co.uk).

**BEGINNING EXPERIENCE** The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email [belfastbe@yahoo.com](mailto:belfastbe@yahoo.com)

**THE LEGION OF MARY ANNUAL PILGRIMAGE** to Knock Shrine will take place on Sunday 27 September 2026. A coach will leave Dunloy Parish Centre at 7am, returning by 9.30pm. Information/booking: 07471 537 051

**ALZHEIMER'S SOCIETY MEMORY WALK** is back for 2026! Take part in Memory Walk this autumn and walk to fund faster diagnosis and vital support.. Belfast Ormeau Pk on Sat **26 Sept** Sign up [todaymemorywalk.org.uk](http://todaymemorywalk.org.uk) 0300 330 5452

|                                |            |               |                                                 |                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------|------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Saturday 12 <sup>th</sup> Sept | 7.30 p.m.  | St Patrick's  | Ministers of the Word<br>Shane McMahon          | Ministers of the Eucharist<br>A. McNaughton & M. McMullan<br><i>Anniversary Mass Rosemarie Laverty</i> |
| Sunday 13 <sup>th</sup> Sept   | 9.30 a.m.  | St MacNissi's | Pat McAuley                                     | Joseph McCarry & M. Young<br><i>Anniversary Mass Ann McFadden</i>                                      |
|                                | 11.30 a.m. | St Patrick's  | Orlagh McArthur                                 | C. Casey & G. McMillan                                                                                 |
| Monday 14 <sup>th</sup> Sept   | 7.30 p.m.  | St MacNissi's | <b>NO PARISH MASS TODAY</b>                     |                                                                                                        |
| Tuesday 15 <sup>th</sup> Sept  | 9.30 a.m.  | St MacNissi's | <b>NO PARISH MASS TODAY</b>                     |                                                                                                        |
| Wed 16 <sup>th</sup> Sept      | 7.30 p.m.  | St Patrick's  | <b>NO PARISH MASS TODAY</b>                     |                                                                                                        |
| Thursday                       | 9.30 a.m.  | St Patrick's  | Mass followed by Adoration 10.00 a.m. -12 noon. |                                                                                                        |
| Friday                         | 9.30 a.m.  | St Patrick's  | Mass                                            |                                                                                                        |
| Saturday 19 <sup>th</sup> Sept | 7.30 p.m.  | St Patrick's  | Ministers of the Word<br>Damian McCloskey       | Ministers of the Eucharist<br>M. McCloskey & T. Devlin<br><i>Anniversary Mass John Reid</i>            |
| Sunday 20 <sup>th</sup> Sept   | 9.30 a.m.  | St MacNissi's | Majella Murray                                  | V.McDonnell & M.McKinley                                                                               |
|                                | 11.30 a.m. | St Patrick's  | Paula Casey                                     | T.McIntyre & B. Connolly                                                                               |

**ANNIVERSARIES** Bridie Carey Annie Douthart Anna Greene  
Patrick and Ellen Hetherington Rosemarie Laverty Harry McAuley  
Eilish McClements John McCloskey Ann McFadden Tilly McGill  
Tom O'Neill Annemarie Rafferty John Reid Joe Robinson John Waide

**BAPTISMS** The Sacrament of Baptism will be celebrated on the **1<sup>st</sup> and 3<sup>rd</sup> Sunday** of the month **only** after the 11.30 a.m. Mass. To book please contact the Parish Office. A copy of the child's long birth certificate is required within a week of booking. On the day please bring a Baptism Candle and a white Shawl.

**ANNIVERSARY/MONTH MIND MASS** Please now book through the office, these can be booked for any scheduled Mass **excluding Sunday 11.30 a.m.**

**WEDDING BOOKING** Please ring the office for initial bookings.

**WEEKLY COLLECTION** £1415.00 Thank you for your support.  
Autumn Offering will be taken up **next** weekend.

**DAY TRIP TO KNOCK:** Saturday 3rd October. Bus leaving St Patrick's Church Loughguile at 6am. Contact Patricia Campbell on 02827641120 or 07871626940. Price approx. £30 depending on numbers.







## PARISH BULLETIN

Sunday 6 September 2026  
Twenty Third Sunday in Ordinary Time

Fr Francis O'Brien

### CONTACTS

**Parish Office:** 028 90 324597

**Address:** 199 Donegall Street, Belfast, BT1 2FL

**Emergency Telephone:** 07496818511.

**Office hours 10.30am – 2.00pm Tuesday -Thursday, closes 1pm on Friday.**

You can contact us by telephone or email. Since St Patrick's is a very busy Parish Office; we can't always answer the phone immediately. Please leave a message with your telephone number and we will call you back.

**Parish email:** [stpatricks@downandconnor.org](mailto:stpatricks@downandconnor.org)

**Website:** [www.stpatricks.org](http://www.stpatricks.org)

 [St. Patrick's Parish, Belfast | Belfast | Facebook](#)

 [@stpatricks200](#)

**St Patrick's Parish is a member of a Family of Parishes comprising the Parishes of Holy Family, St Gerards and St Patrick's.**

**Holy Family** – Fr Michael Spence, Fr John O' Lavery (028 90 743119)

**St Gerards** – Fr Patrick O'Keeffe (028 90 774833)

**Belfast Jesuit Centre:** Fr Gerry Clarke SJ  
[gclarke@jesuit.ie](mailto:gclarke@jesuit.ie)

**St Patrick's Primary School:** 028 90 351478

**Blessed Trinity College:** 028 90 370665

### WEEKEND MASS

Saturday Vigil 6pm. Sunday Morning 9am & 11am.  
Sunday Evening 6pm Candlelit Mass.

**WEEKDAY MASS** Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday 10am.

**CONFESSIONS** Saturdays 5.30pm to 5.50pm.

### REST IN PEACE

Inurnment: Jim Meighan.



### MASS INTENTIONS FOR THE COMING WEEK

**Saturday 6pm:** Jim Meighan Months Mind, In Memory of Deceased Members of the Cosgrove Family.

**Sunday 9am:** Albert Gibson Anniversary.

**Sunday 6pm:** Eddie Brannigan 3<sup>rd</sup> Anniversary.

**Tuesday 10am:** Seamus Brady Anniversary, In Memory of James and Jean Flanagan.

**Wednesday 10am:** In Memory of Annie and George Madine.

### BAPTISMS IN ST PATRICKS

**We welcomed to the Family of God this Summer.....**

**Caiden, Rosie Mae, Harper, Olivia, Kayden, Ava and Eadaoin.** *As a Parish we pray that the Lord protects them, strengthens them and helps them continue shining their light.*

### FEAST/MEMORIAL DAYS THIS WEEK

**Tuesday 8 September – The Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary.** We celebrate the Nativity of Mary, who brought the dawn of hope and salvation to the world. She is the true Ark of the Covenant, the Temple of God, because her body received the one Mediator.

**Wednesday 9 September - St Ciaran,** was born in Roscommon around 512. He came to Clonmacnoise in January 545 where he founded a monastery which was to become one of the most renowned in Europe. He died at the age of 33 while the monastery was still being built.

**Thursday 10 September - St Peter Claver,** born in Catalonia 1580, a member of the Society of Jesus (Jesuits). In 1610 he was sent to Cartagena in Colombia and worked for 33 years among the slaves until his death in 1654. During a tireless ministry he is said to have baptised more than 300,000.

**Saturday 12 September - The Most Holy Name of Mary.** This Feast was included in the Roman Calendar in 1684 to celebrate the victory over the Turks at Vienna in 1683.

### NEW LODGE GROTTTO 50<sup>th</sup> BIRTHDAY CELEBRATIONS

**Monday 7 September**

**6.30pm Rosary at the Grotto**

**7pm Holy Mass at the Grotto**

Followed by Refreshments. **All**

**Welcome!** With Fr Francis O'Brien and Fr John O'Lavery.





## TWENTY THIRD SUNDAY OF THE YEAR

### On Fraternal Correction

The question in today's Gospel is not forgiveness, but the sin of one member of the community. Every effort is to be made to bring the erring person to repentance, first in private, then before a few, finally, before the whole community. If he is still unrepentant, he must be excommunicated. The decision of the Church will be honoured by God, since God inspired them in making that decision. The harsh phrase 'treat him as a pagan or a tax collector' reflects the strict Jewish Christianity of Matthew's Church. The First Reading talks about the grave responsibility leaders of the community have to try to correct the erring.

**READINGS: First Reading (Ezek 33:7-9).** The appointed leaders bear the responsibility to point out to wrong-doers the error of their ways and to try to get them to reform. **Second Reading (Rom 13:8-10).** If we truly loved our neighbours, we would not harm them in any way. **Gospel (Mt 18:15-20).** We hear about the duty of a Christian to correct an erring brother or sister. But there is a proper way of doing it.

## OPENING MASS FOR THE SEASON OF CREATION

**Sunday, 6th September 6pm in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast.** Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson marking the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept-4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water".

## RCIA A JOURNEY IN FAITH

Thinking about becoming a Catholic, or wanting to deepen your understanding of the faith?

**The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation and community for adults wishing to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church.** It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect with their faith.

**The 2026-2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23 September in St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast.** Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion and time for questions.

All are welcome, whether you are exploring the faith for the first time or returning after time away.

To find out more email [rcia@downandconnor.org](mailto:rcia@downandconnor.org)

## DOWN & CONNOR DIOCESAN RETREAT

**13TH – 16TH SEPTEMBER** As Fr Francis will be attending the retreat there will be no weekday Mass Tuesday 15 and Wednesday 16 September.

## PRAYER OF THE WEEK

We wish all the students and teachers of the schools in our Parish best wishes for the new school year.

## A BACK-TO-SCHOOL PRAYER

Loving God, thank you for the rest and relaxation we enjoyed over the summer.

Today, we pray for our children as they begin their new school year.

Bless them with joy at seeing friends, excitement at new experiences, and a love of learning. Watch over all who learn, replacing fear with joy, anxiety with peace, and tiredness with energy.

Grant teachers wisdom, patience, and joy in serving their students.

In Jesus' name we pray.

Amen.

## THOUGHT FOR THE WEEK

*"September is a gentle reminder: you are capable of change."*

## NOT DEAD YET UK

There are cards available in the Church to vote against the **Second Reading of The Assisted Dying Bill**. Please lend your support to those campaigning for disabled people to be assisted in living, not dying. **The Second Reading of the Bill in the House of Commons takes place on September 11**, please fill in and send your vote against it before that date.

## PARISH COLLECTIONS

The **Offertory Collection for Sunday 30 August** came to **£1866.00. Dona £135.00.**

XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

If you wish to donate directly via Bank Transfer the parish bank details are:

**Account Name: St Patricks Parish**

**Account Number: 70327727**

**Sort Code: 95-06-79** (please add an identifying name to your transaction) or you can contact the Parish Office for a Standing Order Form.

**Thank you for your continued support and generosity.**





## **PARISH OF ST TERESA OF ÁVILA**

Web Page: [www.stteresasparish.church](http://www.stteresasparish.church) [stteresas@downandconnor.org](mailto:stteresas@downandconnor.org)

Black Mountain Family of Parishes

Fr Gabriel Lyons 028 9061 2855 [g.lyons@downandconnor.org](mailto:g.lyons@downandconnor.org)

Parish Office open Tuesday, Wednesday & Thursday 9am to 3pm.

**6 September 2026, Twenty Third Sunday of Ordinary Time, Year A.**

**Sunday Gospel** *In any group, small and big, things cause friction. Everyone thinks his or her way is right. We can fight over who is right. Some things are worth a fight, others not. In the big questions of life, we need the advice, support and love of the other. Many people ask themselves, "Why I didn't give an honest opinion about a decision like marriage or a job or a course of studies which seemed ill-advised to everyone?" We all have good and not-so-good tendencies. We can only advise as best we can, sensitively and wisely, and hope we get a hearing. We are afraid to hurt, to be rejected. Why do we let so many people drink themselves into trouble and never tell them? The terror of a neighbourhood, no matter what age, needs to be confronted. The problem of drugs in a neighbourhood is not confronted. Crime is not reported. In small and big things we are each others' keepers. Jesus is saying something like that today. Parents can find this difficult as they try to guide the family well and not lose them. We have social responsibility in the family and in the neighbourhood and even worldwide for the common good. (Fr D Neary)*

**Please note,** St Teresa's Church will be closed from Monday 7 September 2026 until Saturday 12 September 2026. It will take 5 days to repair the sanctuary steps that were vandalised in November 2025.

**Sunday Masses** Church of the Holy Spirit (Sat.) Vigil 5pm, St Matthias' 10am, St Teresa's 12noon.

**Weekday Masses** St Matthias Monday 7pm, Tuesday 10am, Wednesday 10am, Thursday 10am, Friday 7am & 10am, Saturday 10am.

**Confessions** Saturday 4 30pm in Church of the Holy Spirit, after any Mass and on request.

**Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament** every Wednesday in St Matthias' Church from 11am to 4pm.

*To book an Anniversary Mass, Baptism or Wedding Ceremony please email the Parish Office.*

**Recently Deceased** Martin McKenna, Andrew Campbell.

**Months Mind** Maureen McCrossan

**Anniversaries,** Mary McDermot, Desmond Nugent, Catherine Morrison, Sr Catherine O'Connor, Rosie Glover, Andrew Murray.